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Barapullah P-III flyover to be ready by end of June: Minister

NATION: PG 5
'Mere speculation, no reality': Cong on K'taka leadership change

FILM: PG 14
Ranveer Singh 'banned' by film body over 'Don 3' exit

SHAH LINKS DEMOGRAPHIC CHANGE TO NATIONAL SECURITY, SOVEREIGNTY CONCERNS

Govt sets up high-level panel to examine 'unnatural demographic' changes

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Centre has formed a high-level committee, headed by a retired Supreme Court judge, to examine demographic changes arising from illegal immigration and other unnatural causes and recommend measures to deal with these challenges, Union home minister Amit Shah announced on Tuesday.

The committee has been given a year to submit its report, an official statement said. The Union Home Ministry may extend the committee's tenure by up to six months.

"Illegal infiltration and other reasons leading to Unnatural Demographic Change is a very big challenge for the present and future of any nation. To deal with this challenge, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had announced the high-level committee on demographic change on August 15 last year. I am delighted to inform that the government has now constituted this committee," Shah said in a post on his X account.

Shah said the committee will be chaired by former Supreme Court judge Justice Prabhakar Naolekar (Retired). Apart from the census commissioner, an official statement said former Uttar Pradesh chief secretary Durga Shankar Mishra, former Delhi police commissioner Balaji Srivastava and economist Shamika Ravi would be expert members of the committee.

"The joint secretary (foreigners-l), Ministry of Home Affairs, will serve as the member secretary of this committee," he said.

Shah emphasised that demographic change is a serious issue linked not only to the country's sovereignty but also to national security, law and order, profound changes in social structure and the preservation of tribal society.

"This committee will conduct a comprehensive assessment of demographic changes occurring across India due to illegal immigration and other unnatural causes, analyse patterns of abnormal population shifts at the levels of religious and social communities, and present a planned and time-bound solution for the same," he said.

The high-level committee will conduct a scientific evaluation of the demographic changes taking place in different regions of Continued on P4

Delhi Police conducts a verification drive to identify illegal Bangladeshi immigrants ANI/FILE

TAKEAWAYS

- Retired Supreme Court judge Justice Prabhakar Naolekar will head the committee
- Panel has one year to submit report; tenure extendable by six months
- Amit Shah says demographic change poses present and future national challenges
- Shah links issue to sovereignty, national security, law and order concerns
- Committee to assess demographic shifts caused by illegal immigration and unusual factors
- PANEL WILL ANALYSE ABNORMAL POPULATION CHANGES ACROSS RELIGIOUS AND SOCIAL COMMUNITIES

Quad eyes 'Partnership of Action' with new Indo-Pacific security drive

Announces massive $20 bn critical minerals framework

From left, Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio during the Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting, in New Delhi PTI

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Quad nations on Tuesday rolled out a broad set of new initiatives spanning energy security, critical minerals, maritime surveillance, port infrastructure and counter-terror cooperation, as the four-member grouping sought to deepen practical cooperation in the Indo-Pacific amid rising geopolitical tensions and supply chain concerns. Meeting in New Delhi for the 11th Quad Foreign Ministers' Meeting, India, the United States, Japan and Australia reaffirmed their commitment to a "free and open Indo-Pacific," while also voicing concerns over coercive actions in regional waters, disruptions to energy trade and vulnerabilities in global supply chains.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar hosted the meeting, attended by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong and Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi. After the talks, Indian officials described the Quad as an increasingly action-focused platform moving beyond consultations toward implementation. Continued on P4

India-US rare earths pact aims to counter China's global dominance

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: India and the United States on Tuesday signed a major agreement to strengthen cooperation in securing critical minerals and rare earth supplies, marking a significant step in their strategic partnership as both countries seek to reduce dependence on concentrated global supply chains dominated by China. The framework, signed in New Delhi by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio on the sidelines of the Quad foreign ministers' meeting, covers cooperation across mining, processing, recycling, financing, and supply chain management for minerals that are essential to advanced technologies, clean energy systems, and defence manufacturing.

Calling the agreement timely, Jaishankar said the framework would deepen cooperation across the full critical minerals and rare earth supply chain.

KEY POINTS

- Framework covers mining, processing, recycling, financing, and supply chain management
- Critical minerals essential for EVs, semiconductors, renewables, drones, and defence systems

"This framework aims to deepen our cooperation across the entire critical minerals and rare earth supply chain, including mining, processing, recycling and related investment," he said.

He added that the agreement would help build resilient and diversified supply chains, support project financing, and improve management of critical minerals and rare earth resources.

Rubio described the pact as a practical sign of the growing India-US strategic relationship.

"We are two countries that have strategic Continued on P4

BSF boosted morale of people living in frontier districts during Operation Sindoor

Amit Shah

In today's paper ...

CITY
SPL HEAT WARD AT LNJP 3
NATION
MODI COMPLETES 12 YRS IN OFFICE 5
EDIT
UNEASY TRUCE 7
INTERNATIONAL
ISRAEL, HEZBOLLAH CLASH 8
BUSINESS
₹ FALLS 44 PAISE TO 95.70 PER $ 10
SPORT
RCB MARCH INTO FINAL 12

Frozen Iranian funds key hurdle in talks

Iran begins restoring internet after long shutdown

MPOST BUREAU

DUBAI: Iran's access to billions of dollars in frozen overseas assets has emerged as the central obstacle in negotiations with the United States, even as both sides continue indirect talks aimed at ending months of conflict that has rattled global energy markets and raised fears of wider instability. Iranian media reports said Tehran has made the release of blocked funds a key precondition for progress, while fresh US military strikes and Iran's sharp response have cast new uncertainty over the fragile diplomatic process.

Iran's state-linked Fars News Agency, citing a source close to the negotiations, reported on Tuesday that discussions over Tehran's frozen assets are now being handled through Qatari mediation. The report said Iran has made clear that no broader agreement can move forward unless it gains access to the funds.

"No agreement is possible until the agreed-upon funds have been deposited," Fars quoted negotiators as saying, adding that Tehran remains wary because of what it described as past failures by Washington to honour commitments. "Given America's history of breaking promises, Iran does not consider these understandings finalized."

Iran is reportedly seeking the release of about $24 billion in blocked assets under a broader 14-point framework linked to ending the conflict that began on February 28 after Continued on P4

TAKEAWAYS

- Tehran reportedly seeking release of $24 billion in blocked assets
- Qatar acting as mediator in negotiations over Iran's frozen funds
- Iran says no agreement possible until initial funds are transferred

Breather for Gymkhana: Centre in HC says won't take forceful possession by June 5

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court on Tuesday gave members of the historic Delhi Gymkhana Club temporary relief after recording the Centre's assurance that no forceful takeover of the club premises would take place by June 5, even as a legal battle over the government's move to terminate the club's nearly century-old lease gathered pace.

Hearing multiple petitions filed by club members, employees and the last elected governing body, Justice Avneesh Jhingan said there was no immediate need for an interim order, noting the Centre's submission that any eviction, if undertaken, would follow due legal procedure and prior notice. The matter has now been listed for the end of July, giving petitioners a temporary reprieve.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, told the court that June 5 was only the date by which the lessee had been asked to vacate voluntarily and not a deadline for forcible possession. See P2

> "UNLIKE THE POPULAR BELIEF, WHICH IS GOING ROUNDS IN MEDIA CIRCLES, IT IS NOT THAT THE POLICE WILL RUSH IN AND FORCIBLE POSSESSION WILL BE TAKEN OVER"

WARM NIGHT CONDITIONS ADD TO HEAT STRESS

Banda sizzles at 47.4 degrees Celsius as intense heat continues across states

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: An intense heatwave swept across large parts of northern and central India on Tuesday, with Uttar Pradesh's Banda once again recording the highest temperature in the country at 47.4 degrees Celsius, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD), as several states battled extreme daytime heat and unusually warm nights.

The IMD classifies a heatwave in the plains when the maximum temperature crosses 45 degrees Celsius, while temperatures above 47 degrees Celsius fall under the severe heatwave category.

In Uttar Pradesh, Banda remained the hottest location nationwide. Five other districts in the state also crossed the 45-degree mark. Orai recorded 45.8 degrees Celsius, Jhansi 45.5 degrees, Continued on P4

A man bathes under tap water to beat the heat during summer season, at Sangam, in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, on Tuesday PTI

Rajasthan also saw harsh weather conditions, with Sri Ganganagar registering 47 degrees Celsius, the highest in the state

CNG prices in Delhi hiked again; rise by Rs 2/kg

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Compressed natural gas (CNG) prices in the national capital and adjoining cities were raised by Rs 2 per kg on Tuesday, marking the fourth increase in less than two weeks amid rising input costs.

CNG now costs Rs 83.09 per kg, up from Rs 81.09, according to Indraprastha Gas Ltd, the country's largest city gas company that sells CNG to automobiles and piped natural gas (PNG) to households and industries in Delhi and adjoining cities.

However, there was no revision in the rates of piped natural gas used by household kitchens for cooking.

The fourth increase in rates since May 15 took the cumulative increase in CNG prices to Rs 6 per kg. The prices were last increased by Rs 1 per kg on May 23. Prices had gone up by Rs 2 per kg on May 15 and by Re 1 on May 18.

In Mumbai, where rates were last revised on May 14, CNG costs Rs 84 per kg.

The CNG price hike in the national capital came just as state-owned fuel retailers started delayed passing on the impact of higher international oil prices to consumers. Petrol price has been increased by Rs 7.35 per litre and diesel by Rs 7.53 in four instalments.

Rates of petrol and diesel, as well as CNG, vary from state to state depending on the incidence of VAT. Continued on P4

India strongly objects to references to J&K in China-Pak joint statement

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday strongly rejected references to Jammu and Kashmir in a recent joint statement issued by China and Pakistan, saying the remarks were unwarranted and reiterating that Jammu and Kashmir, along with Ladakh, remain an inseparable part of India.

Responding to media queries, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India's position on the matter has been clear and consistently communicated to all concerned parties.

"India categorically rejects unwarranted references to the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir in the Joint Statement between China and Pakistan," Jaiswal said.

The statement in question was released during Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's recent visit to China.

Reasserting New Delhi's position, Jaiswal said, "The Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh have been, are and will always remain integral and inalienable parts of India. No other country has the locus standi to comment on the same."

India also objected to references in the joint statement concerning projects linked to the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC), parts of which pass through Pakistan-Occupied Kashmir, territory claimed by India.

Jaiswal said New Delhi firmly opposes any attempt by foreign countries Continued on P4

> The statement in question was released during Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's recent visit to China

STUDENTS REPORT PAYMENT FAILURES, ACCESS ISSUES, BLURRED ANSWER SHEET UPLOADS

CBSE rubbishes OSM portal hacking claim

Parl panel summons Education Ministry officials, CBSE chief on Jun 2 to review NEET, OSM

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Tuesday rejected social media claims that its On-Screen Marking (OSM) system had been hacked, even as scrutiny over the board's digital examination and post-result systems widened, with a parliamentary panel summoning top education officials, technical experts beginning an audit of recent glitches, and the Union education minister pushing for a major overhaul of payment infrastructure used by students.

In a statement posted on X, CBSE said claims that its evaluation platform had been compromised were based on confusion over a testing portal, not the actual system used for assessing answer books. The clarification came after a social media user identifying himself as a cybersecurity researcher claimed he had accessed vulnerabilities in what he described as the board's OSM portal.

The board said the URL cited in the claims, cbse.onmarks.co.in, was only a testing site containing sample data for internal review and not the live evaluation platform.

"The portal used for evaluation of answer-books bore a different URL, which has neither been compromised nor does it have the vulnerabilities indicated," CBSE said.

It added that no real evaluation data, marks or related records were stored on the testing site and that no security breach had been detected.

The controversy began after a user named Nisarga posted on X on May 22, claiming he had hacked CBSE's OSM platform in February and Continued on P4

KEY POINTS

- Board said alleged hacked portal was only an internal testing site
- CBSE said no actual marks or evaluation data were compromised
- Social media user claimed vulnerabilities allowed access to examiner accounts
- User alleged marks and examiner details could be altered

TEAM EXAMINING SOFTWARE FAILURE, PAYMENT ISSUES, POSSIBLE CYBER ATTACK ANGLES

HC: NO INTERIM ORDER NEEDED AT PRESENT

No forceful eviction of Gymkhana Club by June 5: Centre to HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Giving Delhi Gymkhana Club members a breather, the Delhi High Court on Tuesday took note of the Centre's submission that it would not take forceful possession of the colonial era club by June 5 and said no interim order was needed at the moment.

Justice Avneesh Jhingan also refused to interfere at this stage with the Centre's decision to terminate the perpetual lease of the 27.3 acre plot of the club in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi and posted the matter for end of July.

The court proceedings have given Gymkhana members a reprieve at least till July end -- when the Centre will file its response to the petition and the petitioner the rejoinder to the government's reply.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who appeared for the Central government, said eviction proceedings will only be initiated in accordance with law and after giving due notice.

"June 5 is the date of which we have given an option to the lessee to vacate on its own. Unlike the popular belief, which is going rounds in media circles, it not that the police will rush in and forcible possession will be taken over. It will have to be taken over in accordance with the procedure established by law," he submitted.

"Taking into account the summons issued and the statement made by the solicitor general, no further interim directions are called for"

Mehta added that compensation in this case can either be in terms of money or the government can offer an alternative land.

On May 22, an order issued by the Land and Development Office (L&DO) under the Union Housing and Urban Affairs Ministry asked DGC to return its land by June 5 on grounds of "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure".

The court observed on Tuesday that at this stage, there was nothing on record to suggest that authorities had initiated legal action for eviction and therefore no interim order was required on the lawsuits by Gymkhana members and staff.

"The issue (of eviction) is premature and presumptive. If need so arises, the plaintiffs can avail their remedies in accordance with the law," Justice Jhingan stated.

"Taking into account the summons issued and the statement made by the solicitor general, no further interim directions are called for. The statement is to the effect that for eviction, if so to be done, will be in accordance with law with prior notice," he added.

The court also issued summons to the Centre and the club's management on the lawsuits by the Gymkhana members, the staff as well as the last elected governing body, and sought written statements from the defendants within eight weeks.

It dispelled the plaintiffs' apprehension that DGC's governing body, which comprises nominees of the Centre, might be "hand-in-glove" with the authorities and could, therefore, hand over possession.

Gymkhana members told the Delhi High Court that the Centre's move to terminate the club's 1928 perpetual lease lacked genuine public purpose and amounted to forced eviction. The Centre denied any forcible takeover, saying any action would follow due legal process.

Delhi Police on high alert ahead of Eid-ul-Azha

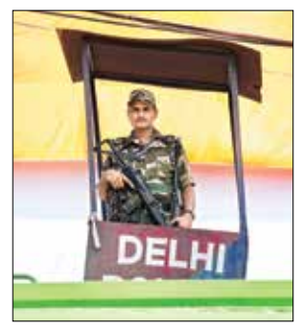
OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Police in Delhi are on high alert ahead of the Eid-ul-Azha celebrations on May 28, with elaborate security arrangements made across all districts, particularly in sensitive areas, officials said on Tuesday.

Intensified patrolling, flag marches and strict monitoring of social media platforms will be conducted to prevent the circulation of videos of animal sacrifice or any provocative content that may disturb communal harmony, they said.

Police personnel, including additional forces, have been deployed at strategic locations, while district units have been directed to maintain round-the-clock vigil and strengthen coordination with community leaders and mosque committees.

"Special teams are monitoring social media platforms to ensure that no objectionable posts, rumours, inflammatory messages or videos of sacrifice are uploaded or circulated online. Strict action will be taken against those found trying to disturb peace through social media," a senior police officer said.



'District police have been directed to maintain a strong vigil, ensure regular patrolling...': Officer

According to police, cyber teams have been tasked with conducting surveillance on various social media platforms and messaging applications during the festival period.

Authorities have also appealed to people not to perform animal sacrifice in open public places and to follow all lawful guidelines issued by civic and government agencies.

In northeast Delhi, a coordination meeting was chaired by Joint Commissioner of Police (Eastern Range) Ajit Kumar Singla and attended by imams, members of Aman Committees, Nagrik Bhaichara Samitis, civic officials and other stakeholders. During the meeting, police urged them to maintain communal harmony, ensure proper disposal of waste and refrain from posting objectionable or provocative content online. Similar meetings were organised in other districts as part of confidence-building measures ahead of the festival.

In Dwarka, Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP) Kushal Pal Singh chaired a meeting attended by over 150 mosque imams and community representatives, along with ACPs and SHOs.

During the meeting, police discussed arrangements related to law and order, crowd management, traffic regulation and public safety during the celebrations.

Senior officers appealed to the community leaders to cooperate with police, avoid spreading rumours or misinformation and promote peace and brotherhood during the festival.x"District police have been directed to maintain a strong vigil, ensure regular patrolling and remain in close coordination with local representatives to prevent any untoward incident," an officer said. Delhi Police intensified patrolling and surveillance in crowded markets and sensitive areas ahead of Eid-ul-Azha, while residents were urged to report suspicious activity. A flag march will also be conducted near New Delhi railway station to reassure the public and maintain peace.

Delhi government forms teams to oversee sale, sacrifice of animals

NEW DELHI: Ahead of Eid-al-Adha, the Delhi government has constituted rapid response teams across all 13 districts to monitor the transportation, sale and sacrifice of animals and ensure compliance with animal welfare rules. Formed under the Animal Husbandry Unit on the directions of Minister Kapil Mishra, the teams on Tuesday conducted inspections in several parts of the city, including North-West, North-East, Central and West Delhi.

The government said no illegal sacrifice would be permitted during Bakrid and the sale or purchase of animals at public places was prohibited. Sacrifices can only be conducted at authorised locations and not on roads or lanes. The advisory also bans the sacrifice of cows, calves, camels and other prohibited animals. Authorities have asked residents to report violations to the police or PCR. MPOST

Juvenile plots revenge killing, watchman run over twice

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A juvenile, nursing a grudge over a month-old altercation, allegedly conspired with his associates to brutally murder a 60-year-old security guard by assaulting him with a stick and then running him over twice with an SUV in outer Delhi's Peeragarhi area, police said on Tuesday.

Police have arrested two men and apprehended two juveniles, including the alleged mastermind for murdering the security guard.

"The accused allegedly killed the guard to avenge a month-old altercation in which the victim had abused one of the juveniles," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Outer) Vikram Singh said.

According to police, the incident took place in the early hours of May 24 near the tempo stand at the entry gate of Peeragarhi village.

Police received a PCR call around 4.03 am regarding a fatal accident near Shri Shidh Baba Mandir. A police team reached the spot and found the victim, identified as Bijender Bharadwaj (60), lying unconscious with severe blunt and crushed injuries. He was declared dead at the scene.

During preliminary enquiry, police learnt that Bharadwaj worked as a guard at the tempo stand. Investigators noticed multiple skid marks at the scene, which raised suspicion about the nature of the incident. CCTV footage collected from cameras near a temple allegedly showed the accused first assaulting the victim with a stick before mowing him down with a vehicle, police said.

Police analysed footage from over 200 CCTV cameras before arresting two men and apprehending two juveniles in the Paschim Vihar murder case. Investigators said the accused allegedly plotted the killing over a month-old altercation and used an SUV to run over the victim.

Cops bust fake Parivahan website scam, 1 nabbed

NEW DELHI: The Cyber Cell of Delhi Police has arrested a 24-year-old MCA degree holder for allegedly developing and managing a fake website, "parivahan.online", used to cheat people across India. The accused, identified as Anshul Yadav from Etawah in Uttar Pradesh, allegedly created portals resembling official government transport service websites to dupe users seeking vehicle number plate bookings and other online services.

The case surfaced after a complainant reported being cheated through the fake portal while searching online for number plate booking services. Believing the website to be genuine, he paid Rs 1,099 and was later asked to make additional payments on various pretexts.

Following a complaint on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, police registered an FIR and launched an investigation involving technical analysis, financial scrutiny and digital surveillance. Investigators traced the fraudulent domain and financial transactions to Yadav. Police recovered two laptops, mobile phones, source files and login credentials. Further investigation is underway. MPOST

Newlywed jumps to death from 4th floor

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 25-year-old newlywed allegedly died by suicide by jumping from the fourth floor of a building in northeast Delhi's Mustafabad area, with her family accusing her husband and in-laws of dowry harassment, police said on Tuesday.

According to the police, the incident took place on Monday. The woman was rushed to a hospital, where doctors declared her dead.

Preliminary inquiry revealed that the woman had married the man of her choice around three months ago. Her family alleged that about a month after the marriage, the husband and his family began demanding gold and cash.

Family members of the girl alleged that the woman was being mentally harassed over the demands and had been under severe stress for the past few weeks. A police officer who confirmed the incident said legal action is being taken and further investigation into the matter is underway.

Newly married woman found dead in Noida, family alleges dowry harassment by husband and in-laws

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: A 22-year-old newly married woman was found dead under suspicious circumstances at her rented accommodation in Noida's Sector 63 area on Monday evening, with her family alleging dowry harassment and accusing her husband and in-laws of murder, police said.

The deceased, identified as Pooja, had married Abhishek Pal, a native of Kasganj district, around six months ago.

Police: 'Abhishek had left for work on Monday morning. When he returned home in the evening, he allegedly found Pooja hanging from a ceiling fan inside the room'

Abhishek works for a private company in Noida and the couple had been living in a rented house in a colony near Chhijarsi under the limits of Sector 63 police station.

Police officials said Abhishek had left for work on Monday morning. When he returned home in the evening, he allegedly found Pooja hanging from a ceiling fan inside the room. The police were informed and the body was sent for post-mortem examination.

After arriving in Noida on Tuesday, the woman's family alleged that Abhishek and his relatives had been demanding additional dowry after the marriage. They claimed that Pooja was subjected to mental and physical harassment as their demands were not met.

Based on the family's complaint, police have registered a case and launched an investigation. Officials said statements of family members are being recorded and further action will be taken after the post-mortem report and findings of the probe.

Police said all angles, including suicide and dowry death, are being examined.

2020 RIOTS: Court acquits 3, finds key prosecution witness unreliable

NEW DELHI: A court here has acquitted three men in a case related to the 2020 North East Delhi riots, saying that it found the testimony of the prosecution's key witness unreliable and riddled with contradictions.

Additional Sessions Judge Parveen Singh was hearing the case against Vinay, Rahul and Sourabh Sharma who were accused of assaulting and looting a man during the riots in Karawal Nagar in February 2020.

Several other accused in the case have already been discharged earlier.

In an order dated May 22, the court said, "Prosecution Witness (ASI Pratap Singh) is not found to be a credible witness and through his testimony, the prosecution has failed to prove its case against the accused persons. All the accused are accordingly acquitted of all the charges framed against them".

'Prosecution Witness is not found to be a credible witness and through his testimony, the prosecution has failed to prove its case against accused'

According to the prosecution, complainant Hamid Ali alleged that on February 24, 2020, his son Jafar Zia was returning home on a motorcycle when 20-25 rioters allegedly attacked him near a Karawal Nagar check post, assaulted him with weapons, looted cash and documents, and damaged his motorcycle.

The chargesheet claimed that the accused were identified during the investigation through disclosures, recoveries and CCTV footage.

During the trial, however, the injured witness failed to identify the accused and stated that the attackers had covered their faces.

The court noted that the entire case regarding identification of the accused ultimately rested on the testimony of ASI Pratap Singh, but found major inconsistencies between his version and that of the victim.

The judge said that while the victim said all assailants had covered their faces and never mentioned police intervention at the scene, the officer claimed he had seen some attackers without face coverings and chased them away.

The court noted contradictions in the investigation and acquitted all accused, saying the prosecution failed to prove guilt beyond reasonable doubt. PTI

Thieves decamp with cash and jewellery from DRDO scientist's home

NEW DELHI: A burglary has been reported at the residential complex of the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) in north Delhi, where thieves allegedly decamped with jewellery, cash and other valuables worth several lakhs of rupees from the flat of a woman scientist, police said on Tuesday. The incident took place inside the high-security complex in the Timarpur area.

According to police, the scientist had left for Chandigarh on May 15 to meet her family. When she returned on May 23, she found the house ransacked and valuables missing.

The stolen items included Rs 15,000 in cash, foreign currency, jewellery, including a necklace set with earrings, bangles, chains, and rings, among others, and three watches.

The exact value of the stolen items is being assessed, though it is estimated to run into several lakhs of rupees. Police have registered a case at Timarpur police station and launched an investigation. Crime and forensic teams inspected the spot, while CCTV footage is being analysed. Investigators suspect the accused conducted a recce. MPOST

23 rescued, two hurt in blaze at Rohini residential building

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Twenty-three people were rescued while two sustained injuries after a fire broke out in a four-storey residential building in Delhi's Rohini area on Tuesday morning, with dramatic visuals showing residents trapped on balconies amid thick smoke and firefighters carrying out rescue operations using ladders. The Delhi Fire Services (DFS) said it received a call regarding the blaze at 7.06 am from a building located on Shamshan Ghat Road in Vijay Vihar Phase-2.

The fire broke out on the ground floor of the building where 18 electricity meters and six vehicles — three scooties, two motorcycles and one bicycle — were engulfed in flames, a DFS official said.

The blaze triggered panic among residents as thick smoke rapidly spread through the building, trapping several people inside their homes and balconies.

In one of the videos from the scene, a man standing on the second-floor balcony was seen attempting to climb down using a rope amid panic caused by the smoke and flames. However, DFS personnel asked him to stop and assured him of a safer rescue operation.

Firefighters later placed a ladder against the building and safely evacuated the three people stranded on the balcony.

Other videos captured sparks continuously shooting out from the area where the fire had erupted, resembling bursting firecrackers, while flames and dense smoke billowed from the electricity meter section on the ground floor.

Panic-stricken residents were heard shouting for help as firefighters simultaneously conducted evacuation and firefighting operations.

The fire was completely doused by 8 am. DFS said 22 people were rescued by fire personnel, while one person was rescued by locals before the arrival of the fire department.

Two people sustained injuries in the incident and were shifted to Jaipur Golden Hospital for treatment.

Khari Baoli: 800 kg spurious spices seized

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police has busted an adulterated spice manufacturing unit in Old Delhi's Khari Baoli and arrested a 31-year-old man allegedly involved in the illegal operation, officials said on Tuesday. Around 801.88 kg of spurious spices and raw materials were seized during the raid conducted on May 23 at a premises in Naya Bans area.

Police said the unit used low-grade substances, artificial colours, rice fragments, chilli stalks and other adulterants to prepare fake turmeric, chilli, coriander, amchoor and garam masala powders, allegedly supplied across Delhi-NCR. Spice grinding machinery was also seized. Food safety department officials collected samples for laboratory testing and further action under food safety laws. A case has been registered under relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. MPOST

WOMEN MAKE UP 59% OF KVIC SKILL TRAINEES IN 2025-26

Khadi and village industries sales rise over sixfold in 12 yrs

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) has recorded its highest-ever annual turnover, with sales of Khadi and village industry products crossing Rs 1.87 lakh crore in the financial year 2025-26, according to provisional figures released by the Commission on Monday.

The achievement marks a major milestone for the rural economy and reflects a fivefold rise in production and more than sixfold growth in sales over the past 12 years.

Releasing the provisional data at Gandhi Darshan in New Delhi, KVIC Chairman Manoj Kumar attributed the sector's growth to the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and initiatives such as 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat', 'Vocal for Local' and 'Local to Global'.

He said Khadi had evolved from being a traditional product into a symbol of self-reliance, indigenous pride and rural prosperity in "New India".

According to the data, production of Khadi and village industry products rose from Rs 26,109 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 1,25,296 crore in 2025-26, registering a growth of around 380 per cent.

Sales increased from Rs 31,154 crore to Rs 1,87,105 crore during the same period, reflecting a growth of 501 per cent. The Commission also reported substantial gains in employment generation. Total employment linked to Khadi and village industries increased from 1.30 crore in 2013-14 to 2.04 crore in 2025-26, marking a rise of 56 per cent. Nearly 1.99 crore jobs were generated within the village industries sector alone.

The Khadi textiles segment also witnessed sharp growth, with production increasing from Rs 811 crore in 2013-14 to Rs 3,974 crore in 2025-26, while sales climbed from Rs 1,081 crore to Rs 7,869 crore.

In the village industries sector, sales surged to Rs 1,79,236 crore from Rs 30,073 crore over the same period.

Under the Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP), 66,494 new units were established during 2025-26. KVIC also highlighted its focus on women's empowerment, stating that women accounted for nearly 59 per cent of trainees under various skill development programmes during the year.

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PLANS CBDC-BASED DIGITAL RATION SYSTEM

Delhi hikes ration eligibility to ₹2.5L

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major welfare push aimed at strengthening food security and modernising ration distribution, the Rekha Gupta-led Delhi government has approved a sharp increase in the annual income eligibility limit for ration cards while also announcing plans to introduce a Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC/e₹)-based Public Distribution System (PDS). The twin decisions are expected to benefit lakhs of low-income families across the national capital and bring greater transparency to subsidy delivery.

Under the Cabinet-approved proposal, the annual family income ceiling for availing ration benefits under the Priority Household (PHH) category has been raised from Rs 1.20 lakh to Rs 2.5 lakh. The move is aimed at ensuring that economically vulnerable families are not excluded from subsidised foodgrain schemes because of outdated income thresholds.

Announcing the decision, Food and Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the previous limit no longer matched Delhi's rising cost of living. "Earlier, the income eligibility for ration cards was very low. In today's times, even an annual income of Rs 1 lakh is below the level of minimum wages for a family. Keeping this in mind, the Rekha Gupta led Delhi government has increased the income limit to Rs 2.5 lakh so that more deserving families can avail the benefits of subsidised ration under the PDS system," he said. The government said the revision would help families dependent on informal sector jobs such as domestic work, construction, transport and street vending, many of whom were earlier left out despite economic hardship.

Under the Cabinet-approved proposal, the annual family income ceiling for availing ration benefits under the Priority Household (PHH) category has been raised from Rs 1.20 lakh to Rs 2.5 lakh

Delhi currently has around 64.93 lakh beneficiaries covered under NFSA and PMGKAY through nearly 15.46 lakh ration cards and 1,943 Fair Price Shops linked with e-PoS systems.

The government also announced plans to gradually roll out a CBDC-based ration distribution model. Under the proposed system, subsidy amounts equivalent to entitled foodgrains would be credited directly into beneficiaries' CBDC wallets, which can then be used at authorised ration shops. Sirsa said, "The Delhi government under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta is also working towards implementing a CBDC-enabled ration distribution mechanism. Under this system, financial assistance for ration will be directly deposited into beneficiaries' accounts, enabling them to purchase ration as needed through digital currency at ration shops."

Officials said the digital model would improve transparency, create stronger audit trails, reduce leakages and provide beneficiaries with greater flexibility and traceable transactions.

Air quality plan gets deadline-driven push

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a detailed high-level review of Delhi's air pollution mitigation strategy, Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav on Tuesday set strict timelines for multiple departments and agencies to accelerate implementation of key measures aimed at improving air quality before the onset of the winter season.

The meeting was held with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and senior officials of the Delhi Government, and was also attended by ministers Parvesh Sahib Singh and Manjinder Singh Sirsa, along with representatives from central and state pollution control bodies, civic agencies and transport authorities.

A major focus of the review was road dust mitigation. The Minister directed that pending road redevelopment and dust control works be completed by October 2026. He also called for intensified mechanised road sweeping, expansion of green cover along major roads, and identification of vacant patches for plantation drives to reduce dust pollution.

On transport reforms, the Centre pushed for faster deployment of electric buses, expansion of EV charging infrastructure, and improved metro connectivity with last-mile integration. The Minister also urged installation of Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR) cameras at all border entry points by September 2026 to strengthen enforcement against polluting vehicles entering Delhi.

In addition, he recommended the identification of 15 signal-free traffic corridors by September 2026 to reduce congestion and vehicular emissions, along with faster expansion of parking infrastructure and stricter action on end-of-life vehicles. He also emphasised boosting fitness testing capacity for commercial vehicles.

On industrial pollution, Yadav directed strict monitoring of Online Continuous Emission Monitoring Systems (OCEMS) and Air Pollution Control Devices (APCDs), ensuring real-time data flow to CPCB servers. He also called for strict enforcement action, including sealing of non-compliant units where required, and intensified inspections in non-conforming industrial areas.

Construction and demolition waste management was another key area of concern. The Minister flagged a gap of nearly 1,000 tonnes per day in processing capacity and asked agencies to augment facilities by December 2026. He also directed monthly inspections of construction sites and geo-tagging of C&D waste transport vehicles by July 2026.

On municipal waste, he stressed timely completion of legacy waste clearance, expansion of processing capacity by September 2026, and commissioning of waste-to-energy plants within fixed timelines. He also reiterated a zero-tolerance approach to open waste burning during winter months and urged RWAs to support workers with heating arrangements to discourage such practices.

The Minister further highlighted the need for stronger IEC campaigns under the CAQM framework, promotion of green crematoriums at all identified sites, and intensified greening drives after the monsoon to tackle accumulated dust.

Emphasising accountability, Bhupender Yadav said, "The coming months are crucial for Delhi's air quality management. Timely completion of planned interventions, strict enforcement and coordinated action on the ground are essential to protect public health and improve the quality of life for citizens."

Govt eyes ₹13L support for children with disabilities

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is working on a major health insurance proposal that could provide financial assistance of up to Rs 13 lakh for children with disabilities, aiming to ease the heavy medical burden faced by thousands of families across the Capital.

According to officials, the proposal is currently under examination at various administrative levels and is expected to be placed before the Delhi Cabinet soon. The scheme is being designed to cover expenses related to surgeries, hospital treatment, specialised medical procedures, therapies and assistive equipment required for children with special needs.

The proposal is expected to be placed before the Cabinet soon

Officials said the initiative is intended to ensure that no child is deprived of quality healthcare because of financial limitations. Families of children with developmental disorders, physical disabilities and chronic medical conditions often spend several lakhs on long-term treatment and rehabilitation. The government is also considering linking the scheme with empanelled hospitals and rehabilitation centres to provide smoother access to specialised healthcare services.

Spl heat ward at LNJP Hosp

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Singh on Tuesday reviewed heatwave preparedness at Lok Nayak Jai Prakash (LNJP) Hospital and said a dedicated ward for heat-related illnesses has been set up to handle patients suffering from heatstroke and related conditions.

During his visit to the hospital, Singh inspected emergency arrangements, ICU preparedness, special wards and patient care facilities amid rising temperatures in the national capital.

The minister said the Delhi government and the health department were closely monitoring the situation to ensure citizens do not face difficulties during the ongoing heatwave.

"Delhi's health system is fully prepared to deal with heatwave-related emergencies. Our priority is to ensure that no citizen faces any difficulty during this extreme weather," Singh said.

According to the minister, the dedicated "Heat Related Illness" ward at LNJP Hospital has been equipped with ICU support, emergency care facilities, specialised treatment spaces and recovery beds for patients suffering from dehydration, heat exhaustion and other heat-related complications.

He said patients with severe symptoms, including high body temperature and multiple complications, were being provided immediate treatment and shifted to ICU support whenever required.

Singh also said sufficient beds, ICU facilities and emergency systems had been kept ready to handle any rise in patient load due to the heatwave.

Referring to a recent case, the minister said some patients had reached hospitals with extremely high body temperatures and severe heat distress, but timely medical intervention and ventilator support helped in their recovery.

He added that heatwave preparedness measures had been implemented across Delhi's government hospitals, polyclinics and Ayushman Arogya Mandirs.

The minister said mobile relief units had also been deployed at various locations to provide ORS, cold drinking water and emergency support services to people affected by the heat.

Singh urged residents to avoid prolonged exposure to sunlight and seek immediate medical attention if they experience dehydration, dizziness, weakness, fever or other heat-related symptoms.

Karol Bagh Zone receives ISO Certification for civic services

NEW DELHI: The Karol Bagh Zone of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi has received ISO Certification for its sanitation standards, waste management systems and civic service delivery, officials said on Tuesday.

According to the civic body, the certification recognises the Zone's efforts in maintaining cleanliness, improving operational efficiency and adopting sustainable urban management practices across the area.

MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar credited sanitation workers, field staff, officers and residents for contributing towards the achievement. He said the certification reflected the Zone's commitment to strengthening public service delivery and improving civic infrastructure for residents. MPOST

Barapullah P-III flyover to be ready by end of June: Minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Enabling seamless connectivity between east and south Delhi, the Phase III section of the Barapullah flyover is likely to be ready for public use by end of June, Delhi PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said on Tuesday.

Singh along with PWD officials conducted an inspection of the ongoing works to review the progress.

"Visited the Barapullah Phase-III site again today and reviewed the final stage of work. After remaining delayed for years, the project is now close to completion. We are committed to opening it by June 30," the minister said.

The Barapullah Phase-III has been under construction since 2015 and has witnessed several cost escalations and missed deadlines.

Sanctioned in 2015 and initially estimated at Rs 1,260.63 crore, the project has already seen expenditure of Rs 1,238.68 crore, and is expected to cost around Rs 1,500 crore for completion.

The project envisages seamless connectivity between Mayur Vihar-I in east Delhi and AIIMS, on signal-free carriageways.

The new flyover will merge with the existing Barapullah flyover at Sarai Kale Khan, completing a stretch of around 9 km.

"Since coming to power, we have worked to clear every hurdle, every pending approval and every NOC so that the work does not stop. The entire focus is on timely completion and delivering relief to people of Delhi," the PWD minister said.

The project is set to become a landmark in urban infrastructure development, the minister said. "For the first time in India, a flyover corridor has been designed with a dedicated cycle-track, promoting greener and more sustainable mobility for Delhiites."

According to officials, another highlight of the project is the bridge structure over the Yamuna floodplain.

SPECIAL EVENT AT DELHI ASSEMBLY ON MAY 28

LS Speaker Om Birla to launch Vidhan-Chetna

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla will launch the Delhi Legislative Assembly's quarterly journal Vidhan-Chetna along with the release of a comprehensive 89-volume compilation of the Central Legislative Assembly proceedings (1924–1930), in a special event scheduled for May 28 at the Delhi Assembly.

The initiative, led under the chairmanship of Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta, is being described as a major step toward preserving India's parliamentary heritage while encouraging contemporary legislative discourse.

The event will also see the presence of Union Minister for Parliamentary Affairs Kiren Rijiju as the Guest of Honour, along with Delhi Minister for Legislative Affairs Parvesh Sahib Singh, Deputy Speaker Mohan Singh Bisht, MLAs, academicians, historians and Delhi University faculty members.

According to the Assembly Secretariat, the archival release documents key debates and legislative discussions from the pre-Independence era, covering a crucial phase of India's political evolution between 1924 and 1930.

The journal *Vidhan-Chetna* is intended to serve as a platform for research and discussion on constitutional governance, legislative reforms and democratic practices, linking historical context with present-day policymaking.

Speaking about the initiative, the Assembly Secretariat said the dual launch reflects an effort to "bridge India's rich parliamentary legacy with its contemporary democratic journey" and promote deeper academic engagement with legislative history. Officials added that the 89-volume archive preserves important proceedings of early Indian lawmakers, offering scholars and policymakers insight into foundational debates that shaped the country's democratic framework.

The event is expected to bring together key constitutional leaders and academic experts, highlighting Delhi Assembly's initiative to strengthen institutional memory and promote informed democratic dialogue.

Deputy Mayor reviews civic infra in Preet Vihar Ward

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Deputy Mayor of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), Dr. Monika Pant, on Tuesday conducted an inspection of Preet Vihar Ward to review sanitation arrangements, civic amenities, and the progress of ongoing development works in the area.

The inspection was attended by local Councillor Ramesh Garg, Shahdara South Zone Deputy Commissioner Wairokpam Punshiba Singh, and other senior civic officials. During the visit, the Deputy Mayor inspected several residential colonies and public spaces to assess the condition of roads, sanitation facilities, drain cleaning operations, parks, street lighting, and other civic infrastructure. Dr. Pant also interacted with residents and took note of their grievances and suggestions regarding local issues.

MEETINGS WITH FOREIGN MINISTERS OF AUSTRALIA, JAPAN

PM Modi reaffirms stability and prosperity in Indo-Pacific

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India and Australia will continue to work for a free, open, secure and prosperous Indo-Pacific, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Tuesday after he held discussions with Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong on the Comprehensive Strategic Partnership between the two countries.

Prime Minister Modi also met Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi and reaffirmed the vital role of the India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership in advancing peace, stability and prosperity across the Indo-Pacific and beyond.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi interacts with Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong during a meeting, in New Delhi PTI

Earlier in the day, India hosted the Quad foreign ministers' meeting here, chaired by External Affairs minister S Jaishankar, which was attended by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Australian Foreign Minister Wong and Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi.

"Happy to receive Senator Penny Wong, Minister for Foreign Affairs of Australia. We discussed the growing India-Australia Comprehensive Strategic Partnership in areas such as defence, trade, technology and ensuring supply chain resilience. India and Australia will continue to work for a free, open, secure and prosperous Indo-Pacific," Modi posted on X.

In another post, Modi said, "Delighted to receive Mr Toshimitsu Motegi, Minister for Foreign Affairs of Japan. Reaffirmed the vital role of the India-Japan Special Strategic and Global Partnership in advancing peace, stability and prosperity across the Indo-Pacific and beyond."

Seeking to inject fresh momentum into the grouping, the Quad on Tuesday announced energy security and critical minerals frameworks to mitigate supply chain disruptions and unveiled major measures to upgrade maritime surveillance and port infrastructure across the Indo-Pacific.

Preparing for 2027 Assembly polls, BJP retains rural power centres

UP appoints outgoing Gram Pradhans as administrators

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: With the Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections approaching, the BJP government has moved to retain its grassroots political network by appointing outgoing gram pradhans as administrators of village Panchayats for the next six months.

The decision, approved by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, is being viewed as politically significant as it allows elected village heads to continue exercising influence in rural areas ahead of the crucial 2027 Assembly polls.

An order issued by Principal Secretary Panchayati Raj Anil Kumar on the directions of Panchayati Raj Minister Om Prakash Rajbhar said outgoing gram pradhans would take charge as administrators after their tenure ends on Tuesday.

> The move will affect all 57,694 Gram Panchayats in state

The move will affect all 57,694 Gram Panchayats in the state. District magistrates have been authorised to nominate outgoing village heads as administrators from Wednesday to ensure continuity in routine administration and development work.

The decision departs from the earlier practice of appointing Assistant Development Officers (Panchayat) as administrators after the expiry of Panchayat tenures. By retaining elected gram pradhans instead of bureaucratic officials, the government has ensured that local political structures remain active ahead of the Assembly elections.

Political observers say gram pradhans play a crucial role in shaping rural opinion through welfare schemes, caste equations and local mobilisation. Allowing them to continue in administrative positions is expected to help the BJP maintain its reach in villages where electoral contests are often decided by local networks. The government's move also comes amid uncertainty over the timing of Panchayat elections. The state cabinet recently approved the formation of a dedicated backward classes commission to finalise OBC reservation in the three-tier Panchayat polls.

From Page 1

Govt sets up

the country due to illegal immigration and other unusual factors, examine their causes, and suggest suitable policy, legislative, and administrative interventions, a government statement said.

According to the Terms of Reference of the committee, it will comprehensively deliberate upon the challenges arising from demographic changes, including illegal immigration.

It will study the possible causes of demographic changes, such as cross-border activities (including illegal immigration), economic opportunities, and other socio-environmental factors, the statement said.

The panel will also identify the underlying factors behind these changes, which include illegal immigration, abnormal settlement patterns, and orchestrated migration, it said.

Further, the committee will analyse structural population changes at the level of religious or social communities, particularly where they deviate from broader trends.

It will recommend a streamlined and permanent operational mechanism for the legal, fair, and time-bound identification, detention, and deportation of illegal immigrants already residing in the country, the statement said.

The committee will also suggest an appropriate institutional mechanism to strengthen border management, population stabilisation, and identification systems for the continuous monitoring of such trends, it said.

In addition, it will propose a comprehensive policy framework to enhance coordination between the central and state governments on matters related to illegal immigration and the resulting demographic imbalances.

Quad eyes

Additional Secretary in the Ministry of External Affairs K Nagaraj Naidu said the ministers reviewed progress across the grouping's agenda and discussed regional and global developments affecting the Indo-Pacific. He said discussions were structured around four pillars: maritime and transnational security, economic prosperity and security, critical and emerging technologies, and humanitarian assistance and disaster response.

A key announcement was the launch of an Indo-Pacific maritime surveillance collaboration aimed at strengthening maritime monitoring and coordination. The Quad also decided to enhance coordination under the Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness, with member countries working toward a common operating picture for improved maritime oversight.

India will host the next Quad-at-Sea Ship Observer Mission, intended to improve interoperability in responding to illegal maritime activities. Australia is set to host an exercise in June 2026 focused on combating state-sponsored terrorist attacks and unmanned aerial vehicle threats.

Rubio said the grouping intends to become "a partnership of action" rather than a forum for periodic discussion. Highlighting the strategic importance of the region, he noted that nearly 60 per cent of global maritime trade passes through the Indo-Pacific.

The foreign ministers also announced a new energy security initiative aimed at reducing risks from supply disruptions, especially as concerns grow around instability in global energy routes. The Quad stressed the need for uninterrupted commercial movement through the Strait of Hormuz, a crucial route through which roughly one-fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas supplies transit.

The joint statement opposed measures that could obstruct shipping for commercial purposes and called for open and transparent energy markets. The countries said reliable energy trade was essential not only for economic stability but also for the resilience of vulnerable Indo-Pacific nations, including developing countries and Pacific island states.

As part of this effort, the Quad will convene a Fuel Security Forum for senior-level discussions and cooperation on strengthening energy resilience. The grouping said countries producing, transporting and consuming energy should maintain transparent markets and work together during disruptions.

On economic resilience, the Quad launched a Critical Minerals Framework designed to diversify supply chains in mining, processing and recycling. The initiative includes plans to mobilise up to USD 20 billion in public and private capital.

The move comes amid growing concern over dependence on concentrated supply sources. China currently accounts for about 70 per cent of global rare earth mining and remains a dominant force in the critical minerals market, which is essential for electric vehicles, drones, batteries and advanced technologies.

Without naming China directly in the minerals framework, the Quad expressed "grave concerns" over economic coercion, arbitrary export restrictions, price manipulation and supply disruptions affecting global industrial sectors.

The grouping said it would identify strategic projects involving companies headquartered in Quad countries or supplying Quad markets, and support them through export credit agencies, development finance institutions, private capital mobilisation, guarantees, loans, equity participation, insurance and subsidies.

Jaishankar said a significant part of the discussion focused on the broader global environment and the Indo-Pacific's growing strategic importance.

"In the coming days, whether it is economic activity, energy trade or maritime commerce, the Indo-Pacific will become even more important to the world," he said. He also said Quad members believe critical technologies and production capacities should be diversified to improve resilience.

The ministers also unveiled a new infrastructure initiative in the Pacific, with Fiji selected for the first port development project under the Quad Ports of the Future Partnership. Rubio described it as the first time Quad countries would jointly work on a port infrastructure project.

Wong called it the strongest commitment yet by the Quad to the Pacific, adding that the grouping was also stepping up action against illegal fishing, trafficking, scam centres in Southeast Asia and disaster response challenges.

On agriculture and technology, the Quad pledged more than USD 6 million for six international research initiatives aimed at improving food productivity and pest management through artificial intelligence, robotics and sensors.

Counter-terrorism remained a major theme. The ministers strongly condemned terrorism in all forms, including cross-border terrorism, and specifically referred to the Pahalgam terror attack and the Bondi Beach attack in Australia.

The joint statement called for sustained international action against proscribed terrorist groups, their sponsors, affiliates and financiers, in accordance with international law.

The Quad also voiced serious concerns over developments in the East and South China Seas, referring to dangerous manoeuvres, coercive behaviour and interference in offshore resource development, though China was not directly named in those remarks either.

Despite the wide-ranging announcements, uncertainty remains over the timing of the next Quad leaders' summit. India, as current chair, is expected to host it, but officials said no decision has yet been made.

Naidu said the day's announcements reflected the grouping's expanding operational agenda, describing the Quad as an increasingly action-oriented platform with growing regional responsibilities.

India-US

interests in ensuring reliable long-term access to critical minerals and supply chains that are important for our innovation economy," he said.

Critical minerals such as lithium, cobalt, nickel, graphite, and rare earth elements are central to the production of electric vehicle batteries, semiconductors, renewable energy infrastructure, drones, telecommunications systems, aerospace equipment, and military platforms.

The agreement comes at a time of rising global anxiety over supply chain vulnerabilities, especially because of China's dominant position in the sector. China accounts for around 70 per cent of global rare earth mining and nearly 90 per cent of rare earth processing capacity, giving it significant influence over industries dependent on these materials.

A US readout described the framework as a milestone in efforts to ensure foundational materials for advanced technologies and energy systems remain available within trusted networks. It said the two countries would work together internationally to protect sensitive supply chains from coercive market practices and reduce dependence on single-source monopolies.

Rubio said countries with advanced innovation-driven economies could not afford to leave access to essential materials vulnerable to external pressure.

The agreement builds on broader efforts by Washington and New Delhi to create secure technology and industrial supply chains. The groundwork for the latest framework was laid during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Washington in February last year, when critical minerals were identified as a strategic priority in bilateral discussions with President Donald Trump.

India's participation in the US-backed Pax Silica initiative has also added momentum to cooperation. Launched in December, Pax Silica aims to build secure and resilient supply chains for critical minerals and artificial intelligence-related industries.

The US said it is already backing critical mineral supply chain projects worth more than USD 30 billion through investments, loans, and private sector partnerships.

For India, the framework could help reduce import dependence as it pushes electric mobility, renewable energy expansion, and domestic manufacturing growth. Access to American investment and processing expertise may support exploration and downstream industrial development.

For Washington, India offers a trusted democratic partner with growing industrial strength and strategic importance in the Indo-Pacific.

As competition over technology and industrial resources sharpens globally, the India-US agreement signals that access to critical minerals is now being treated as both an economic necessity and a strategic security concern.

Frozen

joint US-Israeli strikes on Tehran, according to Tasnim news agency. The report said roughly $12 billion could be released in an initial phase if an agreement is announced.

A senior Iranian delegation, including Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and Central Bank Governor Abdolnaser Hemmati, travelled to Qatar for talks. Iranian state television later reported that Qalibaf and Araghchi had left Qatar, without offering details on what comes next.The diplomatic push comes against the backdrop of renewed military tension. Iran on Tuesday condemned the latest US strikes in southern Iran, calling them evidence of "bad faith and unreliability" at a sensitive moment in negotiations.

The US military described Monday's strikes as defensive, saying they targeted missile launch sites and minelaying boats, and said the action was carried out with restraint despite the tense environment.

Iran's foreign ministry rejected that explanation, calling the strikes a violation of the ceasefire and warning that Washington would bear responsibility for "all consequences."

"The Islamic Republic of Iran will leave no act of aggression unanswered," the ministry said.

Iran's Revolutionary Guard also said it had intercepted drones and a fighter jet that entered Iranian airspace, according to official media, though no timeline was provided. The ceasefire, in place since April 7, has largely held despite repeated tensions. Still, the latest confrontation has raised questions about whether negotiations can continue smoothly.

US President Donald Trump struck an optimistic note on Monday, saying the talks were "proceeding nicely." But developments on the ground suggest major disagreements remain unresolved.

Beyond the issue of frozen assets, negotiations are also centred on Iran's nuclear programme, its stockpile of highly enriched uranium, and Tehran's demand for the lifting of a US military blockade on Iranian ports imposed on April 17.

Another major pressure point is the Strait of Hormuz, the narrow but strategically critical waterway through which about one-fifth of the world's crude oil and natural gas moved before the conflict.

After the war began, Tehran effectively shut the strait, leaving hundreds of ships stranded and sending shockwaves through global markets. The disruption has extended beyond energy.

The UK Maritime Trade Operations Centre said an explosion was reported aboard a tanker in the Gulf of Oman on Tuesday. No injuries were reported, and the cause was not immediately known.The crisis is also affecting fertiliser supply chains, prompting concern over global food security.

UN Food and Agriculture Organization Director-General Qu Dongyu warned in Rome that the consequences could extend well beyond the region.

"What we are witnessing today is not only a geopolitical crisis. It is a systemic shock" to global agriculture and food systems, he said.

He warned that decisions taken now would determine whether the disruption remains manageable or develops into a deeper food security crisis in 2026 and 2027.

Inside Iran, authorities began restoring internet access after a months-long national shutdown introduced during wartime conditions. Internet users reported gradual reconnection on Tuesday. The shutdown is estimated to have cost Iran's economy between $30 million and $40 million a day.

Trump has also added a wider geopolitical dimension to the negotiations, suggesting any final deal should require more countries, including Saudi Arabia and Pakistan, to join the Abraham Accords, the US-backed normalisation agreements with Israel.

For now, with diplomacy continuing through intermediaries and military tensions still simmering, the path to a lasting agreement remains uncertain. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

CBSE

had reported vulnerabilities to the Indian Computer Emergency Response Team (CERT-In). In subsequent posts and media interviews, he alleged he could alter examiner details, including names, roll numbers and bank account information, and even interfere with student marks.

In a detailed online post, the user claimed the flaws included a leaked master password, weak authentication checks, bypass of OTP verification, password reset vulnerabilities and insecure access controls that could allow unauthorised actions across user accounts.CBSE rejected the allegations in relation to its operational system and said safeguards were in place to maintain the integrity of the evaluation process.

"The Board would like to state that this system has been implemented for enhanced transparency in assessments with strong grievance redressal mechanisms built into it," it said.

The hacking claims surfaced amid criticism over technical issues faced by students during the post-result verification and re-evaluation process for class 12 board exams.

Students and parents had reported payment failures, difficulty accessing the portal and complaints linked to answer sheet uploads. Some also alleged that uploaded answer sheets appeared blurred or did not match the handwriting of students.

To investigate the disruptions, a four-member technical team from IIT Madras and IIT Kanpur has begun examining the system.

IIT Madras Director V Kamakoti said the team started work on Monday evening and was looking into whether the failures were caused by software development problems, technical limitations or a cyber attack.

"There was an issue for around two days. So what was the actual reason for the failure? Was it some development issue, technical issue, or was it even a cyber attack? Because anything is possible," he said.

Kamakoti said the CBSE portal had remained stable for the last "72 hours-plus".

He said the review would include a close examination of how the board's website interacted with payment systems, identifying possible weak points in transaction handling and suggesting ways to prevent future failures.

The IIT team includes two experts from IIT Madras, one with experience in large-scale software deployment and another with expertise in data analytics logs, along with two faculty members from IIT Kanpur.

On complaints regarding answer sheet mismatches, Kamakoti said the team had not yet reached that stage of investigation but would review the scanning and uploading workflow from an IT perspective.

He noted that manual handling is involved in converting physical answer sheets into digital records, leaving room for human error.Defending the broader OSM initiative, Kamakoti said the system was intended to improve transparency by allowing students to see evaluated answer scripts and understand marking decisions.

"From the CBSE's point of view, they tried to do something very good," he said.

Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has also stepped in to address the fallout.

On Tuesday, he held discussions with senior officials from four public sector banks, State Bank of India, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank and Indian Bank, to strengthen CBSE's payment gateway systems.

The education ministry said the minister directed the banks to help establish stronger payment protocols, faster issue resolution, real-time monitoring and automatic refunds in cases of failed or duplicate transactions.

He asked the banks to treat the matter with urgency so students do not face similar problems in future. The banking intervention followed discussions between Pradhan and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on May 24, after which the four lenders were asked to assist with payment gateway integration for CBSE's post-examination services.

Meanwhile, the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education, Women, Children, Youth and Sports has called School Education Secretary Sanjay Kumar and CBSE Chairman Rahul Singh for a meeting on June 2.

According to a Rajya Sabha Secretariat notice, the panel will review the use of the OSM system in grade 12 examinations and discuss issues faced by students after the declaration of results.

The committee, chaired by Congress leader Digvijaya Singh, will also examine the implementation of the three-language formula in classes 9 and 10.

Separately, the panel is scheduled to meet on June 1 to discuss testing reforms, including the use of pen-and-paper examinations versus computer-based testing, and matters relating to NEET and the National Testing Agency.

The scrutiny comes as education authorities face growing pressure to ensure digital systems handling high-stakes examinations remain reliable, secure and accessible for millions of students.

Banda sizzles

Prayagraj 45.4 degrees, Agra 45.3 degrees, and Hamirpur 45.2 degrees Celsius. The weather department also reported warm night conditions at isolated places in the state, adding to public discomfort.

Rajasthan also saw harsh weather conditions, with Sri Ganganagar registering 47 degrees Celsius, the highest in the state. Bikaner and Phalodi both recorded 46 degrees Celsius, while Jaisalmer touched 45.6 degrees and Kota 45.4 degrees Celsius. Jaipur, the state capital, recorded 43.2 degrees Celsius, with most major cities remaining above 40 degrees.

In Maharashtra's Vidarbha region, temperatures stayed well above normal. Brahmapuri, which has repeatedly featured among the hottest places in IMD records alongside Banda, recorded 46.6 degrees Celsius, 3.5 degrees above normal. Chandrapur logged 46.4 degrees, Wardha 46 degrees, Nagpur's Sonegaon airport area 45.5 degrees, and Gondia 45.2 degrees Celsius.In Haryana, Sirsa recorded 46 degrees Celsius, followed by Rohtak at 45.6 degrees. Punjab's hottest location was Bhatinda at 45.8 degrees Celsius.

Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 43.5 degrees Celsius at Safdarjung, 3.1 degrees above normal. IMD said Ayanagar, Ridge and Lodhi Road narrowly missed official heatwave criteria by 0.2 degree, 0.4 degree and 0.7 degree Celsius, respectively. Relief is expected from May 29, with thunderstorms and rainfall forecast.

CNG prices

According to IGL, CNG in Noida and Ghaziabad will now cost Rs 91.70 per kg, while in Gurugram, it will be priced at Rs 88.12 per kg.

PNG continues to be priced at Rs 49.59 per standard cubic metre in Delhi. In Mumbai, PNG costs Rs 51.50 per standard cubic metre. After the Iran war disrupted energy supplies, the government prioritised available gas supply to domestic households. Rates for PNG for domestic cooking were kept unchanged.

But for CNG, the city gas retailers had to rely partly on costlier imported gas. This has translated into CNG price hikes, industry sources said.

The repeated hikes are expected to raise running costs for private vehicle owners, taxis and public transport fleets that rely on CNG, though the fuel continues to remain cheaper than petrol and diesel on a per-kilometre basis.

China-Pak

to validate Pakistan's control over territories India considers illegally occupied.

"As regards the so-called China-Pakistan Economic Corridor projects, some of which are in India's sovereign territory, we resolutely oppose and reject any moves by other countries to reinforce or legitimise Pakistan's illegal and forcible occupation of these territories, impinging on India's sovereignty and territorial integrity," he said.

He added that India has conveyed its objections to both Pakistani and Chinese authorities on several occasions.

The government also took issue with references to "trans-boundary water resources cooperation" between China and Pakistan.

Questioning the basis of such wording, Jaiswal said, "As the two countries do not share any boundary, the question of so-called trans-boundary water resources cooperation does not arise."

He also reiterated India's long-standing rejection of the 1963 boundary agreement between Pakistan and China, saying New Delhi has never recognised the arrangement.

The remarks mark India's latest diplomatic response to references involving Kashmir and territorial matters in statements issued by foreign governments.

NABIN SAYS PM'S TENURE AS 12 GLORIOUS YEARS OF 'SANKALP SE SIDDHI'

Modi completes 12 yrs in office; BJP, Union ministers hail his leadership

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi completed 12 years in office on Tuesday with the ruling BJP and its top leaders hailing his tenure as India's return to self-confidence and cultural renaissance.

On May 26, 2014, Modi took charge as India's Prime Minister with landslide victory. He got re-elected with a bigger mandate in 2019 and again became the Prime Minister for the 3rd time in 2024.

BJP president Nitin Nabin hailed Modi's leadership, saying the era that began on May 26, 2014, represents not merely a change of government, but a historic moment marking the nation's regained self-confidence and cultural renaissance.

In a post on X in Hindi, Nabin said the Modi government, guided by the mantra of 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, aur Sabka Prayas' and the principle of 'Antyodaya', has ensured that policies moved beyond paperwork to become instruments of transformation for every citizen.

PM Narendra Modi

He described the prime minister's tenure as "12 glorious years of 'Sankalp Se Siddhi'" (attainment through resolve).

Defence minister Rajnath Singh said May 26, 2014 marked the beginning of a new chapter in India's civilisational and developmental journey.

"The day Shri @narendramodi took oath as India's Prime Minister, India witnessed a decisive shift in governance, vision, leadership, and national resolve," he said in a post on 'X'.

Singh said the vision of 'Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas' has not remained merely a slogan, but has reflected in governance and policy at every level. He said today, India stands stronger, prouder and more self-confident than ever before.

"A 'Pradhan-Sevak', in the truest sense, Modi Ji has dedicated every moment of his life to the service of Maa Bharati and her people. His tireless commitment, unwavering resolve and selfless devotion towards the nation continue to inspire millions. I pray to the Almighty for his good health, long life and continued service to the nation," he said.

Minister of Road Transport & Highways Nitin Gadkari said a defining moment that reshaped India's destiny—May 26, 2014 will always be remembered as the dawn of a new era under PM Modi.

He said in the years since, governance in India has undergone a fundamental transformation—marked by clarity of vision, decisive leadership, and an unwavering commitment to national progress.

Union Agriculture minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan described Modi as a "visionary" devoted to the nation, saying he has seen him live "every moment" for the country during their 35-year association.

Speaking at the launch of his book "Apnapan", chronicling his long association with Modi, Chouhan said the PM's commitment to national development and his emotional connect with people have deeply influenced him.

Union Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said on this day in 2014, Modi took oath to serve as 'Pradhan Sevak'.

"Tirelessly serving Maa Bharati through the pandemic or the Hormuz crisis, focusing only on improving the lives of Indians. With selfless dedication our government is bringing in transparency in governance," she said.

Minister of Parliamentary Affairs and Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju said May 26, 2014 marked the beginning of a new India as PM Modi took oath with a vision of decisive leadership, development and national transformation.

"Under his leadership, the nation has witnessed remarkable progress in infrastructure, digital growth, welfare, national security & global stature. A true Pradhan Sevak whose unwavering dedication to Maa Bharati continues to inspire millions," he said.

In a series of posts on 'X', the BJP said on this very day in 2014, Modi took the oath as the Prime Minister of India, marking the beginning of a new era.

"This journey, which began with a historic electoral victory, is today propelling the world's largest democracy forward with renewed energy and momentum. A remarkable leadership journey shaping the future of the nation!" it said.

Highlights

- On May 26, 2014, Modi took charge as India's Prime Minister with landslide victory
- Defence minister Rajnath Singh said May 26, 2014 marked the beginning of a new chapter in India's civilisational and developmental journey

'Mere speculation, no reality': Cong on K'taka leadership change

Kharge convened a meeting to decide party candidates for Rajya Sabha and state legislative council elections

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Tuesday termed as "mere speculation" the talk about any leadership change in Karnataka and asserted that the day-long discussions between the central and state top brass were solely focused on the upcoming elections to the Rajya Sabha and the state legislative council.

Though Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge had convened a meeting to decide party candidates for the two elections, the point of interest remained the protracted leadership tussle between Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and his deputy D K Shivakumar, who were summoned to Delhi.

Sources said the Shivakumar camp has been pressing Siddaramaiah to quit the top post and a formula to accommodate him in the central role has been offered to him, which he has not accepted. The formula includes giving Siddaramaiah a Rajya Sabha seat, they said.

The party, however, did not say anything on this. Some media reports, however, claimed that Siddaramaiah may be replaced by Shivakumar in a few days.

Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah, Deputy CM DK Shivakumar and Congress MP KC Venugopal speak to the media, in New Delhi, Tuesday PTI

Siddaramaiah and Shivakumar had arrived in the national capital accompanied by the MLAs supporting them.

After the party meeting, Siddaramaiah once again held deliberations later in the evening with some ministers considered close to him.

At the core of the leadership tangle in the southern state is Shivakumar's demand that he be elevated to the chief minister's post in accordance with a "promise" which his supporters claim was made to him during state Assembly elections in 2023.

The Congress central leadership held deliberations for several hours with its Karnataka state leaders, including Chief Minister Siddaramaiah and Shivakumar, who is also the state party chief, at the Indira Bhawan headquarters.

The party leaders, however, insisted that the issue of any leadership change was not discussed at the meeting attended by Congress president Kharge, Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi, AICC general secretary, Organisation, K C Venugopal and AICC General Secretary in-charge of Karnataka Randeep Surjewala, among others.

Punjab civic polls witnesses 61.5% voter turnout, political workers clash

CHANDIGARH: Clashes involving supporters of Congress, AAP, BJP and SAD and allegations of booth capturing were reported at several places in Punjab during the civic elections that saw 61.5 per cent polling on Tuesday.

The final percentage of voter turnout may change after data is compiled by returning officers.

The local body elections are being seen as crucial for all major political parties of the state as these are taking place ahead of the Assembly polls next year. Congress candidate from Ward number 4 in Raikot, Jagdev Singh Jagga was injured in an attack with sharp-edged weapons by a group of people. He was admitted to a private hospital in Ludhiana, officials said.

Punjab Congress chief Amrinder Singh Raja Warring and Congress MLA Partap Singh Bajwa condemned the incident and slammed the AAP government over the law and order situation in the state.

"The brutal attack on Congress candidate Jagdev Singh Jagga in Raikot exposes the complete collapse of law and order under the Bhagwant Mann government.

"Gangsters and political goons are roaming freely while the government is busy with ads and reels. If election candidates are unsafe, imagine the condition of common people in Punjab," Warring said on X. MPOST

K'taka 'hate speech' Bill may not be necessary: MHA

Ministry says existing legal framework is adequate to address the issue

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BENGALURU: The Union Home Ministry has felt that Karnataka's Bill to curb "hate speech" may not be necessary at this stage, and the existing legal framework is adequate to address the issue.

The Ministry conveyed its "Centre-State Division's" stance on the Karnataka Hate Speech and Hate Crimes (Prevention) Bill, 2025 to the Karnataka government.

Karnataka government sent the Bill to the Ministry of Home Affairs in February for President Draupadi Murmu's assent, after Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot refused to clear it.

The Bill was passed by both houses of the state legislature during the winter session in Belagavi that concluded on December 19 last year, despite strong Opposition from the BJP and JD(S).

"The matter has been examined in the CS Division. In this regard, it is stated that the issues sought to be addressed are already substantially covered under the existing provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 and other prevailing laws. Enactment of a separate state legislation may result in duplication and lack of uniformity," the Ministry of Home Affairs (CS Division) said in its office memorandum dated May 12.

"In view of the above, it is felt that the proposed legislation may not be necessary at this stage, and the existing legal framework is adequate to address the concerns," it added.

Following the centre's letter, the Karnataka Department of Parliamentary Affairs and Legislation has written to the state Home Department on May 20 to furnish the comments or clarification on the said Bill, to enable it to communicate an early reply to the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India.

The Bill proposes a jail term of one year, extendable up to seven years with a fine of Rs 50,000 for hate crime. For repeated offences the maximum imprisonment will be seven years, with a fine of Rs 1 lakh.

The BJP had termed the Bill as "draconian", "direct attack on free speech" and "dangerous tool for political vendetta".

Governor Thaawarchand Gehlot in January sent back the Bill without giving his assent stating that it would have "a severe chilling effect on constitutionally-protected democratic discourse."

Closer Look

- Karnataka govt sent the Bill to the MHA in February for President Murmu's assent, after Governor Gehlot refused to clear it
- The Bill proposes a jail term of one year, extendable up to seven years with a fine of Rs 50,000 for hate crime

KERALA CM MEETS PM

Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan, in New Delhi PTI

HP Panchayat polls: 78.53% polling in first phase

Women voters outnumber men

OUR CORRESPONDENT

SHIMLA: Over 78 per cent polling was recorded in the first phase of the Himachal Pradesh Panchayat elections on Tuesday as women voters polled six per cent more than men, officials said.

Voting for 1,293 Panchayats began at 7 am and concluded peacefully at 3 pm, amid a 'yellow' alert for heatwave conditions in Una, Bilaspur, Hamirpur, Kangra, Solan and Sirmaur districts.

According to the State Election Commission data, 78.55 per cent voters exercised their franchise till 3 pm. Women voters outnumbered men in 10 out of 12 districts.

The data showed that 81.76 per cent of women voters turned up at polling booths, as against 75.43 per cent of men.

The highest turnout was recorded in Kullu district at 84.43 per cent, followed by 82.57 per cent in Sirmaur, 81.06 per cent in Solan, 80.53 per cent in Chamba

Shimla recorded 79.80 per cent voter turnout, Mandi 79.39 per cent, Una 78.76 per cent, Bilaspur 77.39 per cent, Kangra 75.75 per cent, Hamirpur 73.05 percent and Kinnaur 73.59 per cent. Lahaul and Spiti district recorded the lowest turnout at 69.40 per cent, according to the official data.

About 97 per cent voter turnout, the highest in the state was recorded at Kunardhoman Gram Panchayat in Sirmaur district In Maindi, a ward of Karsog in Mandi district, the voting for a Panchayat samiti was cancelled as the name of one of the candidates was missing from the ballot paper.

There are about 2,500 voters in the ward and the name of one candidate, Hoshiyar Singh was not in the list. An enquiry has been ordered, officials said.

The elections were also postponed in ward number 3 of Chambi Panchayat in Chamba as one of the candidate contesting elections died.

The polls were also cancelled/postponed in ward number 1 of Brandhli in Naren Gram Panchayat in Rampur in Shimla district as stamp of NOTA was used in the ballot paper.

"The polling was peaceful across the state. The voting for a Panchayat samiti would be held again in one ward in Mandi district as the name of one of the six candidates was missing from the list," State Chief Election Commissioner Anil Khachi told news agency.

In Bilaspur district, 113-year-old Manglu Devi exercised her right to vote at the 'Pink Booth' established within the Seu Gram Panchayat, located in the Ghumarwin development block.

Takeaways

- The data showed that 81.76 per cent of women voters turned up at polling booths, as against 75.43 per cent of men
- The highest turnout was recorded in Kullu district at 84.43 per cent, followed by 82.57 per cent in Sirmaur, 81.06 per cent in Solan, 80.53 per cent in Chamba

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND 12 MONTHS ENDED MARCH 31, 2026

Strengthening Production, Exploration and Strategic Partnerships

- **Mumbai High field rejuvenation** with TSP - oil production at **102%** of target baseline and gas production at **108% of target** baseline.
- **TSP with bp extended** to entire Western offshore to rejuvenate remaining fields.
- Monetisation from **Daman Upside Development Project** started in Western Offshore; expected to **deliver ~4.89 MMSCMD of gas** progressively.
- **Highest ever projects** in progress in Western offshore with a project cost of **₹33,075 Crores**.
- Project **DeepX mobilised** to accelerate deepwater exploration; **drilling efforts to be doubled** over the next two years.
- India's first **ultra-deepwater stratigraphic well** successfully spudded by ONGC in the **Andaman Basin**.
- Strategic **VLEC partnership signed** with MOL, Japan, and South Korean partners to **strengthen long-term ethane transportation** and **energy logistics** for OPaL.
- Partnership with international majors to explore OALP block in the **Saurashtra offshore basin**.
- Renewable Joint Venture Company **Ayana Renewables**, has reached **3262 MW** capacity , another **1000 MW** on its way.
- Subsidiaries like **HPCL, MRPL, OVL and OPaL** have shown **remarkable improvement** in performance.

By order of the Board
Sd/-
Manish Patil
Director (HR), Additional charge of Director (Finance)
(DIN: 10139350)
Place: New Delhi Date: 26th May, 2026

The results can be accessed through the following link or scan:
https://ongcindia.com/de/web/eng/about-ongc/performance/financial/results

ONGC GROUP OF COMPANIES

Subsidiaries: ONGC Videsh, ONGC Green, HPCL, MRPL, Petronet MHB Limited, OPaL
Joint Ventures: TPC (ONGC-Tripura Power Company Ltd.), tbl (ONGC TERI Biotech Limited), PSL, MSEZ, IGGL
Associates: Petronet LNG Limited, Pawan Hans Limited (A Government of India Enterprise), Rohini Heliport Limited

CIN L74899DL1993GOI054155, **Regd. Office:** Deendayal Urja Bhawan 5, Nelson Mandela Marg, Vasant Kunj, New Delhi - 110070, **Tel:** 011-26754002, **Fax:** 011-26129091, **E-mail:** secretariat@ongc.co.in

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IMMEDIATE & EFFECTIVE MEASURES NEEDED

SC asks Raj, MP, UP to take steps to curb 'illegal' sand mining

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday directed the governments of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh to take immediate and effective steps, including initiating the recruitment process to fill vacant posts of forest guards, to curb rampant illegal sand mining in the National Chambal Gharial Sanctuary.

The top court directed these states to ensure the establishment and operationalisation of surveillance and monitoring infrastructure in affected regions, and also called for coordinated enforcement action against vehicles and machinery involved in these activities and the owners and contractors linked to them.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta took note of a recent media report relating to instances of unregistered and unnumbered vehicles being used for the transportation of illegally mined sand in Morena district of Madhya Pradesh.

It asked Additional Solicitor General S V Raju, who was appearing for Madhya Pradesh, to file a response on the issue and posted the matter for May 29. "If this is correct, then your officers have filed a false affidavit in the court," the bench told Raju. The law officer said if the facts were correct, then it was "shocking" and serious action must be taken.

"They have taken pictures of unregistered and unnumbered vehicles moving around," the bench observed.

The top court is hearing a suo motu case titled 'In Re: Illegal sand mining in the National Chambal Sanctuary and threat to endangered aquatic wildlife'.

REPRESENTATIVE PIC

INSIGHT

- The SC directed these states to ensure the establishment and operationalisation of surveillance and monitoring infrastructure in affected regions
- It also called for coordinated enforcement action against vehicles & machinery involved in these activities and the owners and contractors linked to them

The National Chambal Sanctuary, also called the National Chambal Gharial Wildlife Sanctuary, is a 5,400-sq km tri-state protected area. Besides the endangered gharial (long-snouted crocodile), it is home to the red-crowned roof turtle and the endangered Ganges river Dolphin.

Located on the Chambal river near the tripoint of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh, the sanctuary was first declared a protected area in Madhya Pradesh in 1978 and now constitutes a long and narrow eco-reserve co-administered by the three states.

On Tuesday, the apex court passed further directions to ensure effective enforcement, institutional accountability and immediate operationalisation of surveillance and preventive measures to deal with the issue of illegal sand mining.

"The states of Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh are directed to undertake immediate and effective steps for augmentation of the field level enforcement officials in the respective forest departments including recruitment to vacant posts of forest guards and other front line enforcement personnel...," it said.

It said the recruitment process for such posts should be expedited and these states shall ensure that the process for filling up vacant posts is initiated forthwith and completed within a year. "The states shall take immediate and effective steps for the establishment and/or operationalisation of surveillance and monitoring infrastructure in affected regions including CCTV surveillance systems, integrated monitoring mechanisms, control centres and allied technological infrastructures," it said.

The bench said this process be undertaken on a "war footing" and all surveillance measures proposed pursuant to its earlier orders be fast-tracked and operationalised within six months.

SPECIAL CRIME UNIT BEGINS INVESTIGATION

CBI team conducts probe at house of Twisha's in-laws, meets her family

MPOST BUREAU

BHOPAL: A CBI team on Tuesday visited the Bhopal residence of retired judge Giribala Singh to conduct a probe into the death of her daughter-in-law, Twisha Sharma, officials said. The probe agency sleuths, comprising some women personnel, met Singh's family members at her residence in the Katara Hills area, they said.

Later, the CBI team went to the Army Cantonment Kurushetra Mess in the old city's Shahjehanabad area to meet Twisha's family and is currently camping there.

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) on Monday took over the probe into the death of former model-turned-actor Twisha Sharma, who was allegedly found hanging at her marital home here on May 12, and registered an FIR against her lawyer husband Samarth Singh and mother-in-law Giribala Singh. The agency sent a Special Crime Unit to Bhopal to take charge of the investigation and collect the necessary documents and evidence.

CBI officials investigate the death of Twisha Sharma in Bhopal PTI

The CBI has re-registered the state police FIR in which Samarth Singh and retired district judge Giribala Singh were named as accused, as its own case, according to the procedure.

Taking over the investigation from the state police, the CBI invoked sections 80(2) (punishment for dowry death), 85 (husband or his relative subjecting woman to cruelty) and 3(5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita along with provisions of the Dowry Prohibition Act, which were levelled by the state police as well. The Bhopal police had registered the FIR two days after Twisha's death.

In their statements, Twisha's family members alleged that she was tormented by her in-laws, who were not satisfied with the dowry paid at the time of marriage on December 9, 2025. They accused her in-laws of mental torture and domestic violence, and pushing the 33-year-old former Miss Pune to take the extreme step.

Twisha's mother-in-law, however, questioned her purported medical treatment and mental state in several media interviews.

Samarth Singh was arrested in Jabalpur on Friday after absconding for 10 days. A Bhopal court on Saturday sent him to a seven-day police remand.

On Sunday, a team of doctors from AIIMS-Delhi conducted a second postmortem of Twisha in Bhopal following directions from the Madhya Pradesh High Court.

ED conducts raids at premises linked to builder

CHANDIGARH: The Enforcement Directorate conducted raids at multiple premises linked to Chandigarh Royale City Promoters Pvt. Ltd. (CRCPL), Royale Estate Group and associated persons across Punjab and Chandigarh under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act. Searches included the group's main office at Zirakpur.

The ED probe stems from a Punjab Police FIR registered in SAS Nagar in July 2025 against CRCPL directors and others under IPC sections related to cheating, criminal breach of trust and conspiracy.

The case involves alleged non-payment of GMADA dues linked to a housing project in Village Karala, with bounced cheques worth nearly Rs 32.67 crore. During the searches, officials seized property documents, financial records and digital devices. Further investigation is underway. MPOST

MP: 5 labourers killed as soil caves in Panna

PANNA: Five labourers were killed after soil caved in on them while they were digging a well in a village in Madhya Pradesh's Panna district on Tuesday, police said.

The incident occurred in Biharpurwa village of Ajaygarh block around 12 pm, an official said. Panna Superintendent of Police Nivedita Naidu said that the labourers were working at the site of a public irrigation well, being constructed under the MNREGA scheme, when the soil collapsed on them.

The deceased were identified as Ashish Yadav, Rajkumar Yadav, Rampal Yadav, Chunnu Yadav, and Chunvad Pal. The bodies were extricated from the soil and sent for post-mortem, an official said. On receiving information about the incident, District Collector Usha Parmar arrived at the scene and reviewed the rescue operation.

The collector met the victims' families and assured them of possible assistance. MPOST

Int'l narcotics smuggling probe: ED conducts raids in Tamil Nadu

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI/CHENNAI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED), Chennai Zonal Office, on Monday conducted searches at five locations in Madurai and Chennai in connection with an alleged international drug smuggling network accused of trafficking narcotics to Sri Lanka through the sea route.

The probe, initiated under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), is based on two cases registered by the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and the Customs Act against accused John Britto and his associates. The syndicate allegedly smuggled 99 kg of hashish valued at around Rs 108 crore and 37.5 kg of methamphetamine, commonly known as ICE, estimated to be worth nearly Rs 150 crore in the illegal market. Officials said the investigation is focused on tracing the financial trail and identifying the wider network involved in the cross-border operation.

The case stems from two major seizures made earlier this year. On March 5, 2024, acting on intelligence shared by the Indian Coast Guard, DRI officials in Madurai intercepted a fishing vessel in the Gulf of Mannar and seized 99 kg of hashish allegedly being transported to Sri Lanka. Three individuals — Ramish, Jansan and Prathap — were apprehended during the operation. Investigators claim the consignment was being moved under the directions of John Britto. In another operation on March 1, 2024, DRI officials intercepted Phillomen Prakash, an alleged associate of Britto, at Madurai Railway Station and recovered 37.645 kg of methamphetamine suspected to be intended for smuggling into Sri Lanka.

The ED said preliminary findings indicate that the syndicate used fishermen and boat operators to transport narcotics through Indian maritime zones before handing over consignments to contacts at sea linked to Sri Lanka.

During the searches, officials seized documents and digital evidence related to financial transactions and alleged drug trafficking activities. Further investigation into the money trail and international links of the syndicate is underway.

UP: 11 killed in two separate road accidents

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: At least 11 people were killed and several others injured in two separate road accidents on highways in Uttar Pradesh in the early hours of Tuesday, with police suspecting driver fatigue in both cases.

In the first accident, seven passengers, including a sub-inspector, died after a private sleeper bus travelling from Delhi to Gorakhpur overturned on the Lucknow-Agra Expressway in Unnao district around 5 am. Police said the bus, carrying 52 passengers, lost control at high speed and rammed into a culvert before overturning. The vehicle then skidded for nearly 100 metres on the road, highlighting the impact of the crash.

Three police personnel were among the 24 injured passengers. Several injured persons were referred to the Trauma Centre. Unnao SP Jay Prakash Singh said preliminary investigation indicated that the bus was travelling at over 120 kmph and the driver may have fallen asleep at the wheel, causing the vehicle to go out of control.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath took cognisance of the accident, expressed grief over the deaths and directed officials to speed up relief and rescue operations. He also announced compensation for the families of the deceased.

In the second accident, four friends, including a government doctor, were killed after their Innova car rammed into the rear of a trailer truck on the Lucknow-Sultanpur highway in Barabanki district. The accident took place near Bhikhra village in the Haidergarh area around 3 am when the group was travelling to Kainchi Dham. Police said the Innova was moving at around 100 kmph when it crashed into the trailer from behind. Three other occupants suffered serious injuries and were rushed to hospital by police and local residents.

According to the preliminary investigation, the Innova driver may have dozed off before the collision. Doctors later declared four occupants dead.

Saini calls for 'massive' expansion of public transport across Haryana

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday called for a major expansion of public transport services across the state, saying reduced dependence on private vehicles is essential to cut fuel consumption and promote sustainable mobility.

Chairing a review meeting on the Transport Department's five-year roadmap and action plan under 'Haryana Vision-2047', Saini directed officials to prepare a revised and future-ready route plan to ensure seamless bus connectivity to every village and urban area in the state.

He said the government aims to ensure that no village in Haryana remains without bus service within the next one year. Stressing the need for efficient planning and better management, the chief minister said growing population in nearly 6,500 villages and urban areas has increased transport demand, but public transport expansion has not kept pace.

Saini instructed officials to redesign the transport network according to present and future requirements, adding that improved connectivity would particularly benefit students, women and working professionals and encourage them to shift from private vehicles to buses. He also proposed cluster-based connectivity through circular bus routes linking nearby villages and suggested amendments to existing policies if required.

Highlighting the decline in intra-city bus services despite rapid urbanisation, Saini directed authorities to strengthen local transport and ensure bus connectivity to hospitals, educational institutions and religious places. He also ordered special bus services for industrial workers in Gurugram, Faridabad and Sonipat and mini buses connecting metro stations with bus stands.

To improve passenger convenience, the CM directed integration of all buses with a real-time tracking system similar to Railways. He also ordered installation of CCTV cameras and panic buttons in buses to enhance passenger safety, particularly for women. MPOST

India-Israel ties rooted in shared values: Envoy

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Amid reports that Israel has urged India to designate Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) as a terrorist organisation over concerns regarding its activities within and beyond West Asia, Israeli Ambassador to India Reuven Azar on Tuesday described India-Israel relations as "truly special and unique". He said the strategic partnership between the two countries is built not only on geopolitical interests but also on shared democratic values and deep civilisational connections.

Azar's remarks come at a time of heightened tensions and political instability in West Asia, alongside growing international scrutiny of Iran's regional influence. Israeli officials have argued that several countries have imposed sanctions on the IRGC because of security concerns and maintain that its activities are not limited to the Middle East alone. Reports suggest Israel has shared its assessment of the IRGC with various nations, including India.

India, however, has not designated either Hamas or the IRGC as terrorist organisations, even as it maintains strong defence and strategic cooperation with Israel while continuing diplomatic engagement with Iran, especially in areas linked to energy security and regional connectivity.

In a video statement, Azar placed India-Israel ties within a broader historical and ideological framework. He said both countries share a history of "civilisational resilience and national revival", having endured repeated invasions and attacks on their cultural and national identities over centuries. "Although both societies have gone through many ordeals over thousands of years, our identities have remained intact," Azar said, adding that both nations are now witnessing a resurgence of their civilisations through their nation-state systems. The ambassador highlighted counter-terrorism cooperation as a key pillar of bilateral relations, noting that both India and Israel have faced terrorist threats for decades and therefore maintain close coordination on security matters.

Calling India "the greatest democracy in the world", Azar said the two countries are united by values such as freedom of speech, openness and entrepreneurship. According to him, these common democratic principles have helped build strategic trust and strengthen people-to-people ties between New Delhi and Tel Aviv.

He also stressed innovation and technology as defining features of the partnership, pointing out that both nations have emerged as major global hubs of technological advancement and start-up culture. Greater collaboration in innovation and digital technologies, he said, would further accelerate economic growth in both countries.

Azar further praised India's long tradition of religious tolerance and coexistence, noting that Jewish communities have lived in India for centuries without facing anti-Semitism. "India-Israel relations are different from many other international relationships because of not just the strategic interests but also the shared values," Azar said.

Researchers develop new protein mapping tool

NEW DELHI: Researchers at the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Scientific Research (JNCASR), Bengaluru, have developed a new imaging platform called Cleavable Light-Erased Antibody Reporter (CLEAR) that allows scientists to visualise multiple proteins within the same biological sample using a single fluorophore.

Developed by a team led by Prof Sarit S. Agasti, the study has been published in the Royal Society of Chemistry journal Chemical Science. Researchers believe the technology could improve disease diagnosis in cancer biology, immunology and neurological disorders by enabling detailed protein mapping inside tissues. CLEAR works through a cyclic imaging process in which proteins are labelled with fluorescent tags, imaged under a microscope and then erased using a pulse of 365 nm LED light. The cycle is repeated to build highly detailed protein maps.

Indian Institute of Science researchers also collaborated in validating the system. MPOST

Stanford Indian researcher to present AI-driven schizophrenia study in UK Psychiatry Congress

Computational screening of 1,600 FDA-approved drugs by Bhopal's RISE Global Winner Rushank Goyal, who is pursuing a degree in CS at Stanford University opens new antipsychotic pathways

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: A Stanford University researcher of Bhopal's Madhya Pradesh origin, Rushank Goyal, has been selected to present his AI-driven study on schizophrenia drug discovery at the prestigious International Congress of the Royal College of Psychiatrists in the United Kingdom next month.

Rushank is working in applied artificial intelligence (AI) and computational biology at Stanford University in California, United States, and has applied machine-learning-based ligand optimisation methods to identify new therapeutic compounds for schizophrenia, one of psychiatry's most challenging disorders.

Goyal, a RISE (Rise for the World) Global Winner, is currently pursuing a degree in Computer Science at Stanford University from India, on the prestigious Rhodes Trust Scholarship.

His research paper titled "Expanding the Antipsychotic Arsenal: Drug Discovery for Schizophrenia via Virtual Screening and Ligand Optimisation of FDA-Approved Drugs" has been selected for presentation at the International Congress. The study highlights the growing convergence of artificial intelligence and biomedical research. Using computational screening and AI-based molecular optimisation methods, Goyal evaluated approximately 1,600 FDA-approved drugs for their potential binding affinity to the dopamine D2 receptor (DRD2), a key target for antipsychotic medications.

Rushank Goyal

HIGHLIGHTS

- The study highlights growing convergence of AI and biomedical research
- Goyal generated 450 structural variants from six established antipsychotics
- Earlier, Goyal's work on biomarker discovery published in Springer book

The computational pipeline successfully identified risperidone — a widely used antipsychotic — as the top binder with a molecular docking score of -11.9 kcal/mol, validating the robustness of the workflow. The research further identified dolasetron and trazodone as compounds deserving further scientific attention.

In a notable application of machine learning, Goyal generated 450 structural variants from six established antipsychotics using an AI-driven molecular similarity algorithm. One optimised candidate derived from risperidone achieved a superior docking score of -13.6 kcal/mol, demonstrating the potential of AI to enhance existing drug molecules.

Speaking to **Millennium Post** on his work from California, Rushank Goyal said: "What this research demonstrates is the potential of AI-assisted computational methods to identify promising therapeutic candidates more efficiently than conventional early-stage discovery approaches. Any potential drug candidate would still require extensive experimental validation and clinical testing before therapeutic use could be considered."

Schizophrenia affects millions worldwide, with many patients experiencing limited response or significant side effects from current treatments. Experts view such AI-powered approaches as valuable tools in accelerating early-stage drug discovery by intelligently navigating the vast chemical space of potential molecules.

Rushank has previously contributed to machine learning methods for biomarker discovery, with his work presented at the International Symposium on Biomedical and Computational Biology and published in a Springer book volume.

This achievement by the young researcher of Madhya Pradesh origin underscores India's growing talent in applying artificial intelligence to critical healthcare challenges on the global stage.

Disclaimer: The findings are preliminary computational results and do not constitute any clinical recommendation. Patients should continue consulting qualified medical professionals for treatment decisions.

MPs review rly development in Sonpur Division

HAJIPUR: A meeting of the Divisional Parliamentary Committee of Sonpur Division was held on Tuesday under the chairmanship of Saran MP Rajiv Pratap Rudy to discuss railway development and passenger amenities. MPs and representatives from various constituencies under the division participated in the meeting and offered suggestions on infrastructure development, train halts and improving passenger facilities.

East Central Railway General Manager Chhatrasal Singh, Additional General Manager Amarendra Kumar and Sonpur Divisional Railway Manager Amit Saran, along with senior railway officials, attended the meeting. The MPs stressed the need to expedite infrastructure projects and strengthen railway connectivity. MPOST

EDITORIAL

UNEASY TRUCE

The possibility of a negotiated understanding between the United States and Iran to end the ongoing conflict and reopen the Strait of Hormuz offers the world a rare moment of cautious optimism. After months of military escalation, economic disruption and geopolitical brinkmanship, the prospect of de-escalation has emerged not because trust has suddenly appeared between adversaries, but because the costs of continued instability have become unbearable for all sides. The war has already altered the strategic balance of West Asia, disrupted global energy flows and exposed once again how deeply the world economy remains dependent upon the politics of the Gulf. For India and other major energy-importing nations, the Strait of Hormuz is not merely a distant maritime corridor but a critical artery of economic survival. Nearly one-fifth of the world's oil trade passes through this narrow passage, and the disruption caused by the conflict sent energy prices soaring, increased inflationary pressure and created anxiety across international markets. The proposed reopening of the strait, therefore, is not simply a diplomatic breakthrough but an economic necessity for the world. Yet while markets may welcome signs of progress, the deeper reality is that this agreement, if finalised, will represent a pause in confrontation rather than a permanent settlement of tensions.

The emerging negotiations also demonstrate the limits of military power in modern geopolitics. The United States and Israel may have inflicted severe strategic damage upon Iran and its regional networks, but they also discovered that even a weakened Iran retains the capacity to impose global consequences through asymmetric pressure. Iran's ability to disrupt maritime trade and threaten energy security ensured that the conflict could not remain geographically confined. At the same time, Tehran itself enters negotiations from a position of visible strain. Years of sanctions, economic hardship, internal dissatisfaction and sustained military pressure have narrowed its options considerably. Its willingness to discuss uranium stockpiles and sanctions-linked arrangements reflects geopolitical compulsion rather than ideological transformation. This is diplomacy born out of exhaustion and mutual vulnerability, not reconciliation. That distinction is important because the structural causes of hostility remain unresolved. Israel continues to view Iran's missile programme and proxy networks as existential threats, while Iran sees those very capabilities as essential deterrents against external pressure. Washington seeks de-escalation while simultaneously preserving Israel's freedom to respond militarily to perceived threats. Every party enters negotiations while preparing for the possibility that the agreement may eventually collapse.

The most significant unresolved issue remains Iran's nuclear programme. While reports suggest Tehran could agree to give up its highly enriched uranium stockpile, the crucial questions remain unanswered. Will Iran retain the right to enrich uranium at lower levels? Who will monitor compliance? How durable will sanctions relief prove to be? These uncertainties matter because the nuclear issue lies at the heart of decades of mistrust between Iran and the West. Iran insists that its programme is peaceful and rooted in its sovereign right to nuclear technology, while the United States and Israel remain unconvinced about Tehran's long-term intentions. The proposed 60-day framework for future negotiations suggests that even the current understanding remains incomplete. Equally absent from the negotiations are broader political questions that once dominated Western rhetoric, including regime change in Tehran. Earlier phases of the conflict were accompanied by speculation that sustained military pressure and domestic unrest might destabilise the Iranian leadership. That objective now appears largely abandoned, reflecting a recurring lesson of modern international politics: external military coercion rarely produces predictable political transformation. More often, it generates prolonged instability with wider regional consequences. The current negotiations, therefore, reveal a pragmatic shift from ambitious geopolitical redesign to damage control.

The emerging agreement reflects the fragile nature of 21st-century diplomacy. Modern geopolitical arrangements are increasingly designed not to resolve conflicts permanently, but to manage instability and prevent catastrophic escalation. This is not peace in the classical sense. It is managed hostility sustained through temporary understandings and mutual restraint. Yet even such fragile diplomacy carries enormous value in an era marked by strategic mistrust, militarised nationalism and widening geopolitical fragmentation. The alternative to negotiation would have been prolonged conflict with devastating implications for global energy markets, civilian populations and international stability. If the Strait of Hormuz reopens and oil begins flowing normally again, markets may stabilise temporarily, but the deeper lesson of this crisis will remain unchanged. The world economy continues to rest upon vulnerable geopolitical fault lines, and regional conflicts no longer remain regional. The United States, Iran and Israel may succeed in stepping back from the brink for now, but the underlying tensions that produced this confrontation have not disappeared. The world may witness de-escalation, but not resolution.

BHARAT KI SOCH

Dignity in Times of Adversity

Beyond mythology and reverence, Sita is one of Bharat's strongest moral figures, embodying endurance, grace, ethical conviction and inner strength

ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON BHARAT KI SOCH

Sita is not great because she suffered. She is great because suffering could not corrupt her

Sita occupies a sacred and abiding place in Bharat's civilisational memory not through conquest or power, but through unwavering character, quiet resilience and fidelity to truth. Revered across generations as an embodiment of virtue, she was far more than a queen of Ayodhya or a central figure in the epic tradition. Her life reveals the deeper meaning of courage, the ability to uphold dignity in adversity, preserve conviction in uncertainty and remain steadfast when circumstances demand sacrifice. Across centuries, Sita has endured not simply as a figure of reverence, but as one of the strongest moral figures in Indian civilisation, a timeless guide to grace, inner strength and moral resolve. Through every stage of her life, from Mithila to Ayodhya, from the forest to Lanka, from royal honour to life in Valmiki's ashram, Sita demonstrates that the greatest strength lies in preserving truth, dignity and self-respect when circumstances are unjust, painful and deeply testing.

Born to King Janak of Mithila, Sita's origin itself is associated with the earth, giving her character a profound symbolic depth. Raised in a kingdom where wisdom, learning and philosophical refinement flourished, she grew into a personality of grace, discipline and morality. Her early life reminds us that character is not formed only in moments of crisis but is moulded through upbringing and values that are taught and imbibed. The first lesson from Sita's life, therefore, is the importance of inner strength and moral courage, for when the hour of trial arrives, only those values that have been deeply absorbed can sustain conduct.

Her marriage to Shri Ram was not merely a royal union, but a meeting of two lives guided by dharma. Yet Sita's greatness is not confined to her role as wife. When Ram was exiled, she chose to accompany him into the forest, not as an act of helpless dependence, but as a conscious expression of companionship and shared responsibility. She could have remained in the comfort of Ayodhya, protected by status and privilege, but she chose the uncertain path of duty. This decision offers a profound life lesson. True relationships are not built only in comfort and prosperity. They are tested when sacrifice is required, when convenience must give way to commitment, and when love must express itself through courage.

Sita's life continues to remind us that dignity is not shaped by circumstance and is not abandoned because the path becomes difficult

In the forest, Sita's conduct reflects adaptability without complaint. A princess raised in refinement, she accepted a life of simplicity without allowing hardship to diminish her dignity. She did not treat comfort as entitlement, nor did she allow discomfort to become bitterness. This is one of the most significant moral values her life offers to modern society. The worth of a person is not measured by external circumstances, but by the quality of conduct maintained by them. In an age where comfort is often mistaken for success, Sita reminds us that grace under difficulty is itself a form of greatness. Simplicity, when accepted with dignity, shines through one's personality as evidence of character, poise and conviction.

The abduction of Sita by Ravan and her captivity in Lanka form one of the most powerful episodes of the Ramayana. She may have been physically confined in Ashoka Vatika, but was morally unconquered. Ravan possessed wealth and the power of a great kingdom, yet he could not bend her will. Sita's refusal to yield before him represents courage of the highest order. She shows that ethical strength begins where fear loses command over the mind. Her resistance was firm, composed and rooted in self-respect and commitment to Ram. She did not need aggression to prove her strength, as her refusal itself became her declaration of intent.

This episode also teaches a perennial ethical lesson about the dignity of the individual. Sita may have been held captive, but her conscience remained free. Her example reminds us that no external force can defeat a person with determined resolve. In professional, social and national life, there are moments when pressure, temptation or intimidation tends to weaken moral judgment. Sita's life teaches that ethics are meaningful only when they survive pressure. Values that collapse before fear are only preferences. Values that are steadfast despite uncertainty and apprehension become character.

Her story also compels reflection on the burdens placed upon those who must carry truth through public doubt. The agni pariksha and later separation from Ayodhya have been debated for centuries, and different traditions and readers have approached them in different ways. Some understand Ram's decisions as painful sacrifices made in the interest of societal order, where personal affection came into conflict with public responsibility. It is also remembered that Ram suffered after Sita's exile and never remarried. At the same time, many feel Sita was treated unfairly, for she had already endured captivity in Lanka, upheld her dignity before Ravan and passed through the agni pariksha. To exile a woman because of public gossip appears harsh and unjust to many modern minds. This episode, therefore, raises enduring questions about reputation and justice, social expectations and individual dignity, public morality and the treatment of women. Yet even in this defining moment, Sita does not lose her moral framework. She faces judgment without diminishing herself and demonstrates that dignity lies in her consistent loyalty to her husband's decision.

Sita's response to this submission should never be mistaken for weakness. Her restraint is not passivity but self-command. She does not allow pain to distort her values or influence her conduct. This distinction is important for a holistic reading of her life. She is not great because she suffered. She is great because suffering could not corrupt her. She retained dignity where anger would have been easy, composure where despair would have been natural, and moral clarity where resentment could have taken root. In this lies one of her deepest moral values. The human being must not permit injustice to destroy the very qualities that make justice worth defending.

Her life in Valmiki's ashram adds another dimension to her greatness. Away from royal privilege, she raised Luv and Kush with discipline and a deep connection to their heritage. This phase of her life is particularly important because it shows leadership beyond the throne, title and public recognition. Sita shaped the next generation not through authority, but through values. She transmitted courage without the bitterness of her experiences, memory without hatred, and strength without arrogance. In doing so, she reminds us that leadership is not only exercised in boardrooms, councils or battlefields. It is also exercised in homes, in education, in motherhood, in mentorship and in the formation of character.

The leadership lesson from Sita is therefore profound. Moral authority does not always sit on a throne but is earned through conduct. Sita leads by example, by endurance, by clarity, by self-respect and by the ability to remain aligned with dharma even when life becomes deeply painful. Modern institutions can learn from this. Leadership demands emotional responsibility, because duty without compassion can become rigid, and public order without justice can wound the very values it seeks to protect. Authority without dignity becomes domination. Power without restraint becomes insecurity. Public life without moral grounding becomes performance. Sita's life teaches that leadership is not always about visibility but that which shapes conscience, preserves values and gives others the courage to act with integrity.

Sita's story is eternal because it speaks of the deepest struggles of human life. Whether read as sacred history, itihaas, spiritual teaching or civilisational narrative, the greatness of the Ramayana lies not in presenting perfect human beings alone, but in forcing humanity to wrestle with difficult moral questions. Ram reflects duty, order and the burden of public responsibility, while Sita reflects purity, truth, inner strength and individual dignity. One can deeply revere Ram's virtues while still reflecting upon the pain of Sita's experience. One can also admire Sita's strength without merely identifying her with suffering. Her life continues to remind us that dignity is not shaped by circumstance and is not abandoned because the path becomes difficult. In remembering Sita, we remember a civilisational ideal of greatness sustained by moral purity, and the quietest forms of strength often leave the deepest imprint on the moral memory of a people.

Views expressed are personal

BROKEN CONFIDENCE

Policing Without Public Confidence

As Indian policing becomes technologically stronger and more assertive, rising public scepticism exposes a growing crisis of institutional credibility and democratic legitimacy

OP SINGH
THE WRITER IS PRESIDENT & CEO, INDIAN POLICE FOUNDATION

The Twisha Sharma case has once again raised difficult questions about fairness, institutional neutrality and whether technological modernisation alone can restore public faith in policing

India today witnesses a paradox in policing. Never before has the police force been so technologically empowered, operationally visible and institutionally assertive. Yet never before has public trust in policing appeared so fragile. The Indian police is undoubtedly enhancing policing, but simultaneously losing credibility in the eyes of many citizens. The recent Twisha Sharma case has once again brought this contradiction into sharp national focus.

Modern Indian policing has undergone a remarkable transformation. Integrated emergency response systems, cybercrime units, forensic laboratories, command-and-control centres, CCTV surveillance, facial recognition tools, drones, predictive policing technologies and digitised criminal databases have significantly improved operational efficiency. Police response time in many states has reduced dramatically. Large-scale religious gatherings, elections, protests and disasters are managed with increasing sophistication.

In states like Uttar Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka, technology-driven policing models have changed the operational landscape. Online FIR systems, women's helplines, GPS-enabled patrol vehicles and cyber-monitoring mechanisms reflect a police organisation attempting to modernise itself for contemporary challenges.

However, the deeper question is not whether policing capacity has improved. It certainly has. The real question is whether public confidence has improved alongside it. Increasingly, the answer appears uncomfortable.

The Twisha Sharma case illustrates why.

The death of the young woman quickly transformed into a national debate, not merely because of the tragedy itself, but because of the widespread suspicion surrounding the investigation. Questions emerged regarding the delay in FIR registration, CCTV timelines, forensic handling and the speed with which preliminary conclusions appeared to be drawn. The public perception that influential individuals may receive institutional protection further intensified distrust. Eventually, the matter reached the Supreme Court, and the state government transferred the case to the CBI.

Technology can strengthen policing, but only credibility can strengthen democracy

The significance of the case lies less in the final judicial outcome and more in the instinctive reaction of society. Large sections of the public immediately doubted whether the local police investigation would remain impartial. That instinctive scepticism reflects a serious crisis of institutional credibility.

Unfortunately, this is not an isolated phenomenon.

The custodial deaths in Sathankulam in Tamil Nadu, allegations of mishandling in the Kolkata RG Kar Medical College rape-murder case, controversies surrounding encounter killings, accusations of selective action during communal disturbances and repeated claims of police inaction in cases involving influential persons have collectively contributed to a growing perception that policing in India is not always uniformly fair.

Public trust weakens not merely because mistakes occur, but because people increasingly believe that outcomes may depend upon power, influence, visibility or political convenience.

This perception is dangerous for democracy.

Policing ultimately depends upon legitimacy. A police force may possess weapons, surveillance systems, legal powers and advanced technology, but sustainable policing cannot function without public cooperation. Citizens share intelligence, report crimes, cooperate in investigations and comply with the law primarily when they trust institutions. Fear may create temporary obedience; trust creates enduring legitimacy.

One major reason behind declining trust is the visible politicisation of policing. Transfers, postings, investigations and law-and-order responses are often perceived through political lenses. When police action appears selective or politically convenient, institutional neutrality suffers. The police then risk being viewed not as an impartial protector of law, but as an extension of ruling power structures.

Another reason is the growing culture of performative policing. In the age of social media, policing increasingly operates under instant public scrutiny. Viral videos, public spectacles of arrests, encounter narratives and media-driven investigations often overshadow quiet professionalism. The pressure to appear decisive sometimes becomes greater than the commitment to appear fair. Optics begins competing with objectivity.

Simultaneously, there remains an over-dependence on coercive policing methods. Bulldozer actions, public shaming of accused persons, aggressive interrogation styles and custodial excesses may generate temporary public applause, but they weaken constitutional policing. Democracies cannot permit instant justice to replace due process. The rule of law demands restraint precisely when public emotions are strongest.

Ironically, while policing has become technologically advanced, it has become emotionally distant. Earlier, despite limited resources, local police officers often had stronger community familiarity and personal engagement. Today's policing is increasingly data-driven, centralised and target-oriented. Human sensitivity, empathy and patient listening are receiving less institutional attention than technological modernisation.

The challenge before Indian policing, therefore, is not merely modernisation but democratisation of policing culture.

The police must recognise that professionalism is not measured only by crime statistics, encounter numbers or technological capability. It is equally measured by whether an ordinary citizen feels confident that the police will act fairly, irrespective of social status or political influence.

Restoring trust requires structural as well as cultural reforms — insulating investigations from political interference, strengthening accountability mechanisms, ensuring transparency in sensitive investigations, improving sensitivity training, rewarding ethical conduct and deepening community engagement. The Prakash Singh judgment of 2006 attempted to strike a balance between autonomy and accountability, professionalism and public oversight. Even after twenty years, the verdict has not been implemented in letter and spirit.

The Indian police today stands at a historic crossroads. It can become a technologically powerful force feared by society, or a constitutionally grounded institution trusted by society. The difference between the two lies not in equipment or laws, but in credibility.

The Twisha Sharma case is a reminder that, in a democracy, policing succeeds not when citizens merely fear the police, but when they believe the police will stand by the truth without fear or favour.

Views expressed are personal

AN AMBER HEALTH ALERT ISSUED FOR LARGE PARTS OF THE COUNTRY

Exceptionally early heat wave shatters records, brings deaths in Europe

LONDON: Temperature records toppled as a spring heat wave continued to scorch parts of Western Europe on Tuesday, triggering government warnings about risks to life. Several drownings were reported in Britain and France as people tried to cool down.

London recorded a rare "tropical night", defined as one in which the temperature does not fall below 20 Celsius (68 Fahrenheit), and Britain's Met Office weather service said the temperature in southern England could reach 35 C (95 F) on Tuesday. Monday was the UK's hottest May day on record, with the temperature hitting 34.8 C (94.6 F) at Kew Gardens in London, smashing the previous record of 32.8 C (91.4 F) set in 1922 and 1944.

Records also fell in France, where temperatures reached 36 C (97 F) on Monday in the country's southwest and widely remained above 20 C (68 F) at night. The national weather service, Meteo-France, said a "heat dome", with heat held in place by a high-pressure weather front, was producing temperatures more than 10 degrees Celsius above what used to be usual for this time of year.

People walk outside the Palace of Westminster in London on Tuesday AP/PTI

Unpredictable and extreme weather are becoming more frequent as Earth's warming builds. Experts say unprecedented and deadly weather extremes that sometimes strike at abnormal times and in unusual places are putting more people in danger.

After a UK long weekend that sent people flocking to beaches, pools and shady parks, London commuters sweltered on Tuesday in subway carriages without air conditioning. Trains to and from the busy Waterloo station were disrupted by a report of smoke on the tracks.

In Scotland, firefighters worked through the night to douse a grass fire that sent smoke billowing from Arthur's Seat, the rocky hill that looms over Edinburgh.

The UK Health Security Agency issued an amber health alert for large parts of the country through Thursday, warning of a potential health risk, particularly among older people, at the hottest times of the day.

The UK is used to moderate temperatures, and many homes, schools and businesses do not have air conditioning.

Highlights

- Monday was the UK's hottest May day on record, with temperature hitting 34.8 C (94.6 F)
- Records also fell in France, where temperatures reached 36 C (97 F)
- Unpredictable and extreme weather are becoming more frequent as Earth's warming builds

At least three teenagers died in apparent drownings in UK lakes and reservoirs, and a 60-year-old man died in the sea in southwest England, authorities said. French government spokesperson Maud Bregeon said there have been reports of at least seven deaths potentially related to high temperatures, including five drownings and two deaths in sports competitions. The early heat wave has struck before the annual summer window when lifeguards watch over bathers at popular beaches, increasing risks. AGENCIES

US carried out 'self-defence' strikes in Iran as talks stall

Tehran condemns US strikes as show of 'bad faith'

DUBAI: Iran on Tuesday denounced the most recent US strikes as a sign of "bad faith and unreliability" as negotiations pressed on toward a possible deal to end the war, and the Islamic Republic began restoring internet access after a national shutdown that began in January.

The US military characterised Monday's strikes in southern Iran as defensive, saying targets included missile launch sites and minelaying boats, and said the US acted with "restraint" in light of the weekslong ceasefire.

Iran's foreign ministry called the strikes a ceasefire violation and warned that Washington would bear responsibility for "all consequences", without elaborating.

"The Islamic Republic of Iran will leave no act of aggression unanswered," it added in a statement.

Iran's Revolutionary Guard said Tuesday that it had shot down and deterred drones and a fighter jet that entered its airspace, according to Iran's official Mizan news agency, which did not specify when the incidents occurred.

Iran's supreme leader, Mojtaba Khamenei, used a statement about Islam's annual Hajj pilgrimage to herald his country's confrontation with the US and Israel, declaring that other Mideast countries "will no longer serve as a shield" for US military bases.

REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

> THE ISLAMIC REPUBLIC OF IRAN WILL LEAVE NO ACT OF AGGRESSION UNANSWERED

Iran has previously complained about US military facilities in the region and targeted them. It was not immediately clear what the developments would mean for negotiations. The strikes came after Iranian Parliament Speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf went to Qatar as part of the talks, which US President Donald Trump said Monday were "proceeding nicely". Iranian state TV reported Tuesday that Qalibaf and Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi left Qatar. The report did not elaborate or point to any next steps.

Meanwhile, Iranian authorities eased a monthslong internet shutdown that they cast as a wartime necessity, but that has cost the country's economy an estimated $30 million to $40 million a day. AGENCIES

Russia maintains attacks on Ukraine

A rescue worker climbs on a ladder to help evacuate people from a residential building being destroyed after a Russian strike on Kyiv AP/PTI

KYIV: Russia fired more than 100 drones and two ballistic missiles at Ukraine overnight, the Ukrainian air force said Tuesday, as the country's foreign ministry noted that Moscow's recent threat to hit Kyiv especially hard from the air brought nothing new.

Russia on Monday urged foreign citizens, including members of diplomatic missions, to leave the Ukrainian capital as quickly as possible and told residents to steer clear of military and government facilities. It said that "systemic strikes" on Kyiv were being prepared.

Russia has regularly bombarded Kyiv, often causing dozens of civilian casualties with every attack, since it launched an all-out invasion of neighbouring Ukraine on Feb. 24, 2022.

Russia's Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov told US Secretary of State Marco Rubio by phone Monday that the US should evacuate its diplomatic staff fromKyiv, a foreign ministry statement said. Rubio didn't say whether the US State Department would take that step, but expressed concern during a trip to India that the "terrible" war in Ukraine could escalate further.

The Trump administration has tried for more than a year to stop the war. But its efforts yielded no significant breakthrough and are now on ice as Washington focuses on the Iran war.

There were no announcements of diplomatic departures from Kyiv. AGENCIES

Israel, Hezbollah clash along Lebanese river

BEIRUT: Israel's military clashed with the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group Tuesday along a strategic river in Lebanon as Israeli troops tried to push farther north, just three days before Lebanese and Israeli military delegations are set to meet for direct talks in Washington.

A previously reached ceasefire appeared more nominal by the day, complicating efforts at a broader peace in the Iran war, as Tehran wants an end to the fighting to include Lebanon.

The Litani River has been a de facto boundary in Lebanon, with large areas to the south under Israeli military control despite the Washington-brokered ceasefire in place for over a month. Tuesday's intensified strikes and clashes came after Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said he had authorised more intensive strikes targeting Hezbollah across Lebanon. Meanwhile, an Israeli security official said the military had called up an additional battalion to Lebanon, speaking on condition of anonymity in line with regulations.

REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

> One strike hit the eastern village of Mashghara, killing 12 people including several members of a family

Israel's military said it struck more than 100 Hezbollah sites across southern Lebanon and the eastern Bekaa Valley area overnight, saying it targeted storage facilities, command centers and observation points used to attack Israeli troops and residents in northern Israel. One strike hit the eastern village of Mashghara, killing 12 people including several members of a family, Lebanon's state-run National News Agency said.

Israel in recent days has intensified strikes in Nabatieh city and province, just north of the river. On Tuesday it warned city residents to leave.

Hezbollah meanwhile said it launched several rocket, artillery and exploding drone attacks on Israeli troops and vehicles mobilising along the river toward the Nabatieh villages of Yohmor al-Shaqif and Zawtar al-Sharqieh.

Hezbollah's Al-Manar TV said the militant group repelled attacks along theriver banks. AGENCIES

Pak Army chief briefs Chinese FM on Iran visit

BEIJING: Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi held talks with Pakistan Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir, who briefed him on his latest visit to Iran amid the ongoing tensions involving Tehran and Washington.

Munir concluded a short visit to Iran on Saturday during which he held high-level meetings with the Iranian leadership.

From Iran, Munir travelled to China to join Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif for talks with Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing on Monday. Sharif is on a four-day visit to China that began on Saturday. Munir met Wang separately in Beijing on Monday evening, according to an official Chinese statement.

During the meeting, Munir briefed Wang on the latest progress relating to efforts to defuse the US-Iran tensions and said that a deal between the warring parties is close to being reached, the statement said.

However, US President Donald Trump on Monday ordered fresh air strikes against Iranian targets despite the ceasefire between the two countries, signifying that there was no deal on hand yet. AGENCIES

Planes carrying 19 Australians linked to IS group land in Melbourne, Sydney

MELBOURNE: Two planes carrying 19 Australian women and children linked to the Islamic State group in Syria landed in Melbourne and Sydney on Tuesday, despite Australia's government warning that the returnees could face charges.

The government earlier confirmed seven women and 12 children were heading home on Qatar Airways flights, less than three weeks after a group of 13 people in similar situations returned to Australia's two largest cities. Two women with seven children flew to Melbourne. Four women with six children landed about an hour later in Sydney, a joint police and intelligence agency statement said.

No one had been charged on arrival, but investigations into their activities in Syria were continuing, the statement said. Three of four women who returned home earlier were charged with slavery and terrorism offences and remain behind bars.

Home Affairs Minister Tony Burke said anyone among the 19 on their way to Australia who has committed crimes "can expect to face the full force of the law."

Key Points

- The govt earlier confirmed seven women and 12 children were heading home on Qatar Airways flights
- Three of four women who returned home earlier were charged with slavery and terrorism offences

AUSTRALIAN AGENCIES HAVE BEEN PREPARING FOR THEIR RETURN SINCE 2014

"The government has not and will not provide any assistance to this group," Burke said in a statement. "These are people who have made the horrific choice to join a dangerous terrorist organisation and to place their children in an unspeakable situation," he added.

Australian law enforcement and intelligence agencies have been preparing for their return since 2014 and have long-standing plans in place to manage and monitor them, Burke said.

"The priority of the government, as always, is the safety of the Australian community," he said. Prime Minister Anthony Albanese had earlier told Parliament: "I have nothing but contempt for anyone who has any sympathy for ISIS," referring to IS by an acronym for the Islamic State of Iraq and Syria.

The bid by general practice doctor Jamal Rifi, a community leader in Sydney's Lebanese Muslim diaspora, to return 34 Australian women and children from Syria failed in February.

Syrian authorities blocked their convoy's route to Damascus and turned them back to Roj camp, a location in northeast Syria near the Iraq border where people linked to IS have been held since IS forces in the Middle East were defeated in 2019. AGENCIES

Hungary's Magyar vows to probe alleged misconduct by Orban's govt

BUDAPEST: Hungarian Prime Minister Peter Magyar told lawmakers on Tuesday his party's majority in Parliament will form investigative committees to look into alleged corruption and abuses of power by Viktor Orban and his previous government.

Magyar and his centre-right Tisza party defeated the autocratic leader in a landslide election last month. The win, which gave Tisza a two-thirds majority, allows it to roll back many of the policies that gave Orban a reputation among his critics as a far-right authoritarian.

Among Tisza's biggest campaign promises was holding Orban, his nationalist-populist Fidesz party and their allied business elites accountable for alleged misconduct.

Magyar said Tuesday six parliamentary investigative committees will be set up to examine a number of issues from Orban's tenure. AGENCIES

Why 40% of people are avoiding news: Expert

According to the latest report, 69% of Canadians at least occasionally avoid the news now

WATERLOO: During several recent conversations, people have told me that they've stopped checking their phones in the morning. Not because nothing was happening, but because everything was. They described the feeling as standing under a waterfall of perpetual bad news.

This experience is far from an isolated one. According to Reuters Institute's 2025 Digital News Report, 69 per cent of Canadians at least occasionally avoid the news now.

Globally, 40 per cent report they at least sometimes or often do the same, the highest figure ever recorded. People shared consistent reasons for this: the news put them in a bad mood, they felt overwhelmed and powerless to act.

As a researcher in developmental psychology, focusing on social development and psychological well-being, I argue that news fatigue is not laziness, weakness or a generational decline in civic interest. It's the predictable response of a human brain meeting an environment it was never designed to navigate.

Long before smartphones or even the printing press, our cognitive architecture was shaped by a single problem: stay alive long enough to reproduce. Our ancestors whose attention drifted past the rustle in the grass left fewer descendants than those who froze, looked and listened.

REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

The brain that paid attention to threats was the brain that survived.

This is the foundation of what psychologists call the negativity bias, one of the most replicated findings in cognitive science. Across decades of research, the human mind has been shown to weigh negative information more heavily than positive, attend to it faster and remember it longer.

A predator nearby mattered more than a beautiful sunset. The cost of missing a real threat was death, while the cost of overreacting was a few minutes of wasted vigilance. The asymmetry made this bias adaptive.

Here is the problem: the human brain has not changed since then. We are the same species as we were thousands of years ago. What's changed is the size of the world it's asked to scan for threats.

For most of human history, the threats our nervous system processed were local. A neighbouring tribe. A drought. The illness of a child we personally knew. Information about distant places would barely arrive, and if it did, it was mainly irrelevant.

Takeaways

- The brain that paid attention to threats was the brain that survived
- The cost of missing a real threat was death, while the cost of overreacting was a few minutes of wasted vigilance.

In 2026, the same neurological system is being asked to absorb a war in one region, a financial shock in another, a climate disaster in a third and a violent crime in a fourth, all before lunchtime.

A study published in the scientific journal Nature Human Behaviour examined more than 105,000 real news headlines viewed nearly six million times. Each additional negative word increased click-through rates, while positive words had the opposite effect.

Recent studies suggest people around the world demonstrate measurably stronger physiological responses to negative news than to positive news. The body is reacting before the mind has decided whether the threat is relevant.

Some researchers have introduced a clinical framework for what happens in this instance called Problematic News Consumption (PNC) — a pattern of news engagement that results in preoccupation, dysregulation and disruption to daily functioning. In their 2022 study, the researchers found that 17 per cent of American adults qualified as having severe levels of PNC. Among that group, 61 per cent reported feeling unwell quite a bit or very much, compared with six per cent of those who didn't.

For minority populations, news fatigue may be even more consequential.

Repeatedly witnessing harm directed at our own groups, even when we're not the immediate target, can have a significant psychological impact on people from the same group affiliation. AGENCIES

World Briefs

AHMADIYYA COMMUNITY ALLEGES HARASSMENT AHEAD OF EID IN KARACHI

KARACHI: Members of Pakistan's minority Ahmadiyya community have alleged that police in Karachi are seizing their sacrificial animals ahead of Eid-ul-Azha, saying they were being targeted because of their faith. "We have to face religious persecution and discrimination every time there is a religious festival," community representative Amir Mahmood said. He said members of the community in Karachi were finding it difficult to buy or keep sacrificial animals ahead of Eid-ul-Azha on Thursday due to police intimidation.

SENEGAL'S LAWMAKERS DEFY PRESIDENT, ELECT OUSTED SONKO AS SPEAKER

DAKAR: Senegal's National Assembly elected ousted Prime Minister Ousmane Sonko as parliament speaker on Tuesday, defying President Bassirou Diomaye Faye, who fired him days earlier and threatening political deadlock in a country already buckling under record debt. Sonko was sacked alongside all other ministers last week, following months of tensions between him and the president as the powerful partnership that drove them to power crumbled. His firing triggered the resignation of the parliament speaker. Faye named a new prime minister on Monday and is expected to announce a new cabinet in the coming days. Faye and Sonko took office following the March 2024 presidential election, promising to carry out ambitious reforms that included fighting corruption, creating jobs for Senegal's growing youth.

IN SHOW OF FORCE

North Korea launches ballistic missile, other weapons over sea

SEOUL: North Korea launched a close-range ballistic missile and other weapons toward the sea on Tuesday, South Korea's military said, days after the leaders of Russia and China voiced their opposition to Western pressures on North Korea.

The missile fired from Jongju, a city near the North's west coast, flew about 80 kilometres (50 miles), South Korea's Joint Chiefs of Staff said. North Korea launched other kinds of projectiles, it said, but didn't elaborate.

South Korean media, citing the military, reported that the other weapons systems mobilised included multiple rocket launch systems.

The reports said that the simultaneous launches of different kinds of weapons were likely meant to test the ability to evade South Korean and US defences.

South Korea's military said that it closely monitors activities in North Korea. It said that South Korea, with a solid alliance with the US, maintains a readiness to repel any provocations by North Korea.

It was North Korea's first weapons launch event since April 19, when the country fired multiple short-range missiles in what state media described as a demonstration of cluster bomb warheads.

North Korean leader Kim Jong Un has focused on modernising his nuclear and missile arsenals since his nuclear diplomacy with US President Donald Trump collapsed in 2019. In recent years, Kim has expanded ties with Russia by sending troops and conventional arms to support its war efforts against Ukraine. Kim has also pushed to cement cooperation with China, North Korea's economic pipeline.

In their summit in Beijing last week, Russian President Vladimir Putin and Chinese President Xi Jinping expressed their opposition to "foreign policy isolation, economic sanctions, military pressure and other methods of creating threats to the security" of North Korea, according to a statement from the Kremlin.

Russia and China, both veto-wielding members of the UN Security Council, have previously frustrated the US and others' efforts to toughen international sanctions on North Korea, despite its banned weapons tests.

Trump has repeatedly expressed his desire to resume talks with Kim, but Pyongyang has responded that Washington must first drop demands for the North's nuclear disarmament as a precondition for talks. AGENCIES

It was North Korea's first weapons launch event since April 19

Highlights

- The missile fired from Jongju, a city near the North's west coast, flew about 80 kilometres (50 miles)
- The reports said that the simultaneous launches of different kinds of weapons were likely meant to test the ability to evade South Korean and US defences

Rare public trial opens in Paris child abuse case

PARIS: Parents' groups in France called Tuesday for more attention to long-ignored child abuse scandals as a rare public trial opened of a school assistant accused of sexually assaulting nine small children in Paris.

Inspired by Gisele Pelicot's decision to make her harrowing drug and rape trial public, the parents of the children agreed to open the proceedings. In France, trials involving minors are usually held behind closed doors.

According to their lawyers, some parents said they were following the example of Pelicot and her motto that "shame must change sides" to abusers, not victims.

The Paris case emerged in April 2025 after several children told their parents they allegedly had been sexually abused at a nursery school.

The defendant, 36, who has not been publicly identified, is accused of assaulting children while supervising them in bathrooms, during lunch breaks and in after-school care between August 2024 and April 2025. He has denied any sexual abuse against children.

The children were between 3 and 5 years old at the time. They do not have to attend the trial. A judge has read their testimonies to investigators.

The defendant is also accused of sexually harassing two co-workers and sexually assaulting one of them. He faces up to 10 years in prison. His lawyer would not speak with The Associated Press before the trial.

Barka Zerouali, co-founder of parents' group MeToo Ecole, or MeToo School, said at a protest outside the courthouse that "there needs to be a national wake-up call at some point". Protesters carried a banner reading: "Because no child should be afraid to go to school."

Families said the trauma of the alleged assaults was compounded by what they described as a struggle to be taken seriously by authorities. An initial warning raised by a mother months earlier was apparently ignored by the school.

Rebecca Royer, a lawyer representing several families, said that "what we are expecting is a real turning point in child protection, meaning we expect the government and municipalities to implement real measures to protect children, but also to provide real resources." Similar cases in Paris and across France have drawn media attention in recent months.

Paris prosecutor Laure Beccuau last week said investigations were underway involving 84 nursery schools, about 20 elementary schools and about 10 daycare centers in the capital. Paris Mayor Emmanuel Gregoire said 78 school and after-school staff members have been suspended in the city since the beginning of 2026, including 31 over suspicions of sexual violence. AGENCIES

French President Emmanuel Macron winks as he delivers a speech during a meeting with the French electrification team AP/PTI

The Paris case emerged in April 2025 after several children told their parents they allegedly had been sexually abused at a nursery school

China, Pakistan agree to 'unswervingly safeguard' ties

ISLAMABAD/BEIJING: Pakistan and China have agreed to "unswervingly safeguard" and develop their bilateral relations by working closely to build a shared future, according to a joint statement issued on Tuesday.

The statement was issued at the end of Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's official visit to China from May 23-26 at the invitation of Premier Li Qiang.

During his visit, the two sides signed a number of cooperation documents in various fields.

President Xi Jinping and Premier Li separately held talks with PM Shehbaz, and the two sides reached a new broad consensus on further deepening the China-Pakistan All-Weather Strategic Cooperative Partnership and on international and regional issues of mutual interest.wShehbaz also attended the ceremony to commemorate the 75th anniversary of the establishment of diplomatic relations between the two countries and visited Hangzhou, Zhejiang Province.

Both sides reiterated opposition to any unilateral actions and reaffirmed the significance of maintaining peace and stability in South Asia and resolving all outstanding disputes through dialogue and diplomacy, the statement said.

Like in the previous joint statements after Pakistan leaders' visits, the new statement also said that the Pakistani side briefed the Chinese side on the latest developments on the situation in Jammu and Kashmir.

China, for its part, reiterated that the Jammu and Kashmir dispute is left over from history, and should be properly and peacefully resolved in accordance with the UN Charter, relevant UN Security Council resolutions and bilateral agreements. AGENCIES

"DURING PM VISIT, THE TWO SIDES SIGNED A NUMBER OF COOPERATION DOCUMENTS IN VARIOUS FIELDS"

US President Donald Trump sees doctors for his annual physical

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump is getting a medical exam on Tuesday, putting his health under renewed public scrutiny after he has worked to dismiss concerns over his age and stamina.

The 79-year-old president travelled to Walter Reed National Military Medical Centre for what the White House described as annual preventive medical and dental checkups.

It will be Trump's fourth publicly disclosed medical exam since he returned to office for a second term, and it comes as he tries to project strength ahead of midterm elections that will test his sway with voters.

For decades, administrations have released selected results from presidential physicals, offering the public a glimpse at the commander-in-chief's health. But the results are filtered through the White House and must be approved by the president, raising questions about what the public does and doesn't get to see.

Trump, a Republican, turns 80 next month and was the oldest person elected US president. His predecessor, President Joe Biden, a Democrat, was 82 when he left office, dropping out of the 2024 presidential race because of widespread concerns he was too old for the job. AGENCIES

RUSSIA'S CLAIM

'US did not grant visa for vice minister to attend UN'

WASHINGTON: Russia's U.N. ambassador said on Tuesday that the U.S. did not grant a visa for Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Alexander Alimov to attend a U.N. Security Council meeting and called it a breach of U.S. obligations under the U.N. Headquarters Agreement.Vassily Nebenzia made the comment at a meeting of the 15-member U.N. Security Council chaired by China's Foreign Minister Wang Yi that he said Alimov had intended to attend. The State Department and the U.S. U.N. mission did not immediately respond to questions about Nebenzia's statement.

"The Russian delegation ... based on the invitation of the Foreign Minister Wang Yi should have been represented during today's meeting at the level of the Deputy Foreign Minister for Foreign Affairs of the Russian Federation Alexander Alimov, who oversees matters related to the United Nations," Nebenzia said.

"However, despite all of our attempts to persuade the U.S. side to issue a visa to him, that visa was ultimately not granted," he added.

Nebenzia said that under the U.N. Headquarters Agreement, access to U.N. headquarters in New York "needs to be provided for all officials of member states, barring none."

He said Russia also viewed the issue as "an egregious instance of disrespect for the Chinese presidency of the Security Council, and of the topic that is under discussion today, that of the Charter of the United Nations." AGENCIES

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RO No. 441 **e-Tender Time Extension Notice** Dated : 26/05/2026

The dates of bids invited against e-tender No.: 01/EE(M)/2026-27 by office of the Executive Engineer (Monitoring) "Ujjwal", Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun are hereby extended as under:
Last date for submission of bids on portal-04-06-2026 up to 16:00 Hrs
Submission of original document to office of EE (M)-08-06-2026 up to 11:00 Hrs
Date & time of opening of bids on portal - 08-06-2026 at 15:00 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal "http://uktenders.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (Monitoring)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

BRANCH OFFICE: HOME LOAN CENTRE, A1/24, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 13.06.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act,2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated /charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on " As is Where is", As is What is" and Whatever there is" on 13.06.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under :-

Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.

Date / Time of E-Auction on 13.06.2026 for 8 Hours from 10:00 AM to 06:00 PM with unlimited extn. of 10 minute each.

S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property/ies is/are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Reserve Price (Rs.) (below which property could not be sold) / Earnest Money (EMD) 10% of the Reserve Price / Bid Increment Amount	Name of the Authorised Officer
1.	MR. RAJIV PANDEY Car Loan A/c. No. 41728424815 House No.2103A, 2nd Floor, Street No.13 Prem Nagar, New Delhi-110008.	Rs.3,00,760.00 as on 19.02.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: BALENO DELTA CNG 1.2L 5MT Vehicle No.: DL10CV0553 Engine No.: K12NP4213827 Chassis No.: MBHHWB13SPB389932	₹ 3,06,000.00 ₹ 30,600.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
2.	MS. RITU RITU Car Loan A/c. No. 43386792654 House No.5, Khasra No.79/12, Behind Biswa Choti Manta Mandir, Sheetla Colony, Gurgaon.	Rs.16,01,239.00 as on 19.02.2026 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: HONDA ELEVATE ZX CVT (I-VTEC) Vehicle No.: HR26FN2954 Engine No.: L15ZD2238269 Chassis No.: MAKDG587CR4016150	₹ 8,80,000.00 ₹ 88,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090

Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 13.06.2026 upto 9:00 A.M.
Account/ Wallet in which EMD to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT/RETS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/their bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT from his /her/their bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPDESK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE E-AUCTION ARE AS UNDER:
(1) E-Auction is being held on "As is where is", "as is what is basis " and "whatever there is basis "and will be conducted "On Line". The auction will be conducted through the Bank's approved service provider BAANKNET at their web portal: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing
(2) Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.
(3) The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 11.06.2026 from 11:00 AM to 17:00 Hrs , at Shriram Mall, Faridabad. Contact Person - Mr. Hemant Kumar Mobile: 9034545090, M/s. Suraj Legal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (Resolution Agent).
(4) Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.
(5) To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the property/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the property/ies put on auction and claims/tights/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid.
The e-Auction Advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any commitment or any representation of the Bank. The property is being sold with all the existing and future encumbrances whether known or unknown to the bank. The Authorized Officer shall not be responsible in any way for any third party claims/rights/ dues.
(6) The Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) of the successful bidder shall be retained towards part sale consideration and the EMD of the unsuccessful bidders shall be refunded. The Earnest Money Deposit shall not bear any Interest. The successful bidder shall have to deposit 25% of the sale price, immediately on acceptance of bid price by the Authorized Officer and the balance of the sale price on or before 15th day of the sale. Default in deposit of amount by the successful bidder would entail forfeiture of the whole money already deposited and property shall be put to the e-auction and the defaulting bidder shall have no claim/right in respect of property / amount.
(7) For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing & e-auction website: https://BAANKNET.com

Place: New Delhi Date: 26.05.2026 Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi

SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE

BRANCH OFFICE: HOME LOAN CENTRE, A1/24, JANAKPURI, NEW DELHI-110058

NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION SALE ON 29.06.2026 FOR MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Movable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act,2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described movable property hypothecated /charged to the Secured Creditor, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorized Officer State Bank of India, the Secured Creditor, will be sold on " As is Where is", As is What is" and Whatever there is" on 29.06.2026, for recovery of bank due to the secured creditor as under :-

Interested bidder may deposit Pre-Bid EMD with BAANKNET before the close of e-Auction. Credit of Pre-Bid EMD shall be given to the bidder only after receipt of payment in BAANKNET's Bank Account and up-dation of such information in the e-auction website. This may take some time as per banking process and hence bidders, in their own interest, are advised to submit the pre-bid EMD amount well in advance to avoid any last minute problem.

Date / Time of E-Auction on 29.06.2026 for 8 Hours from 10:00 AM to 06:00 PM with unlimited extn. of 10 minute each.

S. No.	Name of the Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s)	Outstanding Dues for Recovery of which Property/ies is/are being Sold	Vehicle Description	Reserve Price (Rs.) (below which property could not be sold) / Earnest Money (EMD) 10% of the Reserve Price / Bid Increment Amount	Name of the Authorised Officer
1.	SH. ASHISH KUMAR CHADHA S/O SH. ASHOK KUMAR CHADHA Car Loan A/c. No. 42189203638 257, Adarsh Apartment Sector 3, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075	Rs.6,28,341.00 as on 16.11.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: BALENO DELTA AGS Vehicle No.: DL9CBC5592 Engine No.: K12NP4307377 Chassis No.: MBHHWB13SPG516321 Mfg. Date: 07/2023 Fuel: Petrol / CNG	₹ 4,95,000.00 ₹ 49,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
2.	SH. KULDEEP SINGH S/O SH. MAHA SINGH Car Loan A/c. No. 42868852264 House No.12, Village Ranhola, Nangloi, New Delhi-110041	Rs.7,15,439.00 as on 06.08.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: MARUTI SWIFT ZXI CNG Vehicle No.: DL9CBE6791 Engine No.: K12NP1622571 Chassis No.: MBHCZCB3SRCE28884 Mfg. Date: 03/2024 Fuel: Petrol / CNG	₹ 5,85,000.00 ₹ 58,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
3.	MR. MADAN JHA S/O SH. LILADHAR JHA Car Loan A/c. No. 42427884970 House No.C-5, Arjun Park, Najafgarh, New Delhi-110043	Rs.5,56,542.00 as on 08.12.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: TATA ALTROZ XM 1.2 CNG BS-6 PH-2 Vehicle No.: DL10CW4430 Engine No.: REVTRN16HWXMF8437 Chassis No.: MAT632245PPHD8145 Mfg. Date: 10/2023 Fuel: Petrol / CNG	₹ 4,05,000.00 ₹ 40,500.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
4.	MS. SUSHILA W/O ZILE SINGH Car Loan A/c. No. 40728441486 A-410, A Block, Hastsal J J Colony, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059.	Rs.4,47,382.00 as on 18.10.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: VENUE 1.2 KAPPA MTS + Vehicle No.: DL4CBA9188 Engine No.: G4LAMM088712 Chassis No.: MALFC81BLNM289794 Mfg. Date: 12/2022 Fuel: Petrol	₹ 3,10,000.00 ₹ 31,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090
5.	SH. SHOBHIT DUA W/O SH SANJEEV DUA Car Loan A/c. No. 43946736285 474, 3rd Floor, Sainik Vihar, Pitampura, New Delhi-110034.	Rs.12,32,983.00 as on 25.12.2025 plus future Interest and other Charges etc. thereon	Make & Model: SYROS G1 0T 7 DCT HTK PLUS Vehicle No.: DL10CZ4859 Engine No.: G3LCSM362270 Chassis No.: MZBB2811VSN013640 Mfg. Date: 02/2025 Fuel: Petrol / Ethanol	₹ 9,90,000.00 ₹ 99,000.00 ₹ 10,000.00 *GST as applicable	Mr. Kapil Muni Yadav (Chief Manager) HLC, A1/24, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058. Tel-011-79681631 Mr. Hemant Mobile: 9034545090

Last Date of EMD Deposit on or before 29.06.2026 upto 9:00 A.M.
Account/ Wallet in which EMD to be remitted : Bidder's own wallet Registered with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT/RETS. EMD of Reserve Price to be transferred by bidders by means of challan generated on his/her/their bidder account maintained with BAANKNET on its e-auction site: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing by means of NEFT from his /her/their bank. For any assistance, please call BAANKNET HELPDESK: +91 8291220220, support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com and/or Authorized Officer.

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(2) Bank shall reserve the right to cancel/postpone the auction.
(3) The Vehicle are available for inspection during banking hours on 26.06.2026 from 11:00 AM to 17:00 Hrs , at Shriram Mall, Faridabad. Contact Person - Mr. Hemant Kumar Mobile: 9034545090, M/s. Suraj Legal Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (Resolution Agent).
(4) Successful bidder to pay GST as applicable on the successful bid amount, viz sale value.
(5) To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer there is no encumbrance on the property/ies. However the intending bidder should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of the property/ies put on auction and claims/tights/dues/affecting the property prior to submitting their bid.
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(7) For detailed terms and conditions of the sale please refer to the link at the Bank's Service Provider's web portal: https://baanknet.com/eauction-psb/eproc-listing & e-auction website: https://BAANKNET.com

Place: New Delhi Date: 26.05.2026 Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi

RBI TO BE ON WAIT-AND-WATCH MODE FOR NOW: ECONOMISTS

Fuel price hikes, Gold & silver duty could push inflation to 5% by June

Over a period of 11 days, starting May 15, petrol prices have been hiked by Rs 7.38/ltr, diesel prices by Rs 7.48/ltr with some inter-city variation

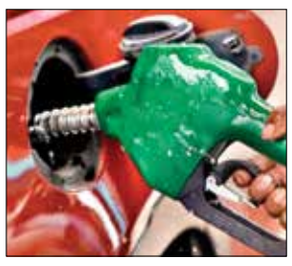
OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Fuel price hikes and higher import duties on gold and silver could push retail inflation to 5 per cent by June, but the RBI will wait and watch till the impact of fuel price hike settles in before tightening interest rates in the second half of the fiscal year, economists said.

Over a period of 11 days, starting May 15, petrol prices have been increased by Rs 7.38/ltr and diesel prices by Rs 7.48/ltr with some inter-city variation. These price hikes will directly cascade into impacting prices in sectors where petrol and diesel are used as inputs such as transport and storage and to some extent electricity.

Besides, the government on May 13 had hiked import duty on gold and silver to 15 per cent to curb non-essential imports.

"After an overall increase averaging about Rs 7.5/ltr in petroleum products, CPI inflation would go up by about 75 basis points. In May 2026, CPI inflation may thus be in the range of 4-4.5 per cent and June CPI may be in the range of 4.5-5 per cent," EY India Chief Policy Advisor D K Srivastava said.



Besides, the govt on May 13 had hiked import duty on gold and silver to 15% to curb non-essential imports

The CPI inflation data for May is scheduled to be released on June 12.

"Since the increase in CPI is cost driven, adjustments in repo rate may have limited effect in containing inflation. RBI may like to wait until the fuel price hike settles down and examine its impact over a quarter before taking a decision. However, If CPI inflation crosses the level of 5 per cent and shows upward momentum, RBI may start tightening interest rates," Srivastava said.

Highlights

- 'After an overall increase averaging about Rs 7.5/ltr in petroleum products, CPI inflation would go up by about 75 basis points'
- 'In May 2026, CPI inflation may thus be in the range of 4-4.5 per cent and June CPI may be in the range of 4.5-5 per cent'
- The CPI inflation data for May is scheduled to be released on June 12

India Ratings & Research (Ind-Ra) Director Megha Arora said she expects June CPI to surpass 4 per cent but remain within the RBI's upper tolerance band of 6 per cent. Economists expect the RBI's monetary policy committee (MPC) to persist with its "neutral pause" in the June 5 meeting, keeping all policy rates unchanged.

Since the last MPC policy announcement on April 8, but WPI inflation has flared up to 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April, reflecting the global commodity price pressures. With inadequate passthrough, retail or consumer price index (CPI) based inflation rose modestly to 3.48 per cent in April.

With the petrol, diesel price hikes beginning mid-May, the CPI inflation print for May is expected to show uptick with full impact being visible in June CPI inflation.

The RBI mainly takes into account CPI inflation while deciding on monetary policy rates. "While we believe there will be no policy rate action in June, we are incrementally getting worried that as this uncertain backdrop lingers, spillover effects to transportation fare, other raw material costs and finally output prices may make inflation outcome in 2HFY27 (October-March) difficult to digest, necessitating a rate hike," Barclays India Chief Economist Aastha Gudwani said.

In the April 2026 Monetary policy report, the RBI's base case assumed crude oil at $85/bbl for its growth and inflation forecasts. With reality decisively shifting to the $95/bbl scenario, Barclays expects the RBI to revise its FY27 inflation forecast from 4.6 per cent to 5 per cent and cut its growth forecast to 6.7 per cent (from 6.9 per cent) after the June 5 MPC meeting.

India Ratings & Research Director Megha Arora said based on the four fuel price hikes so far, June CPI inflation is likely to be higher by around 38 bps, with an upside risk from further passthrough. June CPI is likely to surpass 4 per cent but remain within RBI's upper tolerance band of 6 per cent.

The RBI has the mandate to keep inflation at 4 per cent with a tolerance band of 2 per cent on either side. Crisil Principal Economist Dipti Deshpande said the rating agency expects average inflation at 5.1 per cent in current fiscal year.

"Inflationary pressures at present are largely supply-driven, stemming from elevated fuel and input costs, along with a weaker rupee. As such, the MPC may choose to look through these supply-side pressures in its policy assessment. However, the committee is likely to remain watchful of the risk of spillovers to household inflation expectations, and the possibility of second-round effects leading to broader generalisation of price pressures," Deshpande said.

Markets snap 2-day rally, Sensex drops 480 pts on spike in oil prices

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower in a volatile trade on Tuesday following a spike in crude oil prices amid reports of fresh US military operations in southern Iran.

Besides, losses in financial and banking stocks amid a weak rupee dragged the indices lower, traders said.

The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 479.26 points, or 0.63 per cent, to settle at 76,009.70. During the day, it tanked 579.28 points, or 0.75 per cent, to 75,909.68.

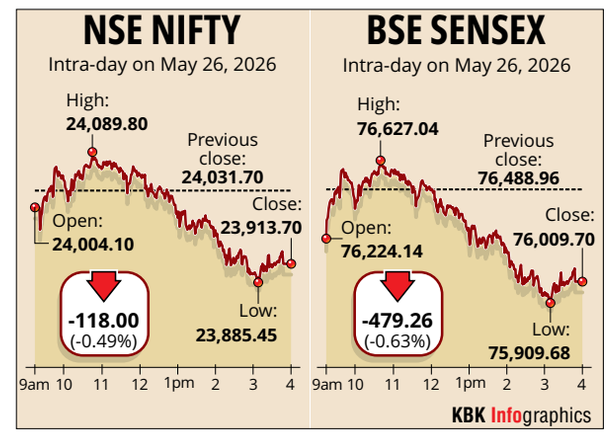
Similarly, the 50-share NSE Nifty dropped 118 points, or 0.49 per cent, to end at 23,913.70.

From the Sensex pack, Bharti Airtel, Trent, Tata Consultancy Services, Bajaj Finance, Titan and HDFC Bank were among the biggest laggards.

In contrast, Tech Mahindra, Eternal, Maruti and Adani Ports were among the winners.

The BSE MidCap Select index went up by 0.27 per cent, and the SmallCap Select index edged higher by 0.26 per cent.

Fuel-intensive sectors such as aviation, paints, chemicals, logistics and cement are likely to face headwinds due to rising input costs, while oil marketing companies may continue to face margin pressure if crude oil prices remain elevated, Siddhartha Khemka - Head of Research, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, said.



From Sensex pack, Bharti Airtel, Trent, Tata Consultancy Services, Bajaj Finance, Titan and HDFC Bank were among the biggest laggards

Among sectoral indices, Consumer Durables dropped 0.86 per cent, Top 10 Banks (0.61 per cent), Realty (0.52 per cent), Hospitals (0.52 per cent), PSU Bank (0.47 per cent) and Bankex (0.31 per cent).

Utilities jumped 1.15 per cent, Metal (1.02 per cent), Power (0.86 per cent), and Capital Goods (0.52 per cent).

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 2.93 per cent to USD 98.96 per barrel.

US President Donald Trump on Monday said negotiations with Iran to end the war were progressing "nicely", but officials pointed out that a final decision may take some time due to the complex communication networks Tehran deploys to consult with its supreme leader.

The sharp rebound in Brent crude prices once again became a key pressure point for Indian equities, he added.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi ended higher, while Japan's Nikkei, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng settled lower. Markets in Europe were trading mostly lower.

US markets were closed on Monday for Memorial Day.

FIIs bought equities worth Rs 821.75 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

In the previous session on Monday, the Sensex jumped 1,073.61 points, or 1.42 per cent, to settle at 76,488.96.

The Nifty surged 312.40 points, or 1.32 per cent, to end at 24,031.70.

Rupee falls 44 paise to 95.70 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 44 paise to close at 95.70 against the US dollar on Tuesday, on renewed geopolitical tensions in West Asia and a rise in crude oil prices. Forex traders said a strong US dollar and weak domestic markets also pressured the rupee.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.43 against the US dollar, and touched an intra-day high of 95.33 and a low of 95.76 against the American currency.

At the end of Tuesday's close, the rupee was quoted at 95.70, down 44 paise from its previous closing.

On Monday, the rupee gained 34 paise to close at 95.26 against the US dollar with the RBI selling dollars and keeping the rupee well bid at all upper levels.

"We expect the rupee to trade with a negative bias on uncertainty between the US and Iran and concerns over military action in the Middle East. "However, softening of crude oil prices from higher levels may support the rupee at lower levels. USDINR spot price is expected to trade in a range of 95.20 to 95.85," said Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst at Mirae Asset ShareKhan.

Forex traders said the rupee remains vulnerable to rising crude oil prices and the strength of the American currency in the overseas market. The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.05, down 0.19 per cent. PTI

Reserve Bank's dollar-rupee swap auction subscribed 2 times

The central bank received bids worth $9.80 bn, but accepted just $5 bn for a cut-off premium of 910 paise

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) USD/INR buy/sell swap auction on Tuesday received robust responses with nearly twice subscriptions than the notified amount.

The central bank received bids worth $9.80 billion, but accepted just $5 billion for a cut-off premium of 910 paise, according to the RBI's release. The notified amount of the auction was $5 billion.

The release said the RBI received 254 bids at the auction and accepted 144 bids. The bid-to-cover ratio stood at 1.96.

The partial allotment as percentage of competitive bids at cut-off premium stands at 18.10 per cent, the RBI said.

The auction will have an initial leg on May 29, and the second leg, which is a reversal of funds, will be on May 29, 2029.

In the first leg of the transaction, banks will sellUS dollars to the Reserve Bank at FBIL reference rate of the auction date.

The settlement of the first leg of the swap will take place on-spot basis from the date of transaction and the Reserve Bank will credit the rupee funds to the current account of the successful bidder and the bidder needs to deliver US dollars into the RBI's nostro account.

In the reverse leg of the swap transaction, rupee funds will have to be returned to the Reserve Bank, along with the swap premium, to get the US dollars back.

Currently, the liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of around Rs 67,285.42 crore as on May 25, as per the RBI's data. PTI

KVIC sees record sale of ₹1,87,105 cr in FY26

The Khadi & Village Industries Commission Chairman Manoj Kumar expressed confidence that sales of products will cross Rs 2.51 lakh crore in FY27

NEW DELHI: Sales of Khadi and Village Industries products reached a record Rs 1,87,105 crore in 2025-26, the highest-ever sales figure, the Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) said on Tuesday.

Sales during the previous financial year FY25 stood at Rs 1,70,551.37 crore, and have surged multi-fold from Rs 31,154 crore in 2013-14.

The KVIC Chairman Manoj Kumar expressed confidence that sales of KVIC products will cross Rs 2.51 lakh crore in FY27.

He informed that while the production of Khadi and Village Industry products remained at Rs 26,109 crore in the financial year 2013-14, it surged nearly five-fold, registering a jump of 380 per cent, to reach

Rs 1,25,296 crore in the financial year FY26.

While cumulative employment in activities related to Khadi and Village Industries stood at 1.30 crore in the year 2013-14, it has augmented to 2.04 crore in FY26, marking a growth of 56 per cent, thereby highlighting KVIC's vital role in generating rural livelihoods, KVIC stated.

Under the Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP), 66,494 new units were established during the financial year 2025-26 and for these units, a margin money subsidy of Rs 2,457 crore was disbursed against loans amounting to Rs 7,375 crore.

Through these units, employment opportunities were provided to 7,31,434 people, KVIC stated.

The KVIC will soon launch a revamped version of its e-commerce portal for 'Khadi India' products, Chairman Manoj Kumar said.

According to officials, the upgraded e-commerce portal powered by Shopify will offer a user interface aligned with global standards. It will have clearly defined categories for simplified product discovery and interactive elements, such as "Shop the Look", for users.

The platform, designed with a mobile-first approach, will have features such as improved product display through high-resolution images, along with an optimised checkout and payment experience, besides strengthened brand storytelling, showcasing Khadi as a contemporary lifestyle choice to appeal to younger, digitally savvy consumers while retaining its traditional values. "KVIC is now moving towards digital transformation in the new India. Very soon, in the coming days, we are going to launch Khadi's e-commerce portal, which will be modern and suit Gen Z. We are revamping our entire digital ecosystem," KVIC Chairman Kumar said. AGENCIES

Gold drops ₹2,800, silver jumps ₹2K to ₹2,73,000/kg

NEW DELHI: Gold prices declined by Rs 2,800 to Rs 1.62 lakh per 10 grams in the national capital on Tuesday as military tensions between Washington and Tehran drove investors towards the US dollar.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity depreciated by Rs 2,800 to Rs 1,62,400 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes). On Monday, gold had settled higher at Rs 1,65,200 per 10 grams.

Silver, however, rose Rs 2,000 to Rs 2,73,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes), as per the association.

It had finished at Rs 2,71,000 per kg in the previous session.

In the international markets, spot gold fell nearly 1 per cent to $4,534.69 per ounce, while silver slipped a little over 2 per cent to $76.49 per ounce.

Analyst said market sentiment weakened after reports of fresh US military strikes on southern Iran despite ongoing negotiations in Qatar aimed at preserving a seven-week-old ceasefire.

Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst - Commodity and Currency at LKP Securities, said investors are now awaiting the upcoming US Core Personal Consumption Expenditures (PCE) inflation and GDP numbers, which could significantly influence the Federal Reserve's expectations and bullion movement in the near term. PTI

Adani Green Energy boosts BESS capacity to 3.37 GWh at Khavda

NEW DELHI: Adani Green Energy Ltd on Tuesday said it has expanded its total operational Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) capacity to 3.37 GWh at Khavda, Gujarat.

The company has expanded total operational BESS capacity to 3.37 GWh, including 1.37 GWh added in March 2026 at Khavda, where it is building 30 GW renewable energy park, of which 9.9 GW is already operational, Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL) said in a statement.

This is the world's largest single-location battery storage deployment outside China and among the fastest executed globally, it added.

AGEL's 3.37 GWh BESS can store enough clean energy to power nearly one million homes for an entire day, supporting peak electricity demand of cities like Indore, Chandigarh or the entire state of Goa.

It can also power more than 12 million LED bulbs continuously for ten hours.

The commissioning marks a major milestone in strengthening grid reliability, peak-hour supply and enabling renewable energy to deliver dependable, round-the-clock power at scale, AGEL said, adding that it plans to add over 10 GWh of battery storage capacity in FY27 and scale this to 50 GWh over the next five years.

"Large-scale energy storage will play a defining role in the next phase of India's clean energy transition. As renewable energy capacity scales rapidly, storage infrastructure becomes critical for delivering reliable, round-the-clock clean power. Our investments in battery storage reflect a long-term commitment to building future-ready clean energy infrastructure at global scale," Sagar Adani, Executive Director, AGEL, said.

AGEL develops, owns, and operates utility scale grid-connected solar, wind, hybrid and energy storage solutions. The company currently has an operating renewable portfolio of 19.7 GW, the largest in India, spread across 12 states. MPOST

Union Bank to raise ₹8K cr through debt & equity mix

NEW DELHI: Union Bank of India on Tuesday approved raising of up to Rs 8,000 crore, which would include the issuance of equities worth Rs 3,000 crore.

In a BSE filing, Union Bank said the board has approved raising of debt capital through Basel III-compliant additional Tier 1 bonds and/or Tier 2 not exceeding Rs 5,000 crore.

Besides, the board has approved raising Rs 3,000 crore equity capital in tranches within the overall limit of Rs 8,000 crore, through Public Issue (i.e. Further Public Offer) and/

or rights issue and/or private placements, including Qualified Institutions Placements and/or Preferential Allotment.

"The board of directors, in its meeting held on May 26, 2026, considered and approved the plan of the bank to raise capital by an amount not exceeding Rs 8,000 crore," the filing said. PTI

'SEBI to assess relaxing disclosure rules for debt issuers'

'SEBI will also launch a pilot on bond tokenisation to check if it helps in faster trade settlement'

MUMBAI: Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey on Tuesday said the regulator will review whether debt-only listed entities require the same disclosure norms as equity-listed firms under listing regulations, as part of efforts to deepen the corporate bond market.

"There is a need to review whether debt-only listed entities need the same rigour under LODR (listing obligations and disclosure requirements) regulations as equity-listed companies," Pandey said.

SEBI will also launch a pilot

Sebi Chief Tuhin Kanta Pandey

on bond tokenisation using distributed ledger technology to examine whether it can enable faster settlement, better traceability, automated servicing and greater transparency in bond trades. Pandey said the regulator remains open to innovation but will proceed cautiously.

CLOSER LOOK

- 'There is a need to review whether debt-only listed entities need same rigour under listing obligations and disclosure requirements regulations as equity-listed firms'
- 'Sebi is exploring a separate regulatory classification for debt brokers to reduce costs, lower entry barriers and encourage specialised debt market intermediaries'

He added that Sebi is exploring a separate regulatory classification for debt brokers to reduce costs, lower entry barriers and encourage specialised debt market intermediaries. Exchanges are also ready to launch the corporate bond repo platform once the RBI issues final guidelines.

Pandey said Sebi is reviewing the municipal debt securities framework to help civic bodies raise funds for urban infrastructure, enable pooled financing and increase retail participation.

Outstanding corporate bonds have risen from about Rs 17.5 lakh crore at the end of FY15 to over Rs 59 lakh crore, expanding at an annual rate of 12 per cent.

In FY26, debt issuances mobilised Rs 9.1 lakh crore, nearly double the amount raised through equity markets.

However, retail participation remains limited. Citing a Sebi survey, Pandey said awareness of corporate bonds stands at only 10 per cent, while household penetration is below 1 per cent. AGENCIES

TCS launches sovereign cloud offering for customers in EU

MUMBAI: The country's largest IT services company TCS on Tuesday announced that it has launched a sovereign cloud offering for customers in the European Union.

The SovereignSecure Cloud offering is designed for governments, public sector enterprises, and regulated industries, as per an official statement.

Enterprises will be able to achieve digital autonomy, strengthen regulatory compliance and enhanced security using the offering, which combines sovereign cloud architecture with AI capabilities to enable sovereignty across data,

operations and digital infrastructure. The company said the same offering was first launched in India last year and has since been rolled out in Kenya, East Africa, and the Philippines.

It comprises a sovereign cloud layer delivered through hyperscalers, providing scale and the flexibility to operate securely within the EU regulatory framework, the statement said, adding that national sovereign cloud layer enables country-specific localisation while bringing operations under a unified control plane.

"European organisations are looking to strike a balance between addressing supply chain and sovereignty risks while ensuring leverage of frontier technologies to be globally competitive," the company's head of Europe Sapthagiri Chapalapalli said.

TCS has been present in Europe for 45 years and has 58 offices in the continent. PTI

Fertiliser subsidy likely to cross ₹3 lakh crore in FY27: Official

Budgetary allocation for fertiliser subsidies in FY27 stands at Rs 1.71L cr

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's fertiliser subsidy bill could cross Rs 3 lakh crore in the current fiscal if the disruptions resulting from the West Asia crisis prolong, a senior government official has said.

The budgetary allocation for fertiliser subsidies in 2026-27 stands at Rs 1.71 lakh crore, but the subsidy bill is set to rise due to a sharp increase in prices of urea, Di-Ammonium Phosphate (DAP) and other soil-nutrients in the global market.

At a conference organised by the Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER) on Monday, Krishna Kant Pathak, joint secretary in the Department of Fertilizers, asserted that the government currently has sufficient stocks of fertilisers, almost 20 million tonnes.

He informed that the fertilisers are being sourced from different countries through long-term agreements.

"But, it has a cost. The cost, which prior to this war situation was almost Rs 2 lakh crore in subsidies. It will grow substantially, and it will be a burden for us," Pathak said at the event, the video of which was released on the ICRIR website.

"...it (fertiliser subsidy) could be more than Rs 3 lakh crore if the problem persists," the joint secretary said. It is difficult to project the total subsidy bill at this stage, he said. Pathak was speaking at a roundtable discussion on 'De-risking India's Fertiliser Supply Chain and Demand Management Amid Rising Geopolitical Risks'.

India consumes around 70 million tonnes of fertilisers annually, he pointed out.

Pathak also expressed concern over the diversion of urea for industrial usage. On Monday, the Centre asserted that there is adequate availability of fertilisers in the country to meet the demand for soil nutrients during the upcoming Kharif (summer-sown) season.

At an inter-ministerial briefing on West Asia developments, Aparna S Sharma, Additional Secretary, Department of Fertilizers, said the domestic output post-crisis has been good, and the country is also importing fertilisers to ensure sufficient supply. "The overall stock position of fertiliser in the country remains comfortable," she said.

Against the assessment of 390.54 lakh tonne of fertiliser for the Kharif season this year, the stock as of date is 200.12 lakh tonne, the secretary said.

According to Sharma, the fertiliser stock is more than 50 per cent of projected Kharif demand, significantly higher than the usual 33 per cent.

The Department of Agriculture has assessed the fertiliser requirement for Kharif 2026 at 390.54 lakh tonne. The Kharif sowing operation will begin in June. Sharma also highlighted that the domestic production and import of fertilisers after the crisis have been substantial.

The total domestic production has been about 95 lakh tonne, and about 22.60 lakh tonne of imports have reached Indian shores. So, a total of 117.6 lakh tonne of fertilisers have been added to the stock.

"This will ensure adequate availability during the peak Kharif season," Sharma said.

In 2025, nearly 73 per cent of the country's total fertiliser requirement was met through domestic production.

The total domestic production of fertilisers, including urea, DAP, NPKs and SSP, has increased from 433.29 lakh tonne in 2021 to a record 524.62 lakh tonne in 2025. India imports a large quantity of urea and diammonium phosphate (DAP) to meet local demand.

The country's urea production has increased from 225 lakh tonne during 2014-15 to 306.67 lakh tonne in 2024-25. The country imported more than 100 lakh tonne of urea last fiscal to meet local demand.

At present, the MRP of neem-coated urea is Rs 242 per bag (45kg), while the DAP is being sold at Rs 1,350 per bag (50kg).

Krishna Kant Pathak, joint secretary in the Department of Fertilizers informed that the fertilisers are being sourced from different countries through long-term agreements

Highlights

- 'The government currently has sufficient stocks of fertilisers, almost 20 million tonnes'
- India consumes around 70 million tonnes of fertilisers annually, Pathak pointed out
- Pathak also expressed concern over the diversion of urea for industrial usage
- Against assessment of 390.54 lakh tonne of fertiliser for the Kharif season, stock as of date is 200.12 lakh tonne

'Enforcing anti-dumping duties can save India ₹28,540 cr/annum'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The non-implementation of the recommended anti-dumping duties has resulted in an annual economic loss of Rs 11,938 crore to the domestic industry, whereas the imposition of these levies could generate an additional Rs 28,540 crore annually in forex by reducing imports, a report said on Tuesday.

The Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR), under the commerce ministry, conducts investigations into alleged dumping as a quasi-judicial authority, whereas the finance ministry takes the final call to impose these duties.

"The non-implementation of anti-dumping duties on 56 DGTR-recommended products has resulted in an annual economic loss of Rs 11,938 crore to the domestic industry.

"Whereas, imposition of DGTR-recommended anti-dumping duty could additionally generate about RS 28,540 crore ($3 billion) in annual foreign exchange savings by enabling domestic manufacturers to meet domestic demand instead of imports," according to the C-DEP Research and Centre for WTO Studies report - Impact of Anti-Dumping Duties in India.

A study of 33 products shows that economic loss from dumped imports in the current period is about Rs 1.54 lakh crore, and is projected to rise to Rs 2.70 lakh crore by 2030, with jobs loss increasing from around 24,000 at present to 38,000-42,000 by 2030, it said.

The report has examined the effects of anti-dumping duties on downstream costs, inflation, MSMEs, domestic capacity, and investments.

Anti-dumping duties are WTO-compliant trade-remedy instruments that are levied globally by governments to safeguard their domestic manufacturers from predatory pricing by foreign exporters, who dump the imported products at prices that are lower than the prices in their home country.

Dumping occurs when a product is exported at a price lower than its normal value. For instance, if a chemical is sold domestically in China for $100 per metric tonne but exported to India at $70 per metric tonne, the dumping margin (difference between the normal value and export price) is $30 per metric tonne, or 30 per cent.

The report said that a notable shift has emerged in recent years in the implementation pattern of DGTR recommendations.

While India historically implemented nearly 99.5 per cent of the recommendations until 2020, rejection and non-implementation rates have risen sharply, it said, adding that the rejection ratio has increased to 81 per cent during November 2025-April 2026 from 16 per cent during April-November 2025.

The report also said that the antidumping duties in the US remain in force for an average of 16.26 years before they are withdrawn, while in India, it is only 6.97 years.

It said that non-implementation of anti-dumping duties reduces domestic capacity utilisation, thereby significantly dampening committed and new investments, leading to weakening of long-term industrial resilience and increasing the supply-demand gap in the economy.

"Non-implementation of anti-dumping duties risks suppressing domestic investment today, which could translate into a substantial structural demand-supply gap by 2030," it said, adding that continued exposure to dumped imports may leave India reliant on foreign suppliers in sectors where domestic capacity exists.

Timely and WTO-compliant implementation of anti-dumping duties provides a direct mechanism to stabilise investment expectations, safeguard existing capacities, and ensure that the domestic industry can meet projected demand, supporting India's trajectory toward a Viksit Bharat, it said.

Govt to sell up to 2% in Coal India; OFS opens today

NEW DELHI: The government will sell up to 2 per cent stake in Coal India through an offer for sale at a floor price of Rs 412 apiece beginning Wednesday.

The sale of up to 2 per cent stake or about 12.32 crore shares at Rs 412 apiece would fetch about Rs 5,000 crore to the exchequer.

The OFS (offer for sale) will open for non-retail investors on May 27, and for retail investors on May 29.

"Govt of India announces OFS in Coal India Limited with a base offer of 1 per cent of its equity and an additional 1 per cent Green Shoe Option in case of oversubscription. Floor price fixed at Rs 412 per share," Department of Investment & Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said in a post on X.

Shares of Coal India closed at Rs 458.25 on the BSE on Tuesday, up 0.25 per cent from the previous close.

The floor price of Rs 412/share is at a 10 per cent discount over the current market price.

With strong operational and financial performance, consistent returns and attractive dividends, CIL continues to offer a compelling long-term investment opportunity, Chawla added.

Coal India would be the second OFS of a public sector company in the current fiscal year. Last week, the government sold 8.08 per cent in Central Bank of India via OFS and raised Rs 2,266 crore. PTI

Tata Sons board meet concludes in Mumbai in presence of Noel Tata

MUMBAI: A board meeting of Tata Sons, the holding company of the salt-to-software conglomerate, concluded on Tuesday.

Directors of the board, including Tata Trusts' chairman Noel Tata, arrived at its headquarters Bombay House in the morning and left in the late afternoon. N Chandrasekaran, the chairman of the group, did not speak to the waiting media on the decisions at the board meeting while exiting the group headquarters in South Mumbai.

A discussion on Chandrasekaran's reappointment was unlikely at the board meeting, which comes amid rising frictions within the Tata group.

Chandrasekaran and Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata, who is a nominee director on the Tata Sons board, are understood to have met over the weekend to discuss the same matter on the performance of the group companies. In FY25, Tata group's unlisted businesses posted a loss of Rs 10,905 crore, which is likely to go up to Rs 29,000 crore, according to reports.

It can be noted that the Tata group, which includes the Tata Trusts owning two-thirds of Tata Sons, the holding company of the group, has seen a lot of top-level friction lately, which has included expulsions or attempts to expel some members and also a deferment on a decision on Chandrasekaran's continuation as the chairman of Tata Sons.

According to reports, Noel Tata is concerned about the mounting losses at Tata Sons, particularly from new businesses started under the helm of Chandrasekaran, such as Tata Digital and the electronics ventures, and also the financially struggling carrier Air India, which was bought from the government a few years ago.

Noel Tata is also reluctant to take Tata Sons public through an IPO. At present, Tata Sons, a core investment company, has been classified as among the top-15 non-bank finance companies (NBFCs) by the RBI, which are mandated to list. Neville Tata, the son of Noel Tata, has already been inducted into a few of the trusts or foundations linked to the group. PTI

India-Canada talks on free trade pact can be concluded before year end target, says Goyal

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday said officials of India and Canada are negotiating the proposed free trade agreement with full sincerity, and the talks could even be concluded before the end of this year, possibly by October. He said that immense opportunities are there for businesses of both countries to enhance collaborations in areas such as innovation, seafood, education, finance, insurance, biotechnology and pharmaceuticals.

Goyal, speaking at a business event in Toronto, said that the prime ministers of India and Canada have "tasked both (Canada's Trade Minister) Maninder (Sidhu) and me to make sure that we work in a mission mode and finalise a very comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA) before the end of the year".

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

The minister is in Canada for a three-day official visit, starting on May 25. He is leading a delegation of industry leaders from over 100 companies.

He added that Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has suggested concluding the negotiations by the end of November, that is, before the G20 Summit.

"Thank god he didn't say we should deliver before the G20 trade ministerial, because that is in October, but possibly we can. And I suspect, the sincerity that I've seen in both the negotiating teams, don't be surprised if they actually can deliver even faster than targeted," he added.

The 2026 G20 Summit is scheduled to be held on December 14-15, 2026, in Miami, United States, under the presidency of the US. The two countries have also set a target to increase the bilateral trade from $17 billion at present to $50 billion by 2030, Goyal said.

Goyal has called on Carney in Ottawa, and both sides expressed optimism about the early conclusion of the trade pact negotiations.

In a social media post, Carney said, "We're negotiating a free trade deal with India. This will be a game changer for Canadian workers and businesses, unlocking a massive new market. We're working fast. I met Minister @PiyushGoyal to review our progress so far and explore the opportunities ahead for both our countries in energy, agri-food, tech, and education."

The two countries are negotiating a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA). Two rounds of negotiations have been completed. The third round is going on in Ottawa from May 25 to 29.

In such pacts, two trading partners significantly reduce and eliminate import duties on the maximum number of goods traded between them. Besides, they also ease norms to promote trade in services and boost investments. PTI

Telecom subscriber base grows to 133.7 crore in April, Airtel stays on top, says Trai data

NEW DELHI: Bharti Airtel stayed on top in terms of subscriber growth across segments, adding 34.82 lakh net new customers in April, according to the latest Trai data released on Tuesday.

The company pipped its rival Reliance Jio in net subscriber addition in the wireline segment as well during the month under review.

The total telecom subscriber base grew by 69.5 lakh in April to an all-time high of 133.75 crore, according to the monthly subscribers report released by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (Trai).

"The number of total telephone subscribers in India increased from 1,330.58 million at the end of March 2026 to 1,337.54 million at the end of April 2026, thereby showing a monthly growth rate of 0.52 per cent," the report said.

Airtel's net new subscriber addition stood at 34.82 lakh, comprising 31.39 lakh in the wireless or mobile segment and 3.43 lakh in the wireline segment in April 2026.

Jio's net subscriber addition stood at 30.84 lakh, which includes 29.42 lakh new mobile connections and 1.42 lakh wireline connections.

The wireless subscriber base, which includes mobile and fixed wireless access connections, increased to 128.89 crore at the end of April 2026 from 128.23 crore recorded in the preceding month.

Vodafone Idea (Vi) added 53,257 new subscribers, and BSNL added 76,175. The growth in the segment was marginally mitigated with state-run telecom MTNL losing 33,403 subscribers. The number of wireline subscribers increased to 4.85 crore at the end of April 2026 from 4.82 crore in March. All three private telecom operators and BSNL gained subscribers while MTNL and Tata Teleservices were losers in the segment.

Tata Teleservices lost 82,407 customers, and MTNL lost 76,633 connections.

The total number of broadband subscribers in the country increased to 107.34 crore at the end of April 2026.

Reliance Jio led the segment with 52.69 crore subscribers. It was followed by Airtel with 37.3 crore subscribers, Vi 12.8 crore, BSNL 2.7 crore and Atria Convergence with 24.2 lakh subscribers. PTI

ONGC posts 3% rise in Q4 profit to ₹6,650 crore in fiscal 2025-26

NEW DELHI: State-owned Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) on Tuesday reported a 3 per cent rise in March quarter profit to Rs 6,649.97 crore as higher oil and gas prices helped negate a drop in output.

Net profit of Rs 6,649.97 crore in January-March — the fourth quarter of 2025-26 fiscal year — compared with Rs 6,448.28 crore earnings in the corresponding period of the previous year and Rs 8,371.85 crore in the preceding three months, according to a stock exchange filing by the company.

Revenue from operations rose marginally to Rs 35,928.18 crore during the quarter from Rs 34,982.23 crore in Q4 of FY25.

For the full fiscal year, ONGC reported a net profit of Rs 32,894.02 crore, down 7.6 per cent from Rs 35,610.32 crore of 2024-25 fiscal year.

ONGC wrote off Rs 4,876.75 crore in exploration well cost during the quarter under review after the wells drilled did not yield any commercial hydrocarbon discoveries. This compared with Rs 4,173.04-crore write-off in the corresponding quarter of the previous year.

For the full year, the exploratory well cost written off was Rs 8,235.98 crore as compared to Rs 7,479.96 crore a year back.

The Board of Directors of ONGC recommended a final dividend of Re 1 per share for the 2025-26 fiscal year. MPOST

MoRTH clears ₹1,428 cr for Thiruvarur bypass

NEW DELHI: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways has approved Rs 1,427.61 crore for the construction of a 4-lane Thiruvarur bypass on the Nagapattinam–Thanjavur section of NH-83 in Tamil Nadu.

According to an official statement on Tuesday, the project spans 14.9 km and also includes the construction of two additional Road Over Bridges on NH-129A and NH-134A.

"In Tamil Nadu, we have approved Rs 1,427.61 crore for the construction of a 4-lane Thiruvarur Bypass on the Nagapattinam–Thanjavur section of NH-83, spanning 14.9 km, along with 2 additional ROBs on NH-129A & NH-134A. This strategic project will strengthen connectivity between key industrial hubs like Tiruchirappalli and Coimbatore with the port towns of Karaikal and Nagapattinam, boosting regional economic activity," Union Minister Nitin Gadkari posted on X.

The bypass, starting from Adiyakkamangalam–Thandalai, will pass through key locations including Athipuliyur, Andipalayam, Kidaramkondan, Pallivaramangalam, Perumpugalur, Elavangarkudi, and Anaivadapathy Colony, among others. PTI

NSE bars YES Securities Ltd from adding new clients for 3 months, imposes ₹2L fine

'YES Securities had previously faced similar regulatory action in Dec 2024'

NEW DELHI: National Stock Exchange of India has penalised YES Securities (India) Ltd and barred it from onboarding new clients for three months for repeatedly passing peak and upfront margin penalties to clients in violation of exchange and SEBI rules.

In an 18-page order issued after a May 21, 2026 hearing, the NSE Member Committee found that the brokerage passed on penalties linked to short or non-collection of upfront margins in 211 instances involving 48 clients, amounting to Rs 18.31 lakh, during January-March 2025.

NSE noted that YES Securities had earlier been warned in December 2024 and directed to refund Rs 9.45 lakh passed on to clients in 30 cases. However, the committee said the firm failed to comply and continued the practice. The order also cited incorrect reporting of peak margins, failure to execute early pay-in transactions and allowing trades without collecting adequate upfront margins.

YES Securities argued that peak margin and upfront margin were distinct concepts and said the restriction on passing penalties applied only to upfront margins. Rejecting the argument, NSE said peak margin is merely a mechanism to verify compliance with upfront margin requirements throughout the trading day.

The committee criticised the brokerage for "continued defiance" of binding directions and imposed two penalties of Rs 1 lakh each. It also directed the firm to refund all penalties collected from clients and submit an auditor-certified compliance report. The order also made adverse remarks against Compliance Officer Aditya Goenka and CEO Anshul Arzare. AGENCIES

Oil giant BP ousts chairman on oversight & 'conduct'

LONDON: Global oil giant BP has ousted its chairman over what it called serious concerns related to "important governance standards, oversight and conduct". The departure was abrupt and unexpected, with Albert Manifold having been appointed to the position just last year. BP's board named Ian Tyler as interim chair on Tuesday.

BP said that it will begin the process of finding a permanent chair. BP, based in London, is a "supermajor," one of the five largest oil production and exploration companies in the world by revenue and profit. The company maintains operations in about 60 countries. Last year there were media reports that British oil giant Shell was in talks to buy rival BP. Shell denied the reports at the time.

Industry analysts have suggested that BP would be an attractive takeover target after a plan to shift its focus to renewable energy, which was abandoned earlier last year, left its shares undervalued in comparison to other oil companies.

BP has also struggled to recover from the 2010 Deepwater Horizon disaster, which killed 17 workers and forced the company to pay billions of dollars for environmental damage in the Gulf of Mexico. AGENCIES

Standing tall in the mountains

Patidar plays captain's knock as RCB storm into 2nd final in a row

Rajat Patidar turned the game on its head with a sensational knock PTI

DHARAMSHALA: Defending champions Royal Challengers Bengaluru marched into a second successive IPL final with a 92-run demolition of Gujarat Titans in Qualifier 1 here on Tuesday, powered by skipper Rajat Patidar's blistering unbeaten 93 off 33 balls and a ruthless pace assault that ripped apart their opponents' top-order inside the powerplay.

Put into bat, RCB piled up a daunting 254 for five, with Patidar producing one of the most destructive knocks of the season, peppering the boundaries with effortless ease after being handed reprieves early in his innings.

The RCB captain tore into the GT attack in the death overs, ensuring his side crossed the 250-run mark in emphatic fashion. Patidar turned the game on its head, smashing nine sixes and five fours after surviving two dropped chances, as RCB plundered 86 runs in the last five overs to seize complete control of the contest. In fact, they got 114 runs off last six overs.

Chasing a mammoth target, Gujarat Titans desperately needed a flying start but their hopes were dented inside the powerplay as both in-form openers departed cheaply.

Sai Sudharsan's dismissal turned out to be a bizarre one as his bat slipped out of his hands while attempting a shot off Jacob Duffy (3/39) and crashed into the stumps, leaving the batter stunned on 14.

93

Patidar's score against GT is also the joint-highest by any captain in the IPL playoffs (or knockouts)

GT suffered a bigger setback soon after when skipper Shubman Gill was cleaned up by the red-hot Bhuvneshwar Kumar for just two, the seasoned seamer once again showcasing his mastery with the new ball.

Bhuvneswar (2/28) showed that he still is an asset for any team. He is now a Purple Cap holder with 26 scalps. The twin blows pushed Gujarat firmly on the back foot against a fired-up RCB attack.

Josh Hazlewood (1/39) then got into the act by castling Jos Buttler (29) while Rasikh Salam struck twice in the final powerplay over -- dismissing Nishant Sandhu (5) and Jason Holder (0) -- to leave the Titans gasping at 51 for five.

The battle of equals soon turned into a lop-sided affair as a desperate GT seemed to have buckled under scoreboard pressure.

Washington Sundar (8) and impact player Rahul Tewatiya (68) had an unenviable task at hand. The game had already been reduced to a formality in the face of the challenge GT faced.

Eventually, GT were bowled out for 162, sending RCB into their fifth final (2009, 2011, 2016, 2025, 2026). GT, the 2022 champions, will have another shot at making the final on Friday when they take on the winner of the Eliminator between Rajasthan Royal and Sunrisers Hyderabad.

Earlier, the RCB innings began at a furious pace with Venkatesh Iyer (19) taking on Mohammed Siraj with audacious strokeplay, including three early boundaries, before Kagiso Rabada dismissed him for 19 soon after being hit for a six. During his lively spell, Rabada also tested Virat Kohli with sharp bounce and pace in an engaging duel, but the RCB talisman weathered the challenge to score 43. AGENCIES

HEATWAVE SWEEPS COURTS

Sabalenka turns up the heat, Medvedev loses cool in defeat

PARIS: Aryna Sabalenka's diamonds sparkled in the sun when she won her first-round match at the heat-soaked-French Open on Tuesday.

Top-ranked Sabalenka looked light on her feet on Court Philippe-Chatrier, despite wearing two thick necklaces in a 6-4, 6-2 win against Jessica Bouzas Maneiro.

"Diamonds, I don't really feel the heaviness, but I can imagine how it looks from the outside," said Sabalenka, the tournament runner-up last year to Coco Gauff. "So I feel pretty comfortable. For me, it's important to look good."

The four-time major winner was initially going to wear three necklaces but said she thought that might be too much.

"It probably sounds a bit crazy, but when I feel good about what I'm wearing, how I look on court, I tend to perform much better," she said. "I like to bring a little bit of a fashion on the tennis court. I know the dress that I will wear on the Grand Slam, and I just try to come up with something to match the outfit."

Sabalenka said she wasn't worried over her jewelry away from Roland Garros.

"I have my fiancé. He's kind of like my security," she said, smiling. "My physio does jujitsu, so I feel pretty secure walking around. If I go somewhere, I don't go alone."

Daniil Medvedev lost in five sets, while Aryna Sabalenka won in two AP

Gauff began her title defense with a 6-4, 6-0 victory over fellow American Taylor Townsend, while four-time major winner Naomi Osaka beat Laura Siegemund 6-3, 7-6 (3) on Court Suzanne-Lenglen.

The fashion-conscious Osaka again caught the eye with a sequined gold playing dress. For a third consecutive day, the temperature in Paris was forecast to rise to at least 32 degrees Celsius (90 Fahrenheit).

The unusually hot conditions at Roland Garros make net-rushing — usually better reserved for hard and grass courts — a viable option because the court is drying out quicker and playing faster.

Medvedev out early again

Daniil Medvedev usually thrives in such conditions but he struggled in a five-set loss to 97th-ranked Australian opponent Adam Walton. Walton, who received a wild card invitation from tournament organizers, beat Medvedev 6-2, 1-6, 6-1, 1-6, 6-4. It was Medvedev's second straight first round exit here and third in four years. AGENCIES

TIDES OVER TROLLS, INJURY

Finally, calm amid chaos for enigmatic Parag

Riyan Parag has justified Royals' captaincy choice PTI

MULLANPUR: Often at the centre of controversy during IPL 2026, Riyan Parag has repaid the immense faith placed on him by Rajasthan Royals in his first full season as captain, leading the team to a last minute play-off berth.

The 24-year-old from Assam has had to deal with criticism at every step since joining the franchise in 2019 -- partially because of his supremely confident and straight talking personality, giving him the "arrogant" tag besides his modest IPL numbers.

"I think I've seen very few players who have been criticised like Riyan has for about seven years now. He is the absolute right guy to lead this franchise," Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara said in strong defence of Parag after sealing the top-four berth in Mumbai.

Season after season his under-performance was questioned until he had a breakout year in 2024 when he amassed 573 runs at a strike rate close to 150 after being promoted to number four.

A standout IPL led to an India call-up later that year but soon after he had to undergo surgery for a chronic shoulder injury, forcing him out of the national set up. With a battery of players ready to take over in the T20 format, Parag has not yet found a way back in.

> **I have taken a lot of brave calls actually this season. That's how I like to lead. That's how I lead Assam as well**
>
> — Riyan Parag

The Royals top management kept believing in him, so much so that he was handed captaincy post Sanju Samson's departure ahead of Dhruv Jurel, Yashasvi Jaiswal and Ravindra Jadeja.

Even in the ongoing season, Parag has to deal with extreme pressure, partially due to lack of runs in the first half of the tournament before countless trolls were fired at him after he was caught vaping in the dressing room on national TV.

The incident coincided with the team's late season slide that almost put them on the brink of elimination. AGENCIES

Gukesh, Pragg earn hard-fought wins

OSLO: D Gukesh emerged victorious after a bruising, nerve-jangling marathon battle against Vincent Keymer, and R Praggnanandhaa outplayed Alireza Firouzja but world No. 1 Magnus Carlsen suffered a rare opening-round defeat at Norway Chess, which began amid towering bookshelves at the historic Deichman Bjorvika public library here.

Thanks to his Armageddon triumph after a draining 144-move slugfest that lasted nearly five hours, Gukesh pocketed 1.5 points, while Keymer settled for one after the classical game had ended in a stalemate.

The marathon encounter saw the Indian world champion visibly rattled in the closing stages, even seeking clarification from the arbiter over the move count as the game drifted towards an inevitable draw despite Keymer being a pawn up.

The German, however, remained ice-cool throughout the classical battle, continuing to press on before eventually losing the Armageddon decider. But the tiebreak itself ended swiftly, with Gukesh unleashing the decisive 15.Bh6, a move that sealed Keymer's fate. AGENCIES

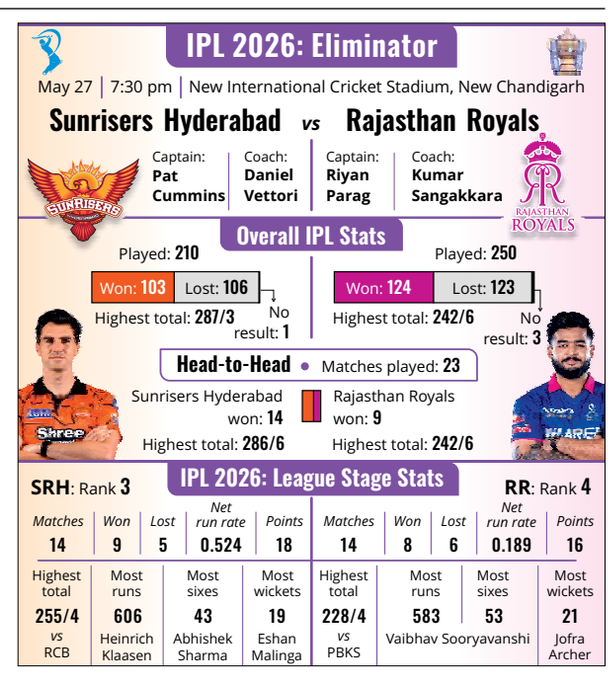
RR bank on Archer-Sooryavanshi combo to crack Sunrisers code

MULLANPUR: The ferocity and fearlessness of a 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi will be pitted against the combined might of an explosive top-order when a resurgent Rajasthan Royals run into a solid Sunrisers Hyderabad in the Indian Premier League Eliminator here on Wednesday.

Sunrisers Hyderabad made a slow start to the competition before finding sustained momentum in the second half of the tournament. The arrival of regular captain Pat Cummins for the last seven league games also made a substantial impact as they won five of those contests.

Having beaten Rajasthan Royals twice in the league stage, Cummins and Co. would carry the psychological advantage heading into the high pressure knock-out fixture. By their own admission, Royals should have qualified much earlier than the last day of the league stage but now that they are there, the Riyan Parag-led unit would be chomping at the bit to put one past SRH and progress deeper into the tournament.

The Royals top order comprising the sensational Sooryavanshi (583 runs), Yashasvi Jaiswal (397) and Dhruv Jurel (458) has expectedly scored the bulk of the runs for the team.



Same is the case with Sunrisers' trio of Abhishek Sharma (563 runs), Travis Head (393) and Ishan Kishan (569). A special mention is a must for Henrich Klaasen (606) at number four as he is in the middle of his best IPL season.

Notwithstanding the destructive abilities of both the top orders, Jaiswal and Head have not been as consistent as they would have liked. The Eliminator presents them the ideal opportunity for a game changing effort for their respective teams.

Sunrisers are arguably the most destructive side of the tournament and therefore it was hardly a surprise that Royals head coach Kumar Sangakkara was inquired about his plans to deal with the opposition's belligerent top-4. AGENCIES

Sindhu swats aside Wardani, Satwik-Chirag advance too

SINGAPORE: Star Indian shuttler PV Sindhu advanced to the second round of the women's singles competition with an impressive straight-game win over fifth seed Putri Kusuma Wardani at the Singapore Open here on Tuesday.

The 30-year-old produced a composed performance to outwit the World No. 6 Indonesian 21-17 21-18 in the opening round of the $10,00,000 Super 750 tournament.

The former world champion will next face Japan's Riko Gunji.

Asian Games gold medallists Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty also progressed after battling past world No. 25 Malaysia's Chen Zhi Yi and Presley Smith 26-28 21-15 21-13 in the men's doubles opening round.

The world No. 4 Indian pair will take on either Chinese Taipei's Lee Jhe-Huei and Yang Po-Hsuan or China's Liu Yang and Huang Di in the next round.

However, rising Indian shuttler Ayush Shetty, a finalist at Asia Championships, bowed out after going down 21-11 14-21 12-21 to world championships bronze medallist Viktor Axelsen in a 65-minute men's singles clash.

Young Unnati Hooda, who has won three Super 100 titles in last four years, too suffered an early exit, losing 14-21 10-21 to former world junior champion and eighth seed Tomoka Miyazaki in women's singles.

In women's doubles, India's Kavipriya Selvam and Simran Singhi went down 21-18 13-21 5-21 to Spain's Paula Lopez and Lucia Rodriguez to bow out in 48 minutes, while Ashwini Bhat K and Shikha Gautam lost 16-21 11-21 to Chinese Taipei's Chang Ching Hui and Yang Ching Tun. Japan's seventh-seeded pair of Takuro Hoki and Yugo Kobayashi got the better of India's Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun 21-15 21-13 in another men's doubles clash. AGENCIES

India to push for Yogasana's Oly inclusion

NEW DELHI: Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya on Tuesday said Yogasana would be pushed for inclusion in the future Olympic Games roster keeping in mind India's bid to host the 2036 Games as the sport geared up to make a statement with its maiden World Championship in Ahmedabad from June 4 to 8.

The World Championship will feature 529 athletes from over 60 countries with 114 of them being Indian yogasana practitioners. The Indian squad was picked after trials and is currently undergoing a training camp in Ahmedabad's Veer Savarkar Sports Complex.

"Yogasana will be among the traditional sports in the 2030 Commonwealth Games in Ahmedabad...We are bidding to host the Olympic Games in 2036 and when that happens, our sport should be there on the roster. Efforts are being made by both the government of India and the national federation (Yogasana Bharat) to ensure that Yoga becomes an Olympic sport by that time," Mandaviya said. "Procedure is to have 75 countries as your signatories to become an international federation, after which a plea to the International Olympic Committee can be made for a sport's inclusion." AGENCIES

Dawn of new order? Life after Pep begins for Manchester City

LONDON: So long, Pep.

After a transformative decade of trophy after trophy, spellbinding play and tactical shifts, the Guardiola era — as it will no doubt be called in future years — in English soccer is over.

The final sendoff came Monday night when sporting and music aristocracy — basketball great Michael Jordan and Oasis mastermind Noel Gallagher among them — gathered in person and on video to pay tribute to the outgoing Manchester City manager in a parade through the city center followed by an after-party.

There were tears. There were laughs. There were so many memories.

There was, though, an elephant in the room, one that may slink away into the background for the next couple of months while the World Cup takes center stage but will emerge ahead of the start of next season: What next for City, Guardiola and, indeed, the English game as a whole?

These could be tough times for the dominant team of the last decade. First of all, some housekeeping. The team needs a new manager and the frontrunner is reportedly Enzo Maresca, the former Chelsea coach who was assistant to Guardiola at City in its treble-winning season of 2022-23.

The sooner a replacement is hired, the quicker they can start shaping a playing squad in their image. It will already be without John Stones and Bernardo Silva, stalwarts who are confirmed to be leaving.

The modern-day Man City, though, was essentially constructed to accommodate Guardiola, right from the moment Ferran Soriano and Txiki Begiristain — two officials close to Guardiola in their Barcelona days — joined from the Catalan giants in 2012 to steer the direction of an ambitious English club that had been taken over by Abu Dhabi four years earlier.

What's the strategy now in this post-Guardiola world if the centerpiece is gone? Much might depend on the verdict of the legal case that City has ongoing with the Premier League, after the club was charged by the league in February 2023 with more than 100 financial breaches, including providing misleading information about its sources of income. The case was heard by an independent commission between September and December in 2024 but no verdict has been reached.

City has always denied the charges. Punishment could be as extreme as expulsion from the top flight, in which case City's world turns upside down overnight This is the moment rival teams have been waiting for. Finally Guardiola — a coach who is pretty much a guarantee of trophies — is gone and the playing field suddenly seems more level.

With City in flux, this might be Arsenal's time to build some sort of dynasty under Mikel Arteta, who has constructed a deep and strong squad and has removed the burden of expectation on the team by leading it to the Premier League title.

"My job, and everybody at the club, is going to be to lift those standards now and achieve much more," Arteta said, "because I think we are capable of doing it."

It remains to be seen how Xabi Alonso reshapes Chelsea and how the third season in Arne Slot's turbulent Liverpool career goes, after being champion one season and barely scraping into the Champions League the next. AGENCIES

Knicks finish sweep of Cavs, make first NBA Finals since 1999

Knick of time

CLEVELAND: As the clock wound down, few Cleveland Cavaliers fans could be found. The New York Knicks left them with no reason to stick around.

Karl-Anthony Towns scored 19 points and grabbed 14 rebounds as the Knicks advanced to the NBA Finals for the first time since 1999, routing the Cavaliers 130-93 in Game 4 of the Eastern Conference finals Monday night.

The Knicks extended their franchise playoff-record winning streak to 11 games -- matching the third-longest run in a single postseason in league history -- and their long-suffering supporters took over Cleveland's arena.

"Growing up in the (New York) area, I feel like the word hope has been gone for a long while, so to restore that is special," Towns said. "There is nowhere better in the world than when (Madison Square) Garden has hope."

Ney York Knicks' Karl Anthony-Towns had 19 points and 14 rebounds AP

OG Anunoby contributed 17 points and Landry Shamet scored 16 off the bench on 4-for-4 3-point shooting for New York, which built a 29-point lead in the second quarter and went up 123-78 in the fourth.

Jalen Brunson and Mikal Bridges finished with 15 points apiece, and Josh Hart added six points, 11 rebounds and six assists. The former Villanova championship teammates relished the opportunity to win the East together. "It's something that is surreal," Hart said. "We already share a bond and a brotherhood for life, and we're going to keep adding memories for that."

This will be their third appearance in the finals since winning their last title in 1973

Brunson was named the series MVP for averaging 25.5 points and 7.8 assists. The Knicks have outscored their opponents by 262 points during their win streak, the most dominant span in league history, playoffs or regular season.

Donovan Mitchell logged 31 points and Evan Mobley posted 15 points and seven rebounds for Cleveland, which reached the East finals for the first time since 2018. James Harden had 12 points and five turnovers while missing all six of his 3-point tries.

"Sometimes you've got to ultimately give the other team credit," Cavaliers coach Kenny Atkinson said. "They played great basketball and they're on a heater."

The Knicks' Mike Brown is off to the NBA Finals for the second time as a head coach, having led the Cavaliers to their first East crown in 2007. AGENCIES

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC/ 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Jitender @ Suja S/o Munsi Ram R/o H.No. 10665, Gali No.8, Partap Nagar Gulabi Bagh, Delhi-8826728321** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 14755/2025 U/s 317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita at P.S. DBG Road, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitender @ Suja** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender @ Suja** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jitender @ Suja of FIR No. 14755/2025 U/s 317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita of P.S.: DBG Road, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 27.06.2026.**

By order
Ms. Harshita Mishra
Chief Judicial Magistrate
Central Room No.38, Ground Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/6891/CD/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Open E-Tender Notice

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of Work	Improvement of water bodies and Manda Wali Ranney Well Complex feeding Anand Vihar Railway Terminal, along with improvement of entry and exit points of Anand Vihar Railway Terminal and Improvement of platform drainage towards Ghaziabad end at Anand Vihar Terminal by providing 600 mm Dia NP2 pipe up to trunk sewer for proper disposal of storm water with suitable gradient, including repair of platform drains, platform down-take chambers and other allied works for betterment of drainage free flow, in the section of SSE/Works/ANVT under ADEN/NDLS.
Approx. Cost of work	₹ 3,49,55,233.03/- (Rupees Three Crore Forty Nine Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Two Hundred Thirty Three and Three Paise only)
Earnest Money to be Deposit	₹ 6,99,100.00/- (Rupees Six Lakh Ninty Nine Thousand One Hundred Only)
Cost of tender document	₹ 0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	17.06.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	**www.ireps.gov.in**
Allocation	04-410-32

- The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system.
- For all terms and conditions please refer tender document.
- No manual offers are acceptable.
- Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/25/2026-27/W-3 Dated : 26.05.2026 1776/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Onkar Singh** S/o Wazir Singh R/o W-1, Gali No. 02, Krishna Park, Tilak Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 600/2020 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Tilak Nagar, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Onkar Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Onkar Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Onkar Singh** accused of FIR No. 600/2020 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Tilak Nagar, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **09.07.2026.**

By Order: Sh. Vikas Madaan,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, (West),
Room No. 289, 2nd Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/6800/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Deepak S/o** Roop Chand, **R/o** Village-Basant Pur, Saintli, PS-Muradnagar, Ghaziabad (U.P.), has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 8094/2017, U/S 379/411/482/34 IPC, PS Nand Nagri, North-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Deepak** the said accused of **FIR No. 8094/2017, U/S 379/411/482/34 IPC, PS Nand Nagri, North-East Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.07.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
Room No.-19, 1st Floor, Shahdara Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/6885/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender No. T-PUB-GRC-2026-429, Dt. 25.05.2026. e-Tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Engineer, S.E.Railway, Garden Reach, Kolkata-700043 for and on behalf of the President of India for the following works before 15.00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. **Description of Works :** Development and upgradation of old Heritage Bungalow No. 13, repair and renovation of the Patient Relative Rest House and upgradation of the Squash Court at North Colony and Garden Reach, South Eastern Railway, under Assistant Divisional Engineer/Settlement/Garden Reach. **Tender Value :** ₹ 2,64,43,681.48. **Earnest Money :** ₹ 5,28,900/-. **Cost of Tender Documents :** 0. **Completion period of the work :** 12 (Twelve) months. **Date of opening :** 16.06.2026. Any change in tender schedule, corrigendum, amendment, if any, shall be available on the E-tender portal only and same will not be published in the newspaper. Interested Tenderers may visit website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these works will be accepted. **N.B. :** Prospective Bidders may regularly visit **www.ireps.gov.in** to participate in all tenders. Help Desk contact no.033-2450-3783. **(PR-228)**

PUBLIC NOTICE

This Notice is given to the general public that Mrs. Santra W/o Jagdish owns Property Plot No. B-11 & B-12, 198 Sq. Yds, Khewat No. 1010/845, Khatoni No. 1546, Mu. No. 82, Killa No. 11/3, 20/1/3, Khewat No. 1015/848Min, Khatoni No. 1551, Mu. No. 82, Killa No. 11/4, Situated at Tigaon, Faridabad, vide Sale Deed Doc. No. 335, dated 30.4.2019. Who lost Sale Deed Doc. No.18690, dated 05.2.2010 in name of Arun Yadav S/o Shailesh Yadav. Now Mrs. Santra W/o Jagdish intends to mortgage the said property to AU SMALL FINANCE BANK LTD. We give this public notice for inviting any claim/objection regarding ownership said property is/are hereby requested to notify the same in writing to undersigned at the address mention below within 7 days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which any claim, if any, of such persons will be consider to have been waived and/or, abandoned. **Chander Kaushik (Advocate),**
Mob: 9999565681, Chamber No. 552, Sector-12, Court, Faridabad

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

TENDER NOTICE
NIT NO. TKD-11-2026
Date: 22.05-2026

Sr. Divisional Electric Engineer/TRS/Electric Loco Shed, Tughlakabad, New Delhi-44, acting for and on behalf of the president of India, invites E-Tenders against the following Tenders, with the closing date 15.06.2026 at 15:30 hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids up to closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **TENDER/BID NO.:** TKD-11-2026, **NAME OF WORK AND STATION:** "Repair/Reconditioning of Auxiliary Motors of 03 Phase Locomotives at ELS/TKD for a period of 02 years.", **QTY.:** As per Schedule of Rates, **ESTIMATED COST (IN RS.):** 1,03,92,910.65, **COST OF TENDER FORM (IN RS.):** NIL, **EARNEST MONEY (IN RS.):** 2,07,900.00, **COMPLETION PERIOD:** 24 Months, **LAST DATE & TIME OF SUBMISSION OF TENDER:** 15.06.2026 at 15:30 Hrs. **Note:**- 1. E-Tender document and details of E-tender will be available on website www.ireps.gov.in Portal. 2. Manual offer will not be acceptable for this E-Tender; in case manual offer received then offer will not be considered. 3. For any correction in this tender, corrigendum will be uploaded on website, which may be seen up-to the date of tender opening. 4. Tenderer must have class-III, digital signature certificate and will have to register on IREPS portal.

Sd./-
For Sr. Divisional Electrical Eingeer (TRS),
Electric Loco Shed, Tughlakabad, WCR, New Delhi

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

SURYODAY — Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector – 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai – 400614. CIN: L65923MH2008PLC261472.

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd., under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (ACT NO.54 OF 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice to below mentioned Borrower/s / Guarantor/s. After completion of 60 days from date of receipt of the said notice, The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower/s / Guarantor/s and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on them under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 6 & 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on the date mentioned herewith:

Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor	Date of Demand Notice	08.08.2025
257000000877 & 257000003610, 1.MR. ANKIT AGGARWAL C/O RAMESH CHAND, 2.MRS. SONIYA AGGARWAL C/O ANKIT AGGARWAL	Total Outstanding Amount in Rs.	Rs. 23,70,073.35/- as on 05-08-2025
	Date of Possession	22.05.2026(Physical)

Description Of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (Ies) : All That Piece And Parcel Of Built Up Entire Upper Ground Floor Without Its Roof Rights, Built On Land Area Measuring 40 Sq. Yds. Approx, Of Property Bearing No.881/57, (Property No. 881, Gali No. 57), Portion Of Old Plot No. 75 Out Of Khasra No. 225/1, 226/2, Situated In The Area Of Village Chowkri Mubarakabad Now Abadi Known As Lekhu Nagar, Tri Nagar, Delhi-110035 Within The Following Boundaries: Boundaries Are As Follow: East: Road 25 Ft., West: Gali 15 Ft., North: Other's Plot/Property, South: Other's Plot/Property

The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the M/s Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd, for an above mentioned demanded amount and further interest thereon.

Date : 27.05.2026, Place : Delhi **Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No.- 09-Elect/G/PRYJ/26-27 **Date- 23.05.2026**

E-Tender Notice

Senior Divl. Electrical Engineer/Gen/N.C. Railway, Prayagraj for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following e-Tenders on prescribed form for the following work up to **15.00** hrs. on **16.06.2026.** The details of the tenders are as under:-

SN.1. TN: ELG-23-2627 **Name of work:** Electrical work in connection with the work of "Replacement of Old FOB by new FOB at Manauri (MRE) (3.05 M wide) and Bharwari (BRE) (6.1 M wide) of PRYJ Division. Replacement of old FOB by 6.10 M wide new FOB with ramp at Sirathu (SRO). "Replacement of old FOB by new FOB at ULD under Ambiapur- Tundla section.

Cost of work Cost : ₹ 9433669.35 | **Bid Security:** ₹ 188700.00
Duration of completion: 06 Months

SN.2. TN: ELG-24-2627 **Name of work:** Provision and improvement of catwalk, pit lights and other related works in existing washing line in Prayagraj division.

Cost of work Cost : ₹ 9525608.79 | **Bid Security:** ₹ 190500.00
Duration of completion: 06 Months

Tender Opening Date: 16.06.2026, 15.00 Hrs.

Note: 1. The complete information along with tender document of above e-TEnder is available on Website **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15.00** hrs. on the due date of tender opening.

1181/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 445 **Date: 26.05.2026**

TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer (M&G) Dhalipur Power House, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No.-01/EE/M&G/DLR/2026-27: Annual cleaning of Intake Trash Rack, Parks, pitching walls, uneven field and 132 KV Switchyard etc.

Estimated Cost: Rs. 23,23,049/- (GST Extra) respectively.

Date of availability of bid document on website: 28.05.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

Last date for submission of tender: 18.06.2026 up to 16:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

(Executive Engineer)

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Virender @Sehbag @Rattan** S/o Rajpal R/o Village Nithara PS Loni, Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh also at Flat No. 478, 1st Floor, GDA Flats near Tila more Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 479/2014 U/s 457/380 IPC, PS Farsh Bazaar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Virender @Sehbag @Rattan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Virender @Sehbag @Rattan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Virender @Sehbag @Rattan** in **FIR No. 479/2014 U/s 457/380 IPC, PS Farsh Bazaar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.07.2026**.

By order
Shri Akhil Malik
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Court No. 38
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/6684/SHD/2026

म.प्र. राज्य बीज प्रमाणीकरण संस्था

प्रधान कार्यालय, ऑफिस काम्पलैक्स, गौतम नगर, भोपाल-23
दूरभाष-(कार्या.) : 0755-2600860, ई-मेल-mpsscaho@gmail.com
वेबसाइट : www.mpssca.org

अल्पकालिक निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना (IVth Call)

बीज प्रमाणीकरण संस्था के जर्मिनेशन पेपर क्रय किये जाना है इस हेतु ऑनलाइन ई-टेण्डर दिनांक 26.05.2026 को सायं 5.00 बजे से आमंत्रित की जाती है। इस हेतु निविदायें, ई-निविदा वेबसाइट **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर निर्धारित तिथि एवं समय पर आमंत्रित है। इस वेबसाइट पर निर्धारित दस्तावेज, जिसमें निर्देश, शर्तें एवं निविदा कार्यक्रम आदि का विस्तृत उल्लेख है, उपलब्ध है।

म.प्र. माध्यम/126018/2026 **प्रबंध संचालक**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No: 2920262027 **Dated: 25.05.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering) / North Central Railway / Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-TENDERS on prescribed form for the following work up to **13:30 hrs. on 17.06.2026**. The details of the Tender are as under :-

SN : 1 | **Tender No. :** 87 | **Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) : 17999999.75**
Name of Work : Annual Civil Maintenance zone work for North East Zone in the section of SSE/W/I/TDL for the P.E. 30.06.2027 under Sr. ADEN/Estate/TDL.
Earnest Money : 360000.00 | **Completion Period :** 30.06.2027
Date of Opening of tender : 17.06.2026
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : Any Civil Engineering Work

SN : 2 | **Tender No. :** 88 | **Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) : 18999999.07**
Name of Work : Annual Civil Maintenance zone work for North West Zone in the section of SSE/W/I/TDL for the P.E. 30.06.2027 under Sr. ADEN/Estate/TDL.
Earnest Money : 380000.00 | **Completion Period :** 30.06.2027
Date of Opening of tender : 17.06.2026
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : Any Civil Engineering Work

SN : 3 | **Tender No. :** 89 | **Approx. Cost of work (Rs.) : 6500000.00**
Name of Work : Horticulture work at Tundla & TDL to DAQ for the P.E. 30.06.2027 under Sr. ADEN/Estate/TDL and Sr. ADEN/TDL.
Earnest Money : 130000.00 | **Completion Period :** 30.06.2027
Date of Opening of tender : 17.06.2026
Eligibility Criteria for similar work : Any Horticulture Work

Note:- 1. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. **2.** The complete infomation along with tender document of above E-TENDER is available on website **www.ireps.gov.in** upto 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e 17.06.2026. **3.** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. **4.** The tenderers shall submit a copy of certificate as given in tender document in standard format, without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. **5.** In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. **6.** The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of cause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC July'2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete offer and accordingly shall not be considered. **1191/26 (AS)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sarfaraz Ansari** S/o Samsul Ansari R/o H. No. 124, E-Block, Shastri Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 949/2020 u/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sarfaraz Ansari** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sarfaraz Ansari** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sarfaraz Ansari** accused of FIR No. 949/2020 u/s 356/379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Kashmere Gate, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **17.07.2026.**

By Order: Sh. Vaibhav Garg,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (Central)
Room No. 138, 1st Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/6402/N/2026

WITHDRAWAL OF PUBLICATION OF APPENDIX IV-A DATED 11.05.2026 ISSUED UNDER RULE 8(6) OF THE SECURITISATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 ('The Act'), WITH RESPECT TO LOAN ACCOUNT NO. HLAPLAJ00269913.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s), that Appendix IV-A Dated **11.05.2026** published by the undersigned in the **MILLINIUM POST - DELHI COVERS FARIDABAD - ENGLISH DT. 20.05.2026** & **JANSATTA - DELHI COVERS FARIDABAD - HINDI DT. 20.05.2026**, in respect of the sale of the Mortgaged Property bearing **LIG FLAT NO. 1822, GROUND FLOOR, HOUSING BOARD COLONY, SECTOR-29, FARIDABAD, HARYANA – 122901,** stands withdrawn with immediate effect, without prejudice to the rights of the undersigned.

sd/-
AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED)

Place : FARIDABAD

UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD R and B DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR JAMMU

Short e-NIT No.15of 2026-2027 Dated:-23-05-2026

For and on behalf of the **Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir** e-tenders are invited on **percentage basis** from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S.No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for complete-on	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	Beautification and overall upgradation of the corridor and white washing and repair of college boundary wall and college lawn at SPMR College of Commerce	PWD (R&B) DIVISION BAKSHI NAGAR Jammu	51.74	1500	2% of Advertised Cost	60 Days	02-06-2026 (12.00 Pm)	"A"

Position of AAA / TS : Accorded

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen / downloaded from the departmental website http://jktenders.gov.in as per below schedule :-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	**23-05-2026**
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	**From 23-05-2026 to 01-06-2026 upto 1800 Hrs**
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	**-**
4	Bid submission **Start Date**	**23-05-2026**
5	Bid Submission **End Date**	**01-06-2026 upto 1800 Hrs**
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	**02-06-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu**
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids (Online)	**To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed**

1. Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of **e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to MH 0059 (Revenue) favoring Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu and upload the same i.e treasury challan / receipt,** Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to **Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu** The CDR/FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1 be submitted to the **Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu** at the time of allotment.
2. The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder needs not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential- submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.
3. The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site **www.jktenders.gov.in** and conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The **Financial-bids of responsive bidders** shall be opened online in the **Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Bakshi Nagar Jammu** The date for same shall be intimated separately..
4. The bids for the work shall remain **valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.**
5. **The earnest money shall be forfeited, If :-**

a) Any bidder/tenderer withdraws his bid/tender during the period of bid validity or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid.
b) Failure of Successful bidder to furnish the required performance security within specified time period after issue of letter of acceptance.
c) Failure of successful bidder to execute the agreement on same day of allotment of work contract as per Chief Engineer PW (R&B) Department Jammu's Circular No. CEJ/G/12660-87 dated 07-10-2021.

6. **Instruction to bidders regarding e-tendering process.**

6.1 Bidders are advised to download bid submission manual from the **"Downloads"** option as well as from **"Bidders Manual Kit"** on website **www.jktenders.gov.**
in to acquaint bid submission process.
6.2. To participate in bidding process, bidders have to get 'Digital Signature Certificate (DSC)' as per Information Technology Act-2000. Bidders can get digital certificate from any approved vendors.
6.3. The bidders have to submit their bids online in electronic format with digital Signature. No financial bid will be accepted in physical form.
6.4. Bids will be opened online as per time schedule mentioned above.
6.5. Bidders must ensure to upload scanned copy of all necessary documents mentioned in NIT and SBD with technical bid online.

Sd/- (ER. SANDEEP GUPTA)
Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division
Bakshi Nagar

DIP No:DIP/J-2700/26

TATA INSTITUTE OF SOCIAL SCIENCES

(A Deemed to be University Under Section 3 of the UGC Act, 1956)
A Grant-in-Aid Institute under Ministry of Education, GoI
V.N. Purav Marg, Deonar, Mumbai 400 088

ADMISSION NOTIFICATION FOR ACADEMIC YEAR 2026-2027

TISS announces admissions for the Full Time (Regular), Post-Graduate Degree Programmes for the Academic Year 2026-2027 based on the CUET PG Score-2026.

For information about Eligibility, Admission Procedure, Online Application Form and other updates/amendments, please visit **https://admissions.tiss.ac.in/admissions/ma/programmes/**

Any admission related queries at any stage should be sent to **admissionsinfo@tiss.ac.in** or call the Admissions helpline at 022- 25525252.

Last Date for Application: 31 May 2026

CBC 21323/11/0001/2627 **Registrar**

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") [formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.] [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029]** and **Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. ("ACRE") [CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769]** acting as a **Trustee of ACRE-102-Trust** (both SCL and ACRE) are jointly and severally referred to as **("Secured Creditor")**, the **physical possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on **"as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is"** basis on **29.06.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of the following amounts due to ACRE and SCL :

DUES OF ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.

S. No.	Loan Account Number	Outstanding Amounts (in Rs.) as on 24.04.2026
1.	HHLDCP00298639	Rs. 32,84,574/- (Rupees Thirty Two Lakh Eighty Four Thousand Five Hundred Seventy Four only)

DUES OF SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) :

S. No.	Loan Account Number	Outstanding Amounts (in Rs.) as on 24.04.2026
1.	HHEDCP00298653	Rs. 6,25,729/- (Rupees Six Lakh Twenty Five Thousand Seven Hundred Twenty Nine only)

The Loan Account No. **HHLDCP00298639** with SCL, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s) including the Immovable Property, had been assigned to **Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Company Limited ("IARCL")** vide registered Assignment Agreement dated **31.12.2021**, which has been further assigned by IARCL to and in favour of **Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. ("ACRE")** acting as a **Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust** vide registered Assignment Agreement dated **29.06.2022.** Consequently, ACRE has also become a Secured Creditor for the said assigned Loan Account SCL has given its consent to ACRE to issue this Notice of Sale.

The amounts mentioned in both the tables given above are pending towards the respective Loan Accounts of ACRE and SCL, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **24.04.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement(s) and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **25.04.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges, due and payable to the Secured Creditor from **RATNESH KUMAR JHA and RAGINI JHA.**

The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be **Rs. 41,60,000/- (Rupees Forty One Lakh Sixty Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit **("EMD")** will be **Rs. 4,16,000/- (Rupees Four Lakh Sixteen Thousand only)** i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

RESIDENTIAL FLAT BEARING NUMBER F / UH - 901, HAVING A SUPER AREA OF 840 SQUARE FEET, SITUATED ON THE 9TH FLOOR, IN TOWER / BLOCK 'F', IN THE RESIDENTIAL GROUP HOUSING PROJECT KNOWN AS "URBAN HOMES" (PHASE - 1), CONSTRUCTED ON LAND BEARING KHASRA NUMBERS 2377, 2378, 2380, 2381, 2382/1, 2406, 2407, 2410, 2410M, 2411 AND 2422, LOCATED IN SHAHPUR BAMEHTA, NH - 24, GHAZIABAD - 201002, UTTAR PRADESH.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i. e. www.acreindia.in and www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E - mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Sd/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
TRUSTEE OF ACRE - 102 - TRUST

Date : 20.05.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Mangal Singh, S/o:** Kanhaiya Lal, **R/o:** 3/90A, Beena Enclave Nangloi, **Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 506/21, U/s: 279/338/471 IPC, PS: Prem Nagar, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Mangal Singh,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Mangal Singh,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Mangal Singh** of **FIR No. 506/21, U/s: 279/338/471 IPC, PS: Prem Nagar, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.10.2026**.

By Order
Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North West Court No. 109, First Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/6342/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Special Limited Tender Notice

The Chief Rolling Stock Engineer/Coaching, Northern Railway, Baroda House for and on behalf of President of India invites sealed tender on **"Single Packet System"** for following work from empanelled tenders.

1	**Name of work**	Better On-Board Services (OBHS and linen Distribution) in identified trains of NR through Empaneled firms for the period of Two Years (730 days)
2	**Work Place**	Northern Railway (DLI Division & JAT Division)
3	**Period of work**	Two Years (730 days)
4	**Approximate cost of work**	**Rs. 41,72,53,504.50/-** (with GST)
5	**Earnest money (on Line)**	Rs. 22,36,270/- (in favour of FA&CAO, Northern Railway, New Delhi.)
6	**Cost of the tender form**	Nil
7	**Availability of tender documents**	Website **www.ireps.gov.in**
8	**Date and time of availability of tender documents**	From 26.05.2026 to 09.06.2026, 15.00 Hrs.
9	**Date and time of tender closing**	09.06.2026 , 15.00 Hrs.
10	**Date and time of tender opening**	09.06.2026, 15.30 Hrs. onwards If the date of opening happens to be a holiday or otherwise the tender shall be opened on the next working day.
11	**Place for opening of tender**	Northern Railway Headquarter Office, Baroda House, New Delhi.

No: NR-HQ0MECH(CHG)/10/2026-O/o SSE/Chg/1/HQ/NR Date: 25.05.2026 **1770/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi, S/o:** Rishipal, **R/o:** H.No. 3, JJ Camp, Rani Garden, Shastri Nagar, Geeta Colony, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 388/2017 U/s 186/353/332 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Ravi** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 388/2017 U/s 186/353/332 IPC, P.S.: Geeta Colony, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.06.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Prerna Rai
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02 (East)
Room No. 15, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/6849/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

RANVEER SINGH 'BANNED' BY FILM BODY OVER 'DON 3' EXIT

The 'Dhurandhar' actor visits temple amid 'Kantara' row

OUR CORRESPONDENT

If you thought the 'ban' culture existed till now only in the Bengali film industry, then let's take a look at Bollywood. 'Dhurandhar' actor Ranveer Singh has been 'banned' by the Federation of Western India Cine Employees (FWICE) after they imposed a non-cooperation directive against him amid the ongoing 'Don 3' controversy. The decision comes after the film body announced at a press conference on Monday that their members will not collaborate with the 'Padmavat' actor till the dispute is over. The problem started when Singh abruptly exited Farhan Akhtar's much-awaited film just a few days before the film was supposed to go on the floors. The move reportedly caused losses of around Rs 45 crore to the filmmaker.

"The Federation considers all artists, technicians, workers, producers, directors and members from every craft as part of one family bound together by mutual trust, professional commitments, respect and collective responsibility. FWICE further believes that sudden exits from projects by senior and established actors at crucial stages pose a serious threat to the stability and working ecology of the entertainment industry," the statement from the film body read. FWICE Chief Advisor Ashoke Pandit also said that the trend to withdraw from a project 10 days before the shoot starts is serious.

Meanwhile, the actor offered prayers at Mysuru's Chamundeshwari Temple on Tuesday morning. His visit to the temple comes on a directive by the Karnataka High Court after Singh offered an unconditional apology in the 'Kantara' mimicry case following the submission of his revised affidavit in April. The court observed that the matter was likely to be disposed of and ordered him to offer prayers at the Chamundeshwari Temple within four weeks.

> The problem started when Ranveer Singh abruptly exited Farhan Akhtar's 'Don 3' just a few days before the film was supposed to go on the floors. The move reportedly caused losses of around Rs 45 crore to the filmmaker

Singh has also responded to the 'ban' through an official statement where he mentioned that 'he holds the highest regard for the film fraternity and for everyone associated with the 'Don' franchise. While several narratives and speculations have surfaced over time, Ranveer has never considered it necessary to respond publicly or contribute to conjecture. His focus remains firmly on his work and the commitments ahead. He continues to hold deep respect and goodwill for all those involved and sincerely wishes the franchise continued success. Choosing restraint and grace in moments like these has always been a conscious decision on his part and he will continue to maintain the same stance', his statement read.

Naseeruddin Shah brings JRD Tata to life

The series 'Made in India: A Titan Story' with Jim Sarbh is set to premiere in June

OUR CORRESPONDENT

For veteran actor Naseeruddin Shah, portraying the character of the iconic industrialist JRD Tata was more than rewarding. "What fascinated me about JRD Tata was not just his vision, but the quiet confidence with which he inspired people to dream bigger than they thought possible. He had an extraordinary ability to spot potential and nurture it with trust, something that feels increasingly rare," he said.

In Amazon MX Player's new show, 'Made in India: A Titan Story', Shah, along with Jim Sarbh as Xerxes Desai, will take the audience on a lesser-known journey. Adapted from Vinay Kamath's acclaimed book 'Titan: India's Most Successful Consumer Brand', the series has been written by Karan Vyas and directed by Robbie Grewal. This six-part series explores ambition, mentorship and the relentless pursuit of excellence that turned an unlikely idea into a national legacy.

> 'What fascinated me about JRD Tata was not just his vision, but the quiet confidence,' says the veteran actor

Set in pre-liberalised India, at a time when the country stood on the brink of economic and social change, the show traces the remarkable rise of 'Titan' through the eyes of visionary businessman Xerxes Desai. The trailer offers a powerful glimpse into a journey driven by ambition and unwavering belief, where a bold idea to build an Indian watch brand slowly transforms into something far greater. As resistance mounts and uncertainty looms large, Xerxes Desai and JRD Tata remain steadfast in their belief that India could create something of its own.

BTS wins 'Artist of the Year' award at AMAs

K-pop band BTS won the 'Artist of the Year' award at the 2026 American Music Awards.

The group comprising RM, Jin, Suga, J-Hope, Jimin, V and Jung Kook took away three awards in total. The event took place in Las Vegas, according to the entertainment news outlet 'Variety'. It also marked the second time for the band to receive the 'Artist of the Year' award. They first received it in 2021. Besides, the band also won 'Song of the Summer' for 'Swim' and 'Best Male K-Pop Artist' award.

Except for BTS, Sabrina Carpenter left with the three major awards: 'Album of the Year' and 'Best Pop Album' for 'Man's Best Friend' and 'Best Female Pop Artist'.

Formed in 2010 by Bang Si-hyuk, BTS debuted in 2013 under 'Big Hit Entertainment'. The band is known for tracks such as 'Mikrokosmos', 'Butter', 'Mic Drop' and others. They are currently touring with the 'Arirang' World Tour, which features over 70 stops across Asia, North America, South America, Europe and Australia.

> The K-Pop band took away three awards in total

The tour will conclude on March 14, 2027, in the Philippines. It is also BTS's first tour following their military service, which led to the hiatus between 2022 and 2025.

PTI

REMEMBERING RAMKINKAR BAIJ: INDIA'S RADICAL MODERNIST

He remains one of the most radical figures in Indian modern art, an artist who transformed cement, laterite and everyday life into a new visual language

Portrait study of Ramkinkar Baij sketched by Niranjan Pradhan

CHANDRIMA DAS

On his birth anniversary on May 25, Ramkinkar Baij remains one of the most radical figures in Indian modern art, an artist who transformed cement, laterite and everyday life into a new visual language. Long before abstraction and public sculpture gained prominence in India, he was reshaping sculpture, painting and environmental art through forms rooted in rural Bengal, labouring communities and lived experience. Working far from the centres of cultural elitism, Baij created works that continue to feel remarkably contemporary.

More than four decades after his death in 1980, Baij remains central to Indian art history. Rejecting academic conventions, he experimented boldly across styles and materials, drawing from terracotta traditions, folk theatre, Impressionism, Cubism and abstraction while working with watercolour, oil paint, cement, bamboo, rope, pebbles and laterite. The result was a deeply original artistic language shaped by the people and landscapes around him.

Born in Bankura and shaped by its terracotta traditions and rural rhythms, Ramkinkar Baij developed a visual language unlike any other in Indian art. His influences ranged from the murals and sculptures of Ajanta Caves and Ellora Caves to Bankura's artisan-crafted idols, folk theatre and the theatrical backdrops he painted in his youth, influences later enriched by encounters with European modernism. This synthesis deepened at Visva Bharati in Santiniketan, where journalist Ramananda Chatterjee encouraged him to study after noticing his posters during the Non-Cooperation Movement. Under Nandalal Bose and with the encouragement of Rabindranath Tagore, Baij found the freedom to pursue an independent artistic path. Santiniketan's blend of global artistic exposure and rootedness in indigenous culture helped shape the experimental approach that would later redefine Indian modernism.

At the heart of Ramkinkar Baij's art were tribal peasants and labouring communities, figures long absent from mainstream academic art. Inspired by the Santhal communities around Santiniketan, he brought ordinary workers to the forefront with rare dignity and monumental scale. Sculptures such as Santhal Family, Harvester and Mill Call captured movement, labour, resilience and survival, transforming Indian modernism by centring lives historically excluded from artistic representation. Fascinated since childhood by the vitality of Santhal labourers migrating seasonally for work, Baij infused his sculptures with a powerful sense of rhythm and motion.

Nature and environment were central to Ramkinkar Baij's artistic vision. The open landscape of Santiniketan shaped his engagement with space, light, movement and organic form. Rather than isolating sculpture on pedestals, he embedded works within their surroundings. Sujata, among his early environmental sculptures, blends into its landscape and eucalyptus grove. His open-air works invited viewers to move around them, experiencing shifting light, shadow, texture and perspective, treating sculpture as part of a living environment rather than a standalone object.

> More than four decades after his death in 1980, Baij remains central to Indian art history

His teaching at Santiniketan followed an unconventional, intuitive method. Ramkinkar Baij, a demanding yet influential mentor, urged students to observe life directly rather than rely on academic models. He often rejected prepared sketches, insisting instead on studying movement, rhythm and form through direct observation. This immersive approach stayed with eminent sculptor Niranjan Pradhan, who remarked, "As a person, Ramkinkar Baij was as simple as the earth beneath our feet. His relationship with students was never limited to formal instruction and was filled with warmth and affection." Pradhan also remembered visiting Baij at work. He said he had come not merely to watch but to understand how Baij lost himself in creation, adding that whatever he learned from him would remain with him throughout his life and work. Baij responded by placing a hand on his back and saying, "This is what I seek. Students who come not just to learn but to absorb. Art is not something that can simply be taught; it must be lived. If one works with complete focus, surrendering to the process, only then will true creation emerge."

His studio life reflected his art, informal and lived. Music, sketching among Santhal communities, long walks and conversation came from direct experience. This shaped his portraits and paintings, focused on inner vitality over surface likeness. His cement busts of Rabindranath Tagore and Binodini reflect his expressive use of form and material. His work stayed rooted in labour, hunger and displacement, shaped by the Bengal Famine of 1943.

This unity of life and art is seen in the 1975 film 'Ramkinkar Baij: A Personality Study by Ritwik Ghatak', where he sketches while speaking and recalls using oil paintings to patch his leaking roof.

According to eminent sculptor Bimal Kundu, who closely witnessed the gradual recognition of Ramkinkar Baij in Bengal's artistic circles, the pioneering modernist worked in relative obscurity for much of his life, unconcerned with conventional materials or public recognition. "Whatever materials were available at hand, he would use them," Kundu recalled, emphasising Baij's instinctive and experimental approach. He noted that although Baij had long been producing pathbreaking work in Santiniketan, Kolkata's art circles remained largely unaware of him for many years. "We in Kolkata truly came to recognise Ramkinkar Baij as an artist only during the 1970s," he said. He explained that after Independence, many statues of British officials across Kolkata were removed and replaced with sculptures of eminent Bengali personalities commissioned by the then government. However, questions of sculptural quality, form and likeness were seldom discussed. Baij entered wider public consciousness when a prominent publication invited him to review the city's growing number of public statues. "People connected deeply with his observations because many of those statues were artistically weak," Kundu said. Through these reviews, Baij emerged as a significant voice in Kolkata's art discourse. "Even as his reputation slowly grew, wider public recognition of Ramkinkar Baij's work in Kolkata took time to develop," he added.

Recalling the artist's death, Kundu said he visited IPGMER and SSKM Hospital and later carried Baij's body before it was taken to Santiniketan. He also noted the former chairman of Lalit Kala Akademi in the late 1980s and sculptor Shankho Chaudhuri's efforts in expanding discussions around Baij, including an All India art camp in Bankura. Kundu pointed to renewed cultural engagement with Baij through works like 'Dekhi Nai Phire' by Samaresh Basu and paintings by Bikash Bhattacharjee. "From then on, people slowly began to understand the extraordinary nature of Ramkinkar Baij," he observed. Reflecting on Baij's legacy, Kundu said originality and continuity defined his work, though recognition came slowly. "Eventually, Kinkarda became a legend across India alongside Abanindranath Tagore, Nandalal Bose and Jamini Roy," he said.

By placing marginalised rural communities at the centre of monumental public sculpture in a cultural context where such representation was uncommon, Ramkinkar Baij redefined the possibilities of modern Indian art. His work reflected a commitment to experimentation, social representation and expressive freedom rather than conventional ideals of perfection. Through their vitality and enduring presence in public space, his sculptures continue to affirm his lasting influence on the development of Indian modernism and the language of contemporary sculpture.

Today, Ramkinkar Baij stands at the centre of modern Indian art history. Yet beyond his formal innovations, it is his uncompromising humanity, his ability to find monumentality in ordinary workers, rural communities and everyday life, that continues to make his work feel strikingly alive even today.

Chandrima Das is an independent researcher in International Relations and European Studies who works on art curation and cultural heritage research